

Spirit of Sacrifice

THE FORTY-FOURTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS

1994 Final Report

Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza, New York, NY, April 17—23

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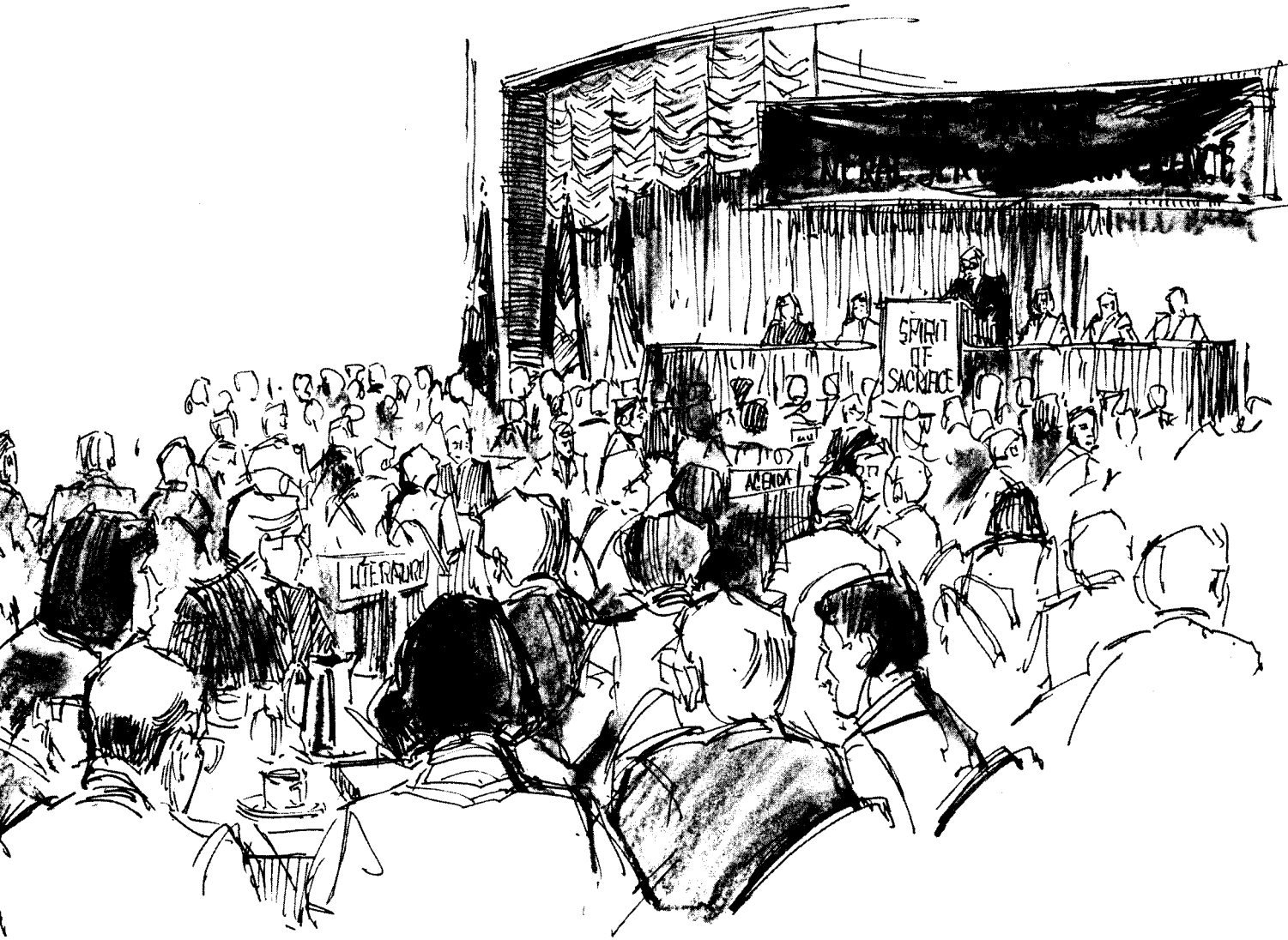
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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



44TH GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

Spirit of Sacrifice

"It is a glorious day outside, but not nearly as glorious as it is inside," said Jim Estelle, chairman of the A.A. General Service Board, at the closing brunch of the 44th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous of the United States and Canada.

An aura of spirituality, peace, and a sense of community seemed to guide this Conference. Why this was the general feeling is as impossible to answer as the mystery of how sobriety and A.A. work. Perhaps (as often happens in our groups or institutions meetings) it was the right blend of people, the right "chemistry," so to speak. Perhaps it came about as the result of the previous Conference, with the theme "A.A. Takes Its Inventory," which ended a year of intense inventory-taking throughout the groups, districts, areas and other A.A. entities. Perhaps the theme "Spirit of Sacrifice" helped this Conference focus on our primary purpose and Legacies.

Or, perhaps it was the shift in agenda which allowed for a general sharing session on Wednesday morning. The reason for holding this type of sharing session for the first time was reviewed by Mark Langsam, District of Columbia, on Wednesday morning. "At the end of last year's Conference," Mark explained, "the members of the Conference Agenda Committee and the delegates had a feeling that the week went much too quickly and that time was needed to discuss the Fellowship as a spiritual entity. It was felt that it would be a good idea to pause mid-Conference and share about some general A.A. principles and operating at this level of service, before going back to the actual business of the Conference."

As the sharing session continued, Lois Concelman, Western Pennsylvania, read from *Daily Reflections* for April 20: "...we ask God to direct our thinking, especially asking that it be divorced from self-pity, dishonest or self-seeking motives." (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p. 86) Lois then gave the suggested topics for this sharing session: Assisting individual A.A.s to carry the message; keeping the message clear; the Traditions in service.

The sharing that followed was filled with gratitude for the Fellowship, concerns for the work that needs to be done, and mutual love and respect for each other. One delegate summed it up when he said that he found it a humbling experience to be there. "This year the Conference is quieter...a most challenging growth experience for all of us."

The 44th General Service Conference met at the Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza, New York City, April 17-23. The 133 Conference members consisted of delegates from the 91 service areas of the U.S. and Canada, 21 trustees (14 alcoholic and 7 nonalcoholic) of the General Service Board, plus directors of the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Corporate Boards, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members.

For the first time this year, the Conference had four co-chairs, instead of two. Taking turns on the podium were: Jim Estelle (nonalcoholic) chairman of the General Service Board; George Dorsey, G.S.O.'s general manager; John Hartley Smith, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; and Diane Watson, the delegate chairperson, from California Northern Coastal Area. On the podium at all times was Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O. staff member who serves as Conference coordinator.

The Conference was officially opened Sunday morning with the calling of the roll by George Dorsey. There were greetings from the delegate chair, Diane Watson, (page 6); the keynote address was given by Greg Muth, Pacific regional trustee (page 7).

The opening dinner Sunday evening was followed by an open A.A. meeting. Gay Walters, of Utah, chaired the meeting, and

speakers were: Jean Smith, general service trustee; Pat Dawson, South Florida/Bermuda/V.I.; Anne Mabery, Hawaii; Richard Roughton, A.A.W.S. director; and Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O. staff.

The busy week consisted of Presentations and Reports (page 14); Area Service Highlights (page 45); a workshop, based on the Conference theme (page 10); and two What's On Your Mind? sharing sessions. Conference members also heard reports on Identifying Marks and Copyrights (page 7), an update on G.S.O.'s records department (page 18), and a progress report on the upcoming 60th Anniversary International Convention (page 21). And, of course, most important, were the meetings of the eleven standing Conference committees that discussed and reviewed their individual agenda items and, beginning Thursday morning, presented their recommendations and suggestions to the entire Conference. Many of these recommendations became Advisory Actions (page 11).

On Wednesday afternoon regional trustee elections were held. Julian Rhinehart was elected Pacific regional trustee, replacing Greg Muth; William Bungay, of Corner Brook, Newfoundland, will replace Marc Pineau as Eastern Canada regional trustee. Peter Brock, of Arlington, Virginia, will be the new A.A.S.W. general service trustee, replacing Jean Smith. The board also approved Peter Roach, of Peterborough, Ontario, to serve as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee.

At the Delegates Only Dinner, Dorothy Neurohr, North Dakota, was chosen delegate chair for the 1995 Conference; Roger Smith, NW Ohio/SE Michigan, will be the alternate chairperson.

Other activities included the annual visit to the General Service and Grapevine offices, where visitors bottlenecked in the Archives to view memorabilia of our history. Saturday afternoon some Conference members visited Stepping Stones, in Bedford Hills, New York, the home of co-founder Bill Wilson and his wife, Lois, and the site of so much A.A. history.

Everyone joined in wishing the A.A. Grapevine warmest wishes and congratulations on the 50th Anniversary of A.A.'s meeting in print. An enormous sheet cake was wheeled into the main session room to a chorus of Happy Birthday. At the closing brunch each member was given a copy of the Grapevine anniversary issue, a double issue, introducing the new design, with many articles highlighting Grapevine and A.A. history.

As A.A. members know, a business meeting—which, in essence, is what the Conference is—does not take the place of a regular A.A. meeting. So, each morning at 7:30, the self-supporting G.S.C. Serenity Group met. Class A trustee John Chappel was there every morning (usually in sweatshirt just in from his morning run). John always refers to this open meeting as his "home group." This year the Serenity Group was chaired by Pat Dawson, South Florida; Denise Bell, Southeast New York, served as secretary/treasurer. The topic each morning was based on a reading from A.A. literature.

Friday afternoon, when the last committee report had been given and the final Advisory Actions recorded, the 44th General Service Conference was closed with the Serenity Prayer in English, French and Spanish.

However, Conference members met one last time for the closing brunch on Saturday morning. Farewell messages were given by rotating trustees Greg Muth, Marc Pineau and Jean Smith.

At the Wednesday morning sharing session, Bruce Bates, Northern Minnesota, shared that A.A. had given him "the gifts of sobriety, faith in the group conscience process, and the ability to participate in this process with patience, tolerance and love. What we do here this week," Bruce said, "will be our

collective gift back to the Fellowship.”

Once more, as Alcoholics Anonymous begins its 60th year, the process continues—with patience, tolerance, love and sobriety.



Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

Greetings and welcome to the 44th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous. Through the mystery of the Third Legacy's most spiritual process—pulling a name from the hat—I have been delegated to welcome you to this Conference meeting. I came to New York last year confident that I was as well prepared as I could be by a legacy of responsibility and communication passed on by previous delegates in my area and by the participation and trust of the groups that sent me here. What I found, as I participated in the Conference process, was the miracle and challenge of unity and sacrifice, as delegates from widely different service cultures discussed and deliberated and came to substantial unanimity on issues that, in humility, we might have felt we could not possibly decide. As delegates, we came to realize that we participate as equals with trustees and staff, as members of a Conference that is charged with making the decisions that Alcoholics Anonymous requires today in

order to be sure that the Fellowship and its message will be, as Bernard Smith said in 1954, "...a permanent haven for all alcoholics who in the ages ahead can find in A.A. that rebirth which brought its first members back to life"—and "...so that Alcoholics Anonymous and Alcoholics Anonymous alone may be the ultimate repository of its own Twelve Steps, its Twelve Traditions, and all of its Services." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 281)

Our task seems simple. We come here with information from our bosses—the groups in our areas—and we share with each other about issues that our Fellowship has sent to us during the year. With the help of a Higher Power, we make decisions, or decide not to decide just yet. It is important to Alcoholics Anonymous that we pay attention to the process. The Conference is surely the place to remember the Declaration of Unity: "This we owe to A.A.'s future: to place our common welfare first; to keep our Fellowship united. For on A.A. unity depend our lives, and the lives of those to come."

We cannot have unity without trust. We must trust the Conference process, the committee process, and above all, we must trust each other. I believe that each of us is as well prepared as we can be; that each of us is here to do the best job we can for Alcoholics Anonymous, and that each of us is here not to exert our own will, but to participate in discovering God's will for our Fellowship. Unity will come if we remember the wisdom in Dr. Bob's farewell talk: "Our Twelve Steps...resolve themselves into the words 'love' and 'service.' We understand what love is, and we understand what service is. So let's bear those two things in mind. Let us also remember to guard that erring member the tongue, and...let's use it with kindness and consideration and tolerance." (*Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*, p. 338)

The Conference, it is said, is a year-round process. Our participation in the 44th General Service Conference will not end with closing ceremonies next Saturday morning. We will spend the rest of this year living with and sharing about the decisions we reach this week. Our responsibility to the unity of Alcoholics Anonymous will continue as we go back home and explain this Conference. It may require tolerance and sacrifice to continue to promote unity if we were to be a minority voice during this Conference. But if we trust each other and trust the presence of a loving God in our decisions this week, we will be able to carry a message of trust and unity to the Fellowship.

Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities. Bill Wilson wrote that, "The spiritual substance of anonymity is sacrifice." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 184) We are here because we have been willing to sacrifice our time and our energy in the service of Alcoholics Anonymous. Let us pray for the willingness this week and this year to sacrifice ego and willfulness to unity, to love, and to service. "We understand what love is, and we understand what service is." We understand it because Bill and Bob gave it to us, because our sponsors gave it, because our predecessors for 43 years gave it. If it is a sacrifice to continue their legacy, let us be joyful and wholehearted in the sacrifice.

*Diane Watson (California, Northern Coastal)
delegate chairperson*

Larry Schlosser (B.C./Yukon) said that he once told a psychiatrist that he felt "selfish, egotistical and self-centered." The psychiatrist responded, "God, you should be drinking!" Larry said, that the wisdom that comes from a cup of coffee amazes him.

Keynote Address

Aloha! I can't begin to describe the heartfelt gratitude that has overwhelmed me since I received my loving invitation to give the keynote address to the 44th annual meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous. My dear friends and fellow rotating trustees, Marc Pineau and Jean Smith, in my estimate, are far better suited than I to give this keynote address. I have come to rely on and appreciate their very special A.A. insights and the gentle way they share their gifts. I pray that my words today reflect their thoughts and feelings on this life-giving A.A. principle of "Sacrifice."

I would like to digress a moment and say a few words about my auspicious beginnings in this great Fellowship. I came to A.A. for all the wrong reasons. I thought I came to get a wife and son back who had sent me packing, not wanting to bear any more heartbreak caused by my alcoholic drinking. I came to get my long-defunct business back, in order to get the creditors "off my back,"—and yes, to learn how to control my drinking. It was this hope that enabled me to continue to attend meetings and, at last, to surrender and face the fact that my life, my entire life, has been based upon my selfish, self-centered pursuit of life's material rewards at the expense of everyone—parents, family, friends and acquaintances—nobody mattered, only Greg.

Thank God it didn't matter to you that I was self-obsessed, dishonest and untrustworthy. You saw in me your very survival, the opportunity to give new life to a fellow sufferer. Through the fulfillment of your Twelve-Step gift, I received the message of hope, and you achieved another day of grace. It was during this very Twelfth Step experience that I became aware that A.A. members were willing to set aside their personal wants and desires, and give freely of themselves with no material rewards, so that I might find a way out from my alcoholic dilemma. I came to understand that as recovering alcoholics, we have no choice, we must reach out to the suffering alcoholic. We do this in order to assure our own survival.

My newfound sponsor knew I was sick, very sick—physically, mentally and spiritually. He knew me well; he knew that I was a very unprincipled drunkard. At my second meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous, my sponsor asked the group leader to have the group discuss anonymity for the benefit of this "new-comer." He knew that I was easily impressed by people, places and things. He also knew that if I were to have a chance to survive, I needed to comprehend and apply our most cherished and unifying principle of anonymity to my life. I was to discover that the very essence of anonymity is sacrifice, putting the needs of A.A. ahead of my own wants and desires.

In offering my thoughts today on the spirit of sacrifice, I would like us all to recall and reflect on Bill's talk, "Why Alcoholics Anonymous is Anonymous." This wonderful talk recounts the pains of our historic beginnings and our forced compliance with the principle of anonymity as expressed through the spirit of sacrifice. Bill's words in *A.A. Comes of Age* (pp. 287-288) are unmatched in their ability to express this spirit of sacrifice, and I quote: "Thus we learned that sacrifice had to bring a double benefit, or else little at all. We began to know about the kind of giving of ourselves that has no price tag on it."

"When the first A.A. group took form, we soon learned a lot more about this. We found that each of us had to make willing sacrifices for the group itself, sacrifices for the common welfare. The group, in turn, found that it had to give up many of its own rights for the protection and welfare of each member, and for A.A. as a whole. These sacrifices had to be made or A.A. could not continue to exist.

"Out of these experiences and realizations, the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous began to take shape and substance. Gradually we saw that the unity, the effectiveness, and even the survival of A.A. always would depend on our continued willingness to give up our personal ambitions and desires for the common safety and welfare. Just as sacrifice meant survival for the individual, so did sacrifice mean unity and survival for the group and for A.A.'s entire fellowship.

"Viewed in this light, A.A.'s Twelve Traditions are little else than a list of sacrifices which the experience of twenty years has taught us that we must make, individually and collectively, if A.A. itself is to stay safe, alive and healthy."

Conference has convened today to do the business of Alcoholics Anonymous, guided in its deliberations by the Twelve Traditions. This week, as in past years, the Conference will be filled with the spirits of our predecessors as we collectively and lovingly discuss, debate and make decisions on questions set before us on our agenda. When Saturday afternoon arrives, and our work has been completed, we will reflect on not how much work we have accomplished, but on the process by which we sought God's will. It is this process that I would like us all to focus on for a moment.



This will be my sixth and final General Service Conference. I have been treated to many special, special moments during the last several years. The Conference has deliberated on many tough and challenging issues: The Challenge of the Seventh Tradition; merit pay; the gay/lesbian pamphlet; in-town trustees; the six points; computers; relocation; reorganization; the circle and triangle logo; litigation; and the Big Book—just to name a few. I have witnessed, time and time again, dedicated Conference members discussing with loving passion their thoughts and beliefs concerning issues of importance to our Fellowship, pressing their points of view, skillfully using knowledgeable resource information and well-defined experience supported by group conscience directions. Rebuttals, submitted with equal elegance and passion, sweeping the searchlight of prudence for the right solutions under God's guidance. This is the process by which we come to rely on one another, to trust one another, to help each other with our frailties and sensitivities, to help each other express our creative God consciousness. It is the process by which we search out and find God's will for us, and we pray for Alcoholics Anonymous.

It has been my impression that, over the past several years, the love and mutual respect we afford each other as A.A. members and trusted servants has been on the decline. The Second Tradition discipline has been set aside in favor of the easier path of fear and mistrust. The leadership discretion, afforded each A.A. servant in Concept Three, has been put aside in our effort to control and direct each other. Some of this mistrust may have been generated from our rapid growth and our inability to find a simple, forthright form of communication. A.A. members and groups may have perceived that at times the boards, staff, management and even delegates have been making decisions outside their delegated authority. Some feel that the committee system, with its utter dependency on the principles of faith, trust and delegated responsibility, cannot possibly work in these changing times of rapid communication; and that the continual desire of Conference members to more fully participate in each and every committee diverts their focus from their assigned

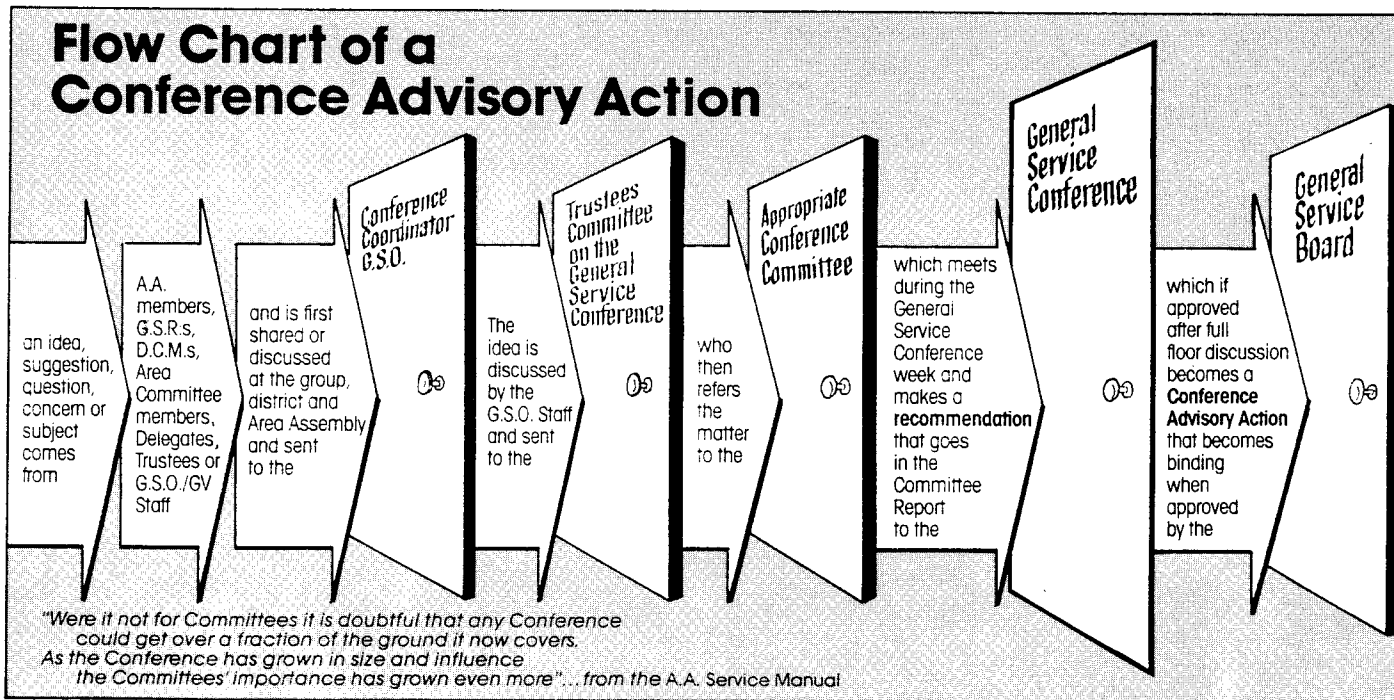
committees.

We must relearn to trust each other, and to know in our heart of hearts that our love for A.A.—individually and collectively—is pure in spirit. We must know that each element of this Conference process is designed to facilitate an equal interaction between members, boards and staff. All Conference members are equal and the Conference process favors no one member over another. We must spend the proper time in studying our past and availing ourselves of the tried and proven principles and relationships outlined in our Steps, Traditions, Charters, By-laws, Concepts and Warranties. We must avail ourselves of this collective wisdom, because within each of these documents is the Spirit that we are urgently seeking and needing.

Today we find ourselves at the threshold of a new era, a resurgence of mutual love and trust for one another. As we gather together this week, let us recommit to a renewal of each of our individual spirits, setting aside our personal agenda and focusing on what is the highest good, the very best for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. As we lovingly discuss each topic let us always be sensitive to each other's viewpoints; let us listen very carefully to each other, sensing the spiritual essence of each talk. Let us be willing to question and review our own thoughts and ideas, always at the ready to set aside our viewpoint for a better vision. The real accomplishment of the 44th General Service Conference will be revealed in the manner by which we collectively see God's will for the good of Alcoholics Anonymous. Let us all remember that what we do here this week is important. We are here to do the work assigned to us by the Fellowship. But of real importance—and far more lasting—is the way that we express our love to one another, the way that we encourage each other to share spiritually. As we process our discussions this week, may we constantly be reminded to pause and to be still and ask ourselves, "What would the Master do?" (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 142) I love you all, *mahalo nui loa*.

Greg Muth, Pacific regional trustee

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



Reports on Identifying Marks and Copyrights

At the 1993 General Service Conference, Jean Smith, acting in her capacity as chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board, stated that the A.A.W.S. Board would present a revised policy statement regarding marks to the 1994 General Service Conference. As a result, the following report on "A.A.W.S. Policy on Identifying Marks and Copyrights" was presented to the Conference by Peter Brock, chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Services Committee, on Monday afternoon:

The policy of the A.A.W.S. Board is to avoid litigation whenever possible.

Background: In connection with the chips/medallions debate at the 43rd General Service Conference, Jean Smith made the following statement in her capacity as chair of the A.A.W.S. Board during the final sharing session (April 23, 1993):

"The A.A.W.S. Board will immediately begin a thorough review of its policies regarding our marks, will do everything possible to avoid initiating litigation, and will prepare a revised policy statement to be ready for next year's Conference."

At the time the foregoing statement was made to the Conference, A.A.W.S. policy regarding its trademarks and service marks was essentially summed up in the section entitled "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" on page S103 of *The A.A. Service Manual / Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

After the Conference had closed, the A.A.W.S. Board published a statement on April 29, 1993 modifying its policy: A.A.W.S. would no longer oppose the use of the circle/triangle symbol by outside enterprises, but would continue to discourage all unauthorized uses of the marks "A.A." and "Alcoholics Anonymous" as well as the remaining marks.* With substantial unanimity, the General Service Board approved the A.A.W.S. Board's recommendation to modify the policy, prior to implementation of the change. A May 21, 1993 statement indicated that A.A.W.S. was phasing out its own "official" use of the various circle/triangle marks. This statement also provided a rationale for the Board's policy modification.

A.A.'s history on the subject of litigation and our available records indicate that we have initiated suits on two occasions in nearly 60 years, each on the grounds of trademark infringement and after extended negotiations in an attempt to resolve the matters. In those instances, the cases were settled prior to trial on terms consistent with A.A.'s policy and principles. At present, there is no pending litigation.

Any policy, to be effective, must include the infinite variety of possibilities which might confront A.A. in the future. Therefore, we believe our policy must contain only general guidelines. To do more could have the effect of deciding today how trusted servants of tomorrow ought to deal with new problems. The position of the A.A.W.S. Board is to avoid litigation whenever possible. If it were decided to prohibit all litigation respecting identifying marks and copyrights, such action could have the effect of abandoning the A.A. name and copyrights forever, along with the integrity of our message and our identity.

In addition, at the request of the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference, Jim Estelle, chairman of the General Service Board, formed an ad hoc committee whose charge was "to review and report on our policy concerning the protection of our trademarks, service marks and copyrights." This committee was ably served by Panel 43 delegates, Hugh Vaughan, chairperson; Bill

Baker; Charlie Burns; Conley Byrd; Susan Campbell; and Esther Hall. Also serving on the committee: Tom Maguire, Grapevine director; David O'Leary, trustee; Helen Turnquest, G.S.O. staff, and Tom Jasper, committee facilitator/liaison. The following report of this General Service Board ad hoc committee was presented to the Conference by Jim Estelle on Monday afternoon:

The committee extensively reviewed numerous documents pertaining to trademarks, copyrights and royalty matters, and concerns by some of our Fellowship about the A.A.W.S. policy on marks.

On Saturday, February 19, 1994, this committee met with the A.A.W.S. Services Committee and Michael Alexander, Trustee Emeritus, for a general discussion regarding copyrights, litigation and related matters. The policy statement developed by A.A.W.S. on "Identifying Marks and Copyrights" was reviewed and discussed.

The ad hoc committee was unable to achieve agreement on the issue of litigation, but recognizes that we are a spiritual Fellowship with some business, and as a matter of policy our Steps, Traditions and Concepts should direct the nature of that business.

Therefore, the ad hoc committee unanimously recommends the following be considered by the General Service Board as additional guidelines to the policy developed by A.A.W.S.:

1. That A.A.W.S. follow the policy on Identifying Marks and Copyrights as guidelines until the 1996 Conference, allowing time for the Fellowship to consider the concerns surrounding this issue; and this policy be reviewed at the 1996 Conference.
2. That information and questions about these issues be furnished to the Fellowship at large and input be sought at the group level. Regional Forum workshops and delegate presentations within each area could be possible avenues for dissemination of this information. Specific questions should include our society's responsibility to A.A.'s intellectual properties, basic message and the A.A. name itself.
3. That litigation is a matter for thorough and cautious consideration and should not be undertaken without consultation with the General Service Board.

After considerable discussion throughout the Conference meeting, the Conference chose to take no action on these reports.



* Additional trademarks and service marks owned by A.A. are as follows: "The Big Book," "Box 4-5-9," "The Grapevine," "GV," "AA Grapevine," and "Box 1980."

Workshop: Spirit of Sacrifice —The Twelfth Step in Action

Wednesday afternoon Conference members split up into groups of 12 to 14 for a workshop discussion based on the Conference theme. Following are the workshop questions and a summary of the report backs.

1 Where Have We Been?

Many Conference members expressed the belief that, although some of the oldtimers' intense, one-on-one dedication to "working with wet drunks" has been lost, the Fellowship's overall spirit of sacrifice in its willingness to be of service is alive and well. "The oldtimers gave us one message: sobriety; Black Belt A.A. sponsors told us what to do and how to do it." In the early days—before the existence of treatment facilities—Twelfth Step work meant "calling on the wet drunks, shaking it out and walking with them." However, the spirit of sacrifice has *always* been an essential component of anyone's sobriety, and will remain so, even as the world continues to change.

Nowadays, G.S.O. "makes it possible for Twelfth Step work to be done," but it is still the individual members who perform the Twelfth Step tasks. Maybe we're not so far from the spirit of sacrifice exemplified by Bill W., and Dr. Bob, after all. There has been a return to basics and a recognition that these should remain in the forefront of everyone's sobriety. Perhaps the message was carried in a "clearer, simpler" way in the old days, but the "Twelfth Step chain never ends." Because each one of us moves from the "selfishness of our drinking days, to experiencing the joy of living," he or she retains a willingness to make sacrifices so others may attain that same awakening.

The unchanging aspect of the A.A. program is what keeps our society strong and unified. While it's true that "our early members sacrificed lots of time and energy," we in the present know we have to continue to work with alcoholics because it: 1) keeps us honest; 2) it's part of our own paths of recovery; 3) we're responsible; 4) it gives us a purpose in life; and 5) many still don't know about us. So we must be willing to go to any lengths to carry the message.

2 Where Are We Now?

There's definitely been a trend on the part of individual A.A.s and groups toward substituting service work for Twelfth Step calls on wet drunks, which is tied to various factors: fear about safety in making the calls, or laziness stemming from a perception of the Fellowship's prosperity and success, combined with too many demands on our time. "How we approach wet drunks and treatment facilities is a key element that will affect the outcome" of our future direction, was the consensus of one group.

There's a tendency among newcomers to be "less desperate," to feel "less allegiance to A.A." And there's been a "loss of integrity in the message" due to the proliferation of non-A.A. literature. Still, Conference members agreed there was a prevailing willingness to carry the message. Many members "see a need for new activity," and there's a collective wish "to be part of the solution with the proper spirit," thus helping ourselves at the same time that we help others.

It was suggested that A.A.s stop "babying newcomers, quit trying to make A.A. fit *them* and tell them that—if they want what we have—they do what we do." A trend toward getting back to basics was cited again and again, though the question was asked, too, about the oldtimers. What's happened to them? Why are they still going underground?

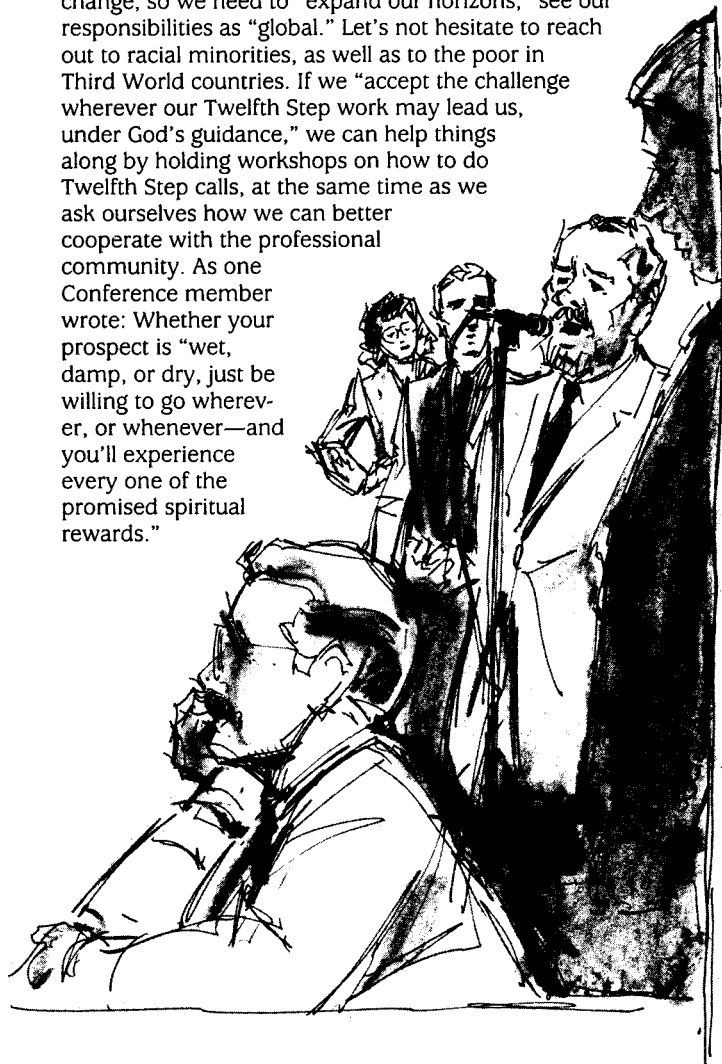
The "spirit of sacrifice" is still best exemplified in the individual

who's "willing to go to any lengths." Nonetheless, some hard questions need not only to be asked, but kept in the forefront of every A.A.'s mind: Are we spending too much time on the converted? How can we help more? Do we look on Twelfth Step calls as work, an inconvenience—or as an opportunity? "Apathy and self-centeredness are a danger to us," all the more so as younger people enter the Fellowship. The continuing challenge is, therefore, to keep holding and carrying the message as we move ahead with the times.

3 Where Are We Going?

If the Fellowship has survived, even thrived through its years of growth, A.A.s have never allowed themselves to feel complacent about A.A.'s direction, and shouldn't engage in those feelings now. So there were many suggestions about keeping ourselves on target. Let us: never lose sight of A.A. principles or the value of getting back to basics; keep a focus on the needs of the deaf, the blind, the physically handicapped; forever keep it simple and direct; improve our ways to "bridge the barriers of language and culture; recognize the value of renewing our energy, especially among the Fellowship's young members"—"they may be our greatest resource in carrying the A.A. message forward."

There's a perception among many A.A.s, who are great believers in "being right where we're supposed to be," that if treatment facilities have had to close, then this is the time to reinforce our determination to use those very basics that have always served us best. Growth always entails an adaptation to change, so we need to "expand our horizons," see our responsibilities as "global." Let's not hesitate to reach out to racial minorities, as well as to the poor in Third World countries. If we "accept the challenge wherever our Twelfth Step work may lead us, under God's guidance," we can help things along by holding workshops on how to do Twelfth Step calls, at the same time as we ask ourselves how we can better cooperate with the professional community. As one Conference member wrote: Whether your prospect is "wet, damp, or dry, just be willing to go wherever, or whenever—and you'll experience every one of the promised spiritual rewards."



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the Conference.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 1 The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the General Service Conference be as follows: The chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be chair of the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.
- 2 The theme for the 1995 General Service Conference be: "Pass It On — Our Three Legacies."
- 3 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1995 General Service Conference:
 - a) Pass It On: Recovery — Our First Legacy
 - b) Pass It On: Unity — Our Second Legacy
 - c) Pass It On: Service — Our Third Legacy
- 4 The following be the workshop for the 1995 General Service Conference: How We Pass It On:
 - a) Our Basic Message
 - b) Sponsorship in Recovery and Service
 - c) Communication - The Language of A.A.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 5 The changes to "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics," prepared by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, be approved with these additional changes:
 - a) This header be added to the contents page or the first page of text: "A.A. publications referred to in these pages are listed on the inside back cover."
 - b) Abbreviations and acronyms be spelled out or explained the first time or two each is used.
 - c) On page 16 of the draft, question 17, "How can local A.A. groups and members help patients who are being discharged from treatment facilities?" be answered: "In order to bridge the gap, A.A. members have volunteered to be temporary contacts and introduce newcomers to Alcoholics Anonymous. Many local groups and committees have established such temporary contact programs. (For more information, see the 'Bridging the Gap' pamphlet.)"
 - d) On page 20 of the draft, the first line of the answer to question 4, "Why is C.P.C. activity important?", be

changed from "The professional can help the alcoholic want to hear the A.A. message of recovery" to: "The professional can help the alcoholic become willing to hear the A.A. message of recovery."

- e) The pamphlet's title be changed to "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Professionals" with the subheading "Cooperation, But Not Affiliation."
- 6 The policy on distributing A.A. confidential directories to outside organizations, treatment professionals and others requesting this information, when approved by the area delegate, be changed as described below, because of the need to respect the autonomy and anonymity of other groups and members, as well as A.A. as a whole:
 - a) The General Service Office no longer provide A.A. confidential directories outside the Fellowship.
 - b) G.S.O. respond to future requests with a friendly letter of explanation enclosing the listing of central offices, intergroups and answering services for the United States and Canada; and forward the request to the area delegate for information and follow up.
- 7 The format of the C.P.C. Workbook be changed as described below to enable wider use of this information, and to reduce the costs to local committees:
 - a) The format be changed to a soft-cover booklet, comparable to the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and the booklet enclosed in a folder with related C.P.C. materials.
 - b) The booklet be available separately, as well as in the complete kit.
 - c) The contents of the kit be addressed and discussed by the 1995 Conference C.P.C. Committee.
 - d) The text be revised and condensed for clarity, and to eliminate inconsistencies and redundancies, and a draft sent as background to the 1995 Conference C.P.C. Committee for approval.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 8 Changes in the pamphlets "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" and "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators," from a report by the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities, be accepted and forwarded to Publications for the next printing of the pamphlets.
- 9 Guidelines for A.A. presentations to corrections professionals and to inmates by correctional committees be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook booklet at its next printing.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 10 The first draft of the new self-support pamphlet not be approved and that the trustees' Finance Committee work with the Publications Department to develop several (3-5, estimated total cost \$3,000 to \$5,000) comprehensive layouts, including the long form of the Seventh Tradition, and definition of Prudent Reserve, keeping in mind that all service entities are equally important. It is requested that these layouts be brought to the 1995 Conference Finance Committee for review.
- 11 We not form an ad-hoc committee to relocate G.S.O. out of

New York, because it is not financially prudent, and such a project is not needed at the present time.

12 The definition of the Prudent Reserve not be changed. The committee recognized that the new presentation of the financial statements excluding shipping and warehousing from operating expenses has effectively reduced the limit of the Reserve Fund by approximately \$800,000.

13 We adopt or continue use of the Birthday Plan to provide "supplementary" support of A.A.'s world services.

14 Instead of the three-part green bar forms that are sent out on a quarterly basis, a simple 8 1/2" x 11" page listing district, group service number, group name, group city, date of last contribution, and contributions to date be used.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

15 All A.A. members be strongly urged to work toward the goal that the A.A. Grapevine magazine be self-supporting through the sale of magazine subscriptions.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

It was recommended that:

16 An anonymity protected photograph of the flag ceremony be taken at the 1995 International Convention.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

17 "District Meetings" be added to the inverted triangle in "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" pamphlet after the current inventory is depleted.

18 The following changes be made in the "G.S.R." pamphlet:

a) Panel 2, #3

Delete the word "also" from the second to last sentence.

Delete the last sentence, "You might like to suggest that your group buy its own copy," and replace it with: "Copies of the report are available to groups upon request."

b) Panel 2, #3

Delete the word "feeling" in the third sentence and replace it with the word "conscience," so that the sentence now reads, "Via your D.C.M. and your delegate, you can see to it that your group's conscience on matters of importance...."

c) Panel 3, #4

Insert the words "or your district or area registrar" in the first paragraph after the words "your area committee" so that the sentence now reads, "...to the secretary of your area committee, or your district or area registrar and to G.S.O...."

d) Panel 3, #5

Delete the words "the directory" in the first sentence. The sentence now reads "In return, G.S.O. sends you the G.S.R. kit...."

e) Panel 3, #7

Delete "60-30-10 plan for" and insert the words "importance of."

In the same sentence after "...G.S.O.," add the word "district." The sentence now reads, "You explain the importance of financial support of your intergroup/central office, G.S.O., district and area committee...."

f) Panel 4, #11

Delete the numeral 15 from the first sentence. Because the A.A. guidelines are in constant flux, the numeral 15 is no longer applicable in this sentence.

g) Panel 5, #4

Insert the words "district or" in the second sentence. The sentence now reads: "If your district or area committee...."

h) Panel 5, #8

At the end of the paragraph, delete the words "public information, institutions, etc." The paragraph now ends with the words "...on special committees."

i) Panel 6

Delete the entire first paragraph and replace it with: "Hence, an A.A. service is anything whatever that helps us to reach a fellow sufferer — ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten-cent phone call and a cup of coffee, and to A.A.'s General Service Office for national and international action. The sum total of all these services is our Third Legacy of Service." (A.A. *Service Manual*, p. S7)

j) Panel 6

Fourth paragraph, change the numeral "90" to "91." The sentence now reads "...a body of about 91 delegates...."

19 The entire sentence "Mood-changing medications — including uppers, sedatives, and antidepressants are usually a threat to sobriety and you may want to learn more about this" be deleted from page 18 in the pamphlet "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" and that the next sentence in the paragraph, "The pamphlet 'The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs' discusses the problem in detail" be moved to the end of the same paragraph on page 19.

The sentence now reads, "...and either course may lead a sober alcoholic back to the first drink. The pamphlet 'The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs' discusses the problem in detail."

20 The text of material on "Service Sponsorship" submitted by the trustees' Literature Committee be included in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" when current inventory is depleted.

21 The circle and triangle logo be discontinued on all Conference-approved literature.

22 The words "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature" be displayed on the front cover of all A.A. Conference-approved literature wherever possible.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

23 The alternate delegate from Area 45, Southern New Jersey, Sally A. Letts, be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Ike Treadwell, who is unable to attend.

24 The 47th General Service Conference be held April 13-19, 1997, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

25 The request from the Washington Area (72) for a new delegate area be denied.

26 The request from the Southern California Area (05) for a new delegate area be denied.

27 No moratorium be placed on topics to be considered by the General Service Conference.

28 All nontrustee, nondirector members of the trustees' committees be encouraged to attend the opening sessions and participate at the joint committee meetings and be invited to attend the Opening Dinner of the General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

29 The revised Public Information Workbook be produced in a soft-cover format similar to the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

30 The third and fourth paragraphs of "The District" on page S52 of *The A.A. Service Manual* be deleted and replaced by the following text:

"Redistricting

"As the number of groups increases, the committee member's problem is met in a number of ways:

"a) The district is divided into two or more districts, each with a committee member to head it.

"b) Local Committee Member (L.C.M.): A large district divides itself into smaller districts (often called subdistricts or local districts), each electing a local committee member. These L.C.M.s may or may not be voting members of the area committee and may or may not hold regular meetings with the G.S.R.s they serve.

"c) District Committee Member Chairperson (D.C.M.C.): A large district in a city or county holds regular meetings led by a D.C.M.C. who serves as the link between the district and the delegate and area committee. Within this large city/county district there are as many districts as are needed to adequately serve the groups. Each of these districts may be called a subdistrict, local district, or zone. Each is served by a district committee member who may hold regular meetings of G.S.R.s. These D.C.M.s may or may not be voting members of the area committee or area assembly.

There are many variations, but the goal is the same: To take care of expansion at the committee-member level. When additional committee members are elected in order to respond to expansion within a district, the qualifications and election method listed for a D.C.M. may serve as a guideline."

31 The last paragraph and all following material on page S103 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* in the section "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" be deleted as it is no longer applicable.

32 On page S104 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*, the sentences "Include the registered trademark symbol R" and "A fourth symbol (shown on page S103) is confined

to Conference-approved literature only, and may not be used" be deleted as they are no longer applicable.

33 On page S129 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* the portion of the following sentence — which is no longer applicable — in bold, stricken-through type be deleted and the italicized print be substituted as follows:

"This process takes time — months — but the results are worth the effort. When the pamphlet or book is finally completed, it is entitled to ~~carry the "Conference approved" seal, having fully earned it~~ bear the designation, "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature."

~~**{Circle/Triangle Design With Words
"General Service Conference" Is Deleted}**~~

34 No monetary contributions be reflected in any A.A. Directory, as this information is provided elsewhere and the purpose of the directories is to help traveling A.A. members find meetings and for Twelfth Step purposes.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

35 The proposed changes in the Treatment Facilities pamphlet be implemented with some editorial changes. The revised pamphlet is directed more towards A.A. volunteers than to treatment personnel. The testimonials have been removed and the Concepts have been added after the Steps and Traditions.

36 When the "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet is revised, the Personal Information page be retained but moved to the back page, with the deletion of the following information: home group, age, sobriety date, and sex. And, that the section entitled, "If you would like to help..." be placed on the same page as the Personal Information. The last sentence of this section should read, "Or send it to the Treatment Facilities Desk, General Service Office, Box 459, Grand Central Station, New York, NY 10163, so that G.S.O. can forward the information to your Area Treatment Facilities Committee."

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

37 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April, 1994 (see page 00; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee).

38 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. World Services Corporate Board (see page 00; slate of directors approved).

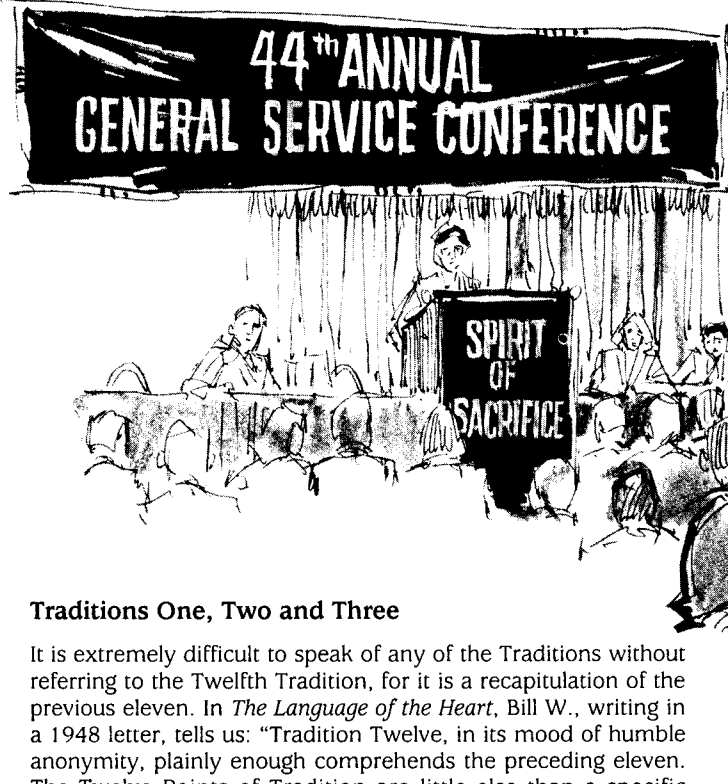
39 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board (see page 00; slate of directors approved).

40 In response to 1993 Conference Advisory Action #38, which pertained to limiting the terms of Class A trustees to two (2) consecutive three-year terms, the amendment, worded as follows, be included for clarification: "The foregoing limitation with respect to the maximum term of service of Class A member trustees shall not be applicable to those Class A member trustees who were serving as such during the 1993 General Service Conference."

Presentations and Reports

THE SPIRIT OF SACRIFICE

Presentations were based on the Conference theme, Spirit of Sacrifice, as reflected through the Twelve Traditions and the last messages of Bill and Dr. Bob. The Monday afternoon session began with two presentations on the first six Traditions. Peter Brock, A.A.W.S. director, was the moderator.



Traditions One, Two and Three

It is extremely difficult to speak of any of the Traditions without referring to the Twelfth Tradition, for it is a recapitulation of the previous eleven. In *The Language of the Heart*, Bill W., writing in a 1948 letter, tells us: "Tradition Twelve, in its mood of humble anonymity, plainly enough comprehends the preceding eleven. The Twelve Points of Tradition are little else than a specific application of the Twelve Steps of recovery to our group life and to our relations with society in general." (pp. 93-94)

When I hear the words "humble anonymity" I can only think how much of a sacrifice it is to me to do something for a human being without talking about it.

Our A.A. Traditions are—we trust—securely anchored in the following wise precepts: charity, gratitude, humility and prudence.

In each of those four precepts we also find the spirit of sacrifice. How can we identify those precepts and the spirit of sacrifice in the first three Traditions? Generally speaking, we can say that each Tradition asks group members to sacrifice something in the interest of the whole Fellowship. We may be asked to let go of some freedom, or to accept ego-deflation, either individually or collectively.

In Tradition One we are told that unless we strive for unity collectively we do not stand a chance to recover individually. Our personal recovery is dependent on the well-being of our group and, if you push unity further, the well-being of our group is dependent on the unity of the Fellowship. It does not imply that our individual needs are not looked after. There is no society we know of that has more respect for its minority, and this privilege is embedded in Concept V. No member of my home group can compel another member to talk and act as he wishes. So the common welfare must always come first, and my group will be able to help me remain sober. I must, however, sacrifice my own will.

With such a freedom to act how can we stay together? We must appreciate that if we do not care for the group we will sicken and die. We must remember that Bill W. could not stay sober by himself, he needed Dr. Bob to share his experience, strength and hope. So, if we are not ready to sacrifice our egos, our groups will suffer and we will die. As a group we have to let go and learn to let God.

In Tradition Two we learn to be aware of God. It is now the turn of the group's to let go of certain ideas. We are asked to submit our will to the care of God so that our group conscience can be perceived. We also have to learn to be just servants and realize that we only lead, we do not govern.

After a few months in the program I spoke to my sponsor about my difficulties in identifying a God who would love me,

understand me and forgive me. I read and read on the subject and consulted outside my group and the Fellowship, only to be told by my sponsor to find the desire to sacrifice some of my time to attend the business meetings of my home group, to appreciate how God expresses himself through our group conscience. It has helped me to reconcile with a God of my understanding, and made me appreciate that in order for a group to survive it has to give up some of its own freedom to make the whole of A.A. a better place for alcoholics to recover. It also forces groups to let go of some of their prerequisites to belong.

This collective letting-go of our egos is the best lead-in for our Third Tradition that tells us Alcoholics Anonymous has no membership rules—the only requirement is a desire to stop drinking. We make sure not to erect any barriers between us and the still-suffering alcoholic. This is the spirit of sacrifice in action. When asked if there are conditions to join our group, we find enough love in our hearts to tell the newcomer that he does not need to believe, he does not owe anything, we do not have membership cards or records. All the newcomer needs to have is the desire.

Our groups are asked to let go of some of their freedom in as much as they are asked to protect the A.A. name and consider their role as helping alcoholics only. We should not try to save the world; let us keep in mind our primary purpose.

In the light of the spirit of sacrifice embedded in these Three Traditions I can only hope that we will find enough love in our individual and collective hearts to reach out for the many minorities that are still to hear our message of love and hope—

be they women, Afro-Americans, Natives, handicapped, aged, dually-addicted, young people or long-time A.A. members that we tend to forget so easily.

May these virtues of charity, gratitude and humility ever stand clear before us in our doings and meditations.

Marc Pineau, trustee-at-large/Canada

Traditions Four, Five and Six

Tradition Four: With respect to its own affairs, each A.A. group should be responsible to no other authority than its own conscience. But, when its plans concern the welfare of neighboring groups also, those groups ought to be consulted. And no group, regional committee, or individual should ever take any action that might greatly affect A.A. as a whole without conferring with the trustees of the General Service Board. On such issues, our common welfare is paramount.

This Tradition gives us the definition of an A.A. group, in addition to other guides to follow. A group ought not do anything to injure A.A., nor affiliate itself with any outside entities. These guides are basic to group and A.A. survival as a whole.

What does or would affect other groups or A.A. as a whole? A rather large group in our area decided, based upon their group conscience vote, to cease signing court papers without consulting other groups that met in the same facility. In doing so, they affected A.A. as a whole. The court appointees rushed to other groups that would sign papers. This created problems in the other groups, in that they were not financially fit and had a lack of meeting space to accommodate the larger group's members. A meeting of all groups that met in the building was held and all sides were heard. A satisfactory conclusion was arrived at by all groups.

Tradition Five: Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity, having but one primary purpose—carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers. From this Tradition, we as members of A.A. gather the unity that we require to remain sober. The very life of our Fellowship requires the preservation of this principle.

We ask: Who carries the message of recovery to the newcomer? We all can and must if we are to stay sober and remain a Fellowship. The Twelve and Twelve, on page 151, talks about the unique ability of each member to identify with, and bring recovery to, the newcomer. We have found the key to sobriety. This is our gift from God. Singleness of purpose is the great paradox of A.A.—that we can't keep the gift of sobriety unless we give it away. We also must remember that our primary purpose is to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers—Wet or Dry!

Tradition Six: Problems of money, property and authority may easily divert us from our primary spiritual aim. We think, therefore, that any considerable property of genuine use to A.A. should be separately incorporated and managed, thus dividing the material from the spiritual. An A.A. group, as such, should never go into business. Secondary aids to A.A., such as clubs or hospitals which require much property or administration, ought to be incorporated and so set apart that, if necessary, they can be freely discarded by the groups. Hence, such facilities ought not use the A.A. name. Their management should be the sole responsibility of those people who financially support them. For clubs, managers who are A.A. members are usually preferred. But hospitals, as well as other places of recuperation, should be well outside A.A., and medically supervised. While an A.A. group may cooperate with anyone, such cooperation ought never go so far as affiliation or endorsement, actual or implied.

An A.A. group can bind itself to no one.

We of Alcoholics Anonymous cannot be all things to all people, nor should we try. The problems of money seem to be a major concern of many members of our Fellowship, too much or too little. How soon do we forget that God will take care of us if we keep to our primary purpose. There are no such things as A.A. clubs, A.A. dances, A.A. half-way houses. We as individuals may be a dues-paying member of such entities, attend or support these types of functions, but we must remember that they are not Alcoholics Anonymous. As a member of A.A. I must remember that A.A. saved my life, and therefore, A.A. must come first. If I allow A.A.'s name to be compromised in any situation, I am not being responsible. I must remind myself that A.A. cooperates but does not affiliate with any outside entity. By using the committee systems we have in place in our Fellowship, we can inform outside entities of what Alcoholics Anonymous is and what it is not, what it can do and what it cannot do. This process is being accomplished, though sometimes slowly, by A.A. members who participate in the committees.

This is my program, and I must be responsible for keeping the name Alcoholics Anonymous from being smeared or used to benefit outside enterprises. We have the answer for alcoholism and we must keep the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous open for the newcomer suffering from the disease of alcoholism and looking for recovery. For that, I am responsible.

Russell Cook, Southeast Texas

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report was given by the treasurer of the General Service Board, who also serves as the chairperson of the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the Finance section of this Report.

Welcome to the meeting of money and spirituality. One of the problems with talking about A.A.'s finances is that we always wind up telling many of you more than you want to know and many others, less.

G.S.O. gets income from two sources: literature sales and contributions. Here's a simplified statement of income and expense. Last year, we had net sales of literature of \$9.3 million, the second down year in a row. It cost just under \$3 million to print and manufacture these books and pamphlets. We paid \$956,000 in royalties on the four books that Bill W. wrote. In addition, we paid \$834,000 for shipping and warehousing these books. In previous years, this shipping and warehousing expense has been included in combined operating expenses (down below). Our new accounting system lets us separate shipping and mailing for books from shipping and mailing for services and publishing administration. We think these new allocations give us a more accurate picture of A.A.'s finances. After subtracting these direct costs from sales (and adding in a small amount of interest), literature income before operating expenses was \$4.5 million.

Operating expenses in publishing were \$2.4 million, so we had net income from publishing of \$2.2 million. Operating expenses are things like salaries, rent, telephone and travel.

Contributions were \$3.8 million in 1993, down for the third consecutive year. We spent \$5.3 million on services to the Fellowship. The bottom line was a deficit of \$1.4 million in services. After adding in publishing net income, we had a \$710,000 profit at G.S.O., which was transferred to the Reserve Fund.

For those of you who have been reviewing our financial

reports through the years, this net service expense is higher than it was in 1992. This is not due to an increase in spending on services. It is because our new accounting system allows us to allocate more realistically expenses between publishing and service.

Now these are large numbers and, because they are large, it is easy to think they are incomprehensible, or to worry about perilous wealth and power, or to worry about keeping it simple. The reason these numbers are large is that A.A. is large. There are now 56,000 groups registered at G.S.O. for the U.S. and Canada. One way to bring these large numbers into focus is to describe them in more human terms than millions of dollars. Service spending last year amounted to \$94 per registered group. Contributions per group were \$68. If each group had contributed \$26 more in 1993—that is, 50 cents more per week—well, you get the picture. Contributions covered 72% of service expense, and literature income covered 28%.

The fact that contributions did not cover service expense is nothing new. That has been true for most of our history. Everyone in this room got sober at a time when book income was helping to carry the message. Bill Wilson wrote about the use of book profits to cover service expenses in 1962 when he wrote the Concepts. In Concept Twelve, Warranty Two, he wrote, "This set income to the groups and to A.A.'s General Services is actually the sum of a great many contributions which the book buyers make to the general welfare of Alcoholics Anonymous. The certain and continuous solvency of our world services rests squarely upon these contributions." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 66) So, Bill viewed book income as another form of contribution, consistent with the Seventh Tradition. Its level is ultimately set by the Fellowship through the service structure.

George Dorsey came up with another way of making our large numbers more approachable. Think of the publishing side of G.S.O. in terms of one big Big Book and see where the \$5.00 selling price goes. On average, 21 cents goes for discounts. It costs \$1.54 to manufacture; 49 cents goes to royalties, and 43 cents for shipping and warehousing. That leaves \$2.33 for G.S.O. \$1.22 of that goes for publishing office expense, leaving \$1.11. Last year 74 cents, or 15% of the \$5.00 sales price, went to support services to the Fellowship, and 37 cents went into the Reserve Fund.

Our new accounting system allows us to tell you better where A.A.'s money is spent. Last year's service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 43%; Public Information 4%; C.P.C. 6%; Treatment Facilities 2%; Correctional Facilities 4%; Loners and Internationalists 2%; Overseas Services 7%; the General Service Conference 14%; and 6% each on Regional Forums, Archives, and trustees' expenses.

An interesting fact here is that after allocating every expense we could to specific activities, we found that 41% of our total office expense goes to areas that support both publishing and services. These are internal support services like accounting, personnel, some data processing, office management, clerical pool, mailroom, and so forth, which publishing and services share. These expenses are allocated to specific activities in proportion to total direct expenses.

Next I want to talk about the Reserve Fund. Right now, the Reserve Fund amounts to \$8.7 million, which in our more human scale is \$156 per A.A. group. It represents 11.7 months of combined Grapevine and G.S.O. office expenses. As I said earlier, we changed our reporting in 1993 to exclude from office expense the cost of shipping and warehousing A.A. literature. This change affects the calculation of the number of months'

expenses in the Reserve Fund. Under the old accounting method, we would now have 10.7 months of operating expenses in the Reserve Fund. The Conference has set an upper limit of 12 months' expenses. Because we are close to the upper limit, under either accounting method, the General Service Board has approved the drawdown of up to \$170,000 of 1994's income from the Reserve Fund to meet a budgeted operating loss at G.S.O. In the past, the Reserve Fund has been used to meet unbudgeted deficits after they have occurred. This is the first time that we are aware of that an operating loss has been planned for. My own view is that as long as we are above 9 or 10 months expenses, we have a prudent reserve.

The proposed budget shows that operating expenses will exceed the total of literature income and contributions by \$168,900. This operating loss will be covered by an item called "Interest Drawdown from Reserve Fund." Net income after this drawdown is projected at zero, so we will have a *balanced budget*. This budget, which was designed to continue the current level of services without raising literature prices, was proposed by the A.A.W.S. Board and approved by the trustees' Finance



Committee and by the General Service Board. A.A.'s longtime auditor, Bud Flanagan, agreed that this was a proper use of the Reserve Fund and a legitimate way to avoid budgeting a deficit.

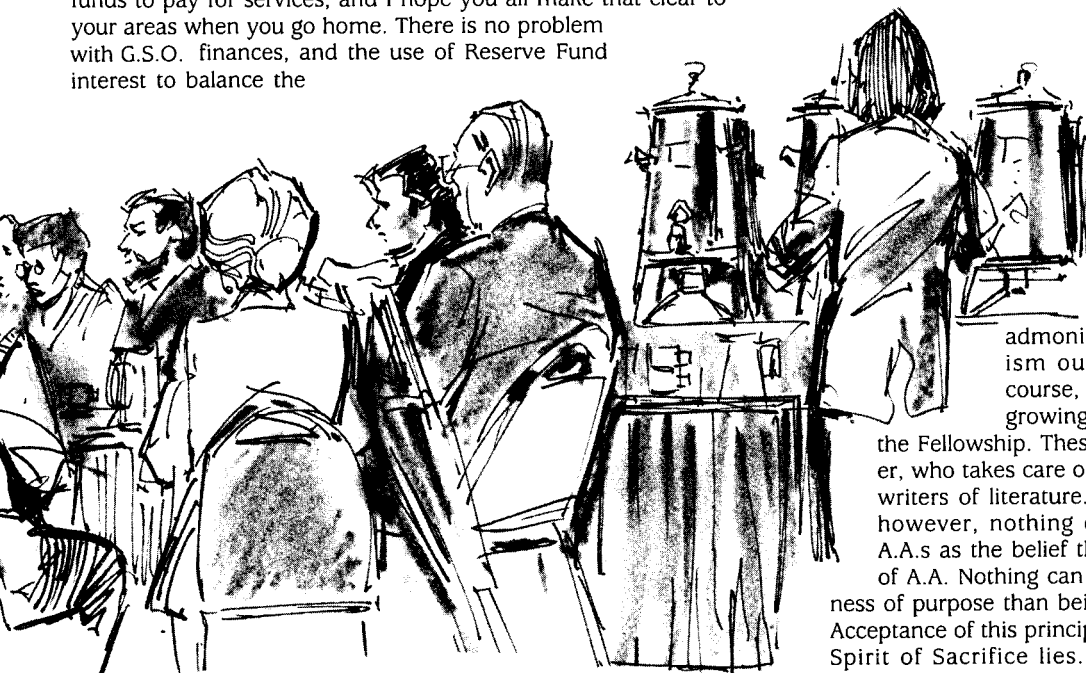
We are projecting a 9.3% decline in net literature sales and a 12.9% decline in gross profit from literature for 1994. Most of the decline in sales is estimated to come from outside A.A. entities. We think sales to A.A. entities have probably stabilized. Based on recent trends, we forecast that contributions will increase by 0.4%, essentially remaining flat after three down years. Operating expenses will increase by 4%, including a 2.6% increase in salaries.

There are two ways we could reduce the Reserve Fund to avoid going over the 12-month limit: we could spend more money, or we could reduce literature income. We will not increase spending above ordinary amounts unless the Fellowship clearly indicates a desire for new services. We must control spending, despite the presence of a large Reserve Fund, with the same sense of stewardship that we would exercise if the Reserve Fund were small. Our cost increases going forward will be modest. We thought it made sense to keep literature prices flat this year with the help of the Reserve Fund, rather than raise prices to fund an operating deficit in 1994, then reduce prices in 1995 or 1996 to avoid going over our upper limit for the Reserve Fund. Frequent changes in literature prices might be disruptive to the Fellowship. The interest to be drawn down would amount to one-third of the total interest for 1994. Except as a last resort, A.A.W.S. and the General Service Board

would be reluctant to increase literature prices to pay for services unless you, the Conference, clearly indicated we should do so. In fact, because we're bumping the ceiling with the Reserve Fund, if 1994 results start looking better than budgeted, it's very possible that we would lower literature prices later this year.

You might ask how the Reserve Fund got so healthy in the face of declining sales and contributions. First, it earns interest, so it grows by over 6% a year without transfers from G.S.O. Second, because G.S.O. has kept its costs under control so well, it has been able to make transfers to the Reserve Fund. For example, total operating and shipping expense dropped by \$883,000 between 1991 and 1993, a decline of 9.4%, which exceeded the decline in revenues.

I would summarize by saying that G.S.O. is financially strong. The emphasis we put on trying to attract a higher level of contributions is not because G.S.O. is in desperate need of funds to pay for services, and I hope you all make that clear to your areas when you go home. There is no problem with G.S.O. finances, and the use of Reserve Fund interest to balance the



budget should be viewed as a sign of strength, not weakness. I view the decline in contributions as a spiritual problem, not a financial one. Group contributions are contributions to A.A. unity. When you think about it, the First Tradition has almost as much to say about contributions as the Seventh does. As Bud Flanagan says, "Contributions are the mortar that hold A.A. together." The decline in book sales and the disappointing level of Grapevine circulation trouble me, not because of the loss of income but because if they're not sold they're not read, and that means some suffering alcoholic is not getting the message.

Gary Glynn
Class A trustee & treasurer, G.S.B.

THE SPIRIT OF SACRIFICE

Gay Garner, Southeast regional trustee, moderated the Monday evening presentations, which covered Traditions Seven through Twelve.

Traditions Seven, Eight and Nine

In the pioneering days of our Fellowship, members entered the

doors of A.A. in a state of complete bankruptcy: physically, mentally, emotionally, spiritually and, yes, financially. Today, more than fifty-eight years later, with personal bottoms higher than ever, the same is still true. While today's newcomer may not arrive completely broke, the woes of alcoholic-incurred debaucher financial insecurity are usually present. As the miracle of sobriety fills the member, prosperity begins to fill the pocket, bringing about a curious change in habit. The member, once a free spender, now becomes miserly toward the very entity that made the prosperity possible.

Alcoholics Anonymous ushered in a new revelation when the irresponsible became responsible. Aspiring to self-support, outside contributions declined. Even exorbitant donations from within, or those which might carry any obligation, are refused. So, wherein lies the spirituality of self-support? Is it in boastful gifts, or in quiet consistent contribution as the basket is passed

in meetings, or in diligent adherence to a birthday plan? Is it in showing favoritism to a particular service level—or is it in understanding and supporting the structure as a whole, so that the life-giving services we enjoy today will be here tomorrow? I pray for the strength that I might choose to follow the latter of these.

In close kinship to the Seventh Tradition we next admonish ourselves to keep professionalism out of our Twelfth Step work. Of course, this ideal is followed by the ever-growing need to provide for the needs of the Fellowship. These needs range from the paid worker, who takes care of the local clubhouse, to editors and writers of literature. This would seem simple enough; however, nothing evokes as much emotion among A.A.s as the belief that someone is making money out of A.A. Nothing can be more detrimental to our singleness of purpose than being paid for our Twelfth Step work. Acceptance of this principle leaves the question of where the Spirit of Sacrifice lies. Shall I seek even nonmonetary reward, or go quietly about the business of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers? Shall I profess expertise on alcoholism, recovery, medicine, sociology, psychology, spiritual matters, or even A.A. itself, or seek a greater understanding between what A.A. employees and other alcoholism agencies do? And, at each stage of understanding, will I pass on to others what I have learned? If this should require wisdom, then I pray for the wisdom to know the difference and choose the latter.

The idea that A.A. should strive for the least possible organization gave way to the principle that we ought never be organized. Considering the labyrinth of service boards and committees throughout the structure, this is difficult enough to understand ourselves, and sometimes impossible to explain to those not initiated in service. Of course, the intent "is that A.A. can never have an organized direction or government." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 118) A.A. has no membership rules or regulations. In fact, A.A. defies the essential elements of organizations everywhere. A.A. leaders derive no authority from any position, only responsibility. And with that responsibility comes sacrifice. Will I shy away from formal service, or seek to understand it and find my place to serve? If privileged to serve, will I attempt to drive by mandate, exerting power I don't have, or will I lead by example, exercising patience and humility in sharing my experi-

ence, strength and hope? Will I resist rotation, or freely sponsor into service those who might follow me? Will I fade into obscurity, or remain quietly available to be of use when needed? I pray for the serenity to accept and practice the latter.

If the first of the twelve principles give life to the member, then the second of the twelve may serve to prevent the demise of the whole, lest we go the way of those before us, such as the Washingtonians. We embrace these sacrifices because we must, and, better yet, because we want to. "A.A. is a power greater than any of us; it must go on living or else uncounted thousands of our kind will surely die. This we know." (*ibid.*, p. 288)

Ron Sharpe, North Carolina

Traditions Ten, Eleven and Twelve

My sincerest thanks for this opportunity to participate in our 44th General Service Conference by speaking on Traditions Ten, Eleven and Twelve, as they relate to our theme, Spirit of Sacrifice. Rather than attempt to redo or rework all the essays, experiences and thought processes that Bill and others put into our Traditions, and I am sure all of us have done just that at one time or another in our various workshops and presentations, I decided to try another approach. I have taken all the key words from our theme and the three Traditions; then I went to *Collins COBUILD English Language Dictionary*, a unique book, I might add. Listen, if you will, and let your mind wander through our writings as we hear these definitions from our theme and Traditions.

Spirit—1) The spirit in which you do something is the attitude you show when you are doing it; 2) If you enter into the spirit of something, you take part in it in an enthusiastic way; 3) Courage and determination that helps people survive in difficult times and to keep their way of life and their beliefs; 4) A set of ideas, beliefs and aims that is typical of people in similar circumstances.

Sacrifice—To sacrifice something that is vital or important means to give it up, often in order to obtain something for yourself or for someone else.

From the Traditions:

Tradition—A custom or belief that the people in a group or society have practiced or held for a long time. E.g.: We ought to consider briefly the history and traditions of the movement.

From Tradition Ten:

Controversy—is discussion and argument about an action or proposal that many people do not approve of.

Controversial—something that causes a lot of discussion and argument.

Anonymous—If someone remains anonymous when they do something or give something their name is not revealed because they do not wish it to be.

From Tradition Eleven:

Attraction—A particular feature which makes something or someone interesting or desirable.

Promotion—A publicity campaign that is intended to increase the sales or usage of something.

From Tradition Twelve:

Anonymity—is the state of not having your name or identity known, especially when you have done a particular thing. E.g.: A benefactor who insisted on anonymity.

Spiritual—relating to peoples' deepest thoughts and beliefs, rather than to their bodies and physical surroundings; the modern world's pursuit of material ends to the neglect of its spiritual

needs; your spiritual home is the place where you feel that you belong, because you have ideas and attitudes in common with the other people there.

Foundation—the foundation or foundations for something such as a belief or way of life is the basic idea, attitude, or experience on which that belief or way of life is built.

Principles—A general rule that you try to obey in the way that you behave or in the way you try to achieve something; from principles come values defined as the moral principles and beliefs that people think are important in life and tend to live their lives by. E.g.: the traditional values of civility and moderation.

Personalities—is your whole character and nature; are rather rude remarks referring to a person's character or appearance. E.g.: the fight never degenerates into personalities—there is no feeling of bitterness.

Maybe it's time to look more seriously at the simplicity of the message carried in the accepted definitions at the very core of our Fellowship. For anything to have true and long-lasting value there must be some type of sacrifice.

Think for a moment on the definitions I have just presented and reflect on our beginnings and experiences. The *Collins COBUILD English Language Dictionary* was produced by a computer over forty years after our Traditions were written. It appears to me there is some type of divine thread weaving us together.

Don Swallow, Eastern Ontario

RECORDS UPDATE

Monday evening Conference members listened to a report on G.S.O.'s records system.

In order to better serve the Fellowship, G.S.O. has initiated a project to upgrade the records system. This process is to encompass input, how the data comes in; throughput, how the data is handled; and output, the mailings. To accomplish this, a steering committee was formed, consisting of a Records person, a Data Processing person and two staff people.

During the analysis phase of the project, it became clear that in order to implement this upgrade successfully, it would be necessary to reassign Group Service numbers; changing from what we know as our "D numbers" (D#) to a plain vanilla sequential numbering system.

It was not a decision undertaken lightly, and its implementation will require a great deal of additional programming effort. The committee presented its plan to the A.A. staff, as well as a couple of delegates, in order to get additional input. It was agreed that the Fellowship should get advance notice and a simple explanation for the change. We are taking this opportunity to give the Fellowship notice through the service structure; additionally, there will be a small article in *Box 4-5-9*. Effective July the new numbers will be included on the quarterly statements and all mailing labels. The Directories scheduled for late summer will reflect the new D#s, as will the area diskettes.

Historically, the D#s were assigned based on the limitations of the original computer system. This system did not have a specific field for the state code (state was part of a longer, free form, city/state/zip field); nor did it have a field that allowed for distinguishing between individuals (Loners, Homers, etc.) and groups. Therefore, by assigning a letter ("D" for group, "L" for Loner, etc.) followed by a two-digit state code (developed alphabetically: 01 = Alabama, 02 = Alaska, etc.), followed by a five-digit number assigned sequentially, this method served us well



for the available equipment. However, as a method of identification its uses have fallen by the wayside. Primarily though, over the years, the integrity of the numbers has been severely compromised. A cursory investigation has revealed hundreds of duplicate numbers as well as hundreds, if not thousands, of numbers that are no longer representative of their original entities. This corruption was brought about by the limitations of the system in that, once assigned, a number could not be changed: once an "L", always an "L." Therefore, if you came on as a Loner and are now a delegate, your number is still indicative of a Loner. Any subsequent count of Loners, then, could not reveal an accurate statistic. Along these same lines, anyone who moves from one state to another will not have a service number reflecting the true geographic location. And, again, any statistical reports based on this would be erroneous. In essence, the original methodology, developed to aid identification, sorting, and geographic location, has been completely corrupted.

In arriving at this decision we have not been insensitive to the burden a new numbering system may place on area registrars when they update their records. However, because of the sheer volume that G.S.O. deals with, we're looking at a definitive increase in throughput speed (inputting and retrieval of area and group information).

For your information, area and district numbers will continue to appear to the right of the service number; therefore no associated functionality will be lost in the reissuing of numbers.

Lillianna Murphy
Information Services manager

THE SPIRIT OF SACRIFICE

Friday afternoon, the last two presentations addressing the

Conference theme were based on the farewell messages of A.A.'s co-founders. The session was moderated by Gerry Flegel, Western Canada regional trustee.

Bill's Last Message

I am happy to have this opportunity to add my voice to the 44th Annual Conference in this way. Our theme, Spirit of Sacrifice, is timely. As we approach the 21st century, it is interesting to think about how rapidly the world around us has changed over the last 59 years. Knowing about our past helps us in understanding the future, especially where Alcoholics Anonymous is concerned.

Almost 59 years ago the impossible became possible. What was considered impossible then, today is considered routine. A.A. has helped the world learn that recovery from alcoholism is within everyone's reach.

At the 1960 Conference, Bill shared an experience he and another early A.A. member had when A.A. was three years old. They visited Dr. Lawrence Kolb, who was the U.S. Surgeon General. Bill stated that the doctor said, "I wish you well. Even the sobriety of such a few is almost a miracle. The government knows that this is one of the greatest health problems we have, one of the greatest moral problems, one of the greatest spiritual problems. But we here have considered recovery of alcoholics so impossible that we have given up and have instead concluded that rehabilitation of narcotic addicts would be the easier job to tackle." Here we are, 56 years later, still relying on the principle of attracting, rather than soliciting, with around 90,000 groups in 144 countries and an estimated two million or more members. The impossible is possible.

Bill expressed in his last message an abstract notion that anonymity was responsible for our growth as a society and most vital to our continuous existence.

In *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* (p. 184) we find these words: "Because A.A.'s Twelve Traditions repeatedly ask us to give up personal desires for the common good, we realize that the sacrificial spirit—well symbolized by anonymity—is the foundation of them all. It is A.A.'s proven willingness to make these sacrifices that gives people their high confidence in our future."

This year's Conference theme has produced much discussion and many questions. Generally, the main question is, what do they *mean* by the Spirit of Sacrifice? The easy reply is: sacrificing a need for recognition, desire for power, prestige, personal distinction, craving to be praised, the ego that feeds on attention, etc. Instead, I would like to suggest: Let's not approach this theme with the question, what do they mean?

In Bill's last message he said, "My thoughts are much occupied these days with gratitude to our Fellowship and for the myriad blessings bestowed upon us by God's Grace." Grace—a special opportunity for right action and thinking.

Concept I tells us, "The A.A. groups today hold ultimate responsibility and final authority for our world services—those special elements of over-all service activity which make it possible for our society to function as a whole." (*A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 6)

It seems to me, since we assumed ultimate service authority and responsibility, that one of the greatest services an A.A. member can do is to try to carry the message of A.A. to alcoholics, and to practice the A.A. principles in all our affairs. It certainly seems to be more fitting that we place emphasis on what we mean by Spirit of Sacrifice.

There is an old adage which says "I don't believe what you say, because I see what you do."

Can we, in this changing world, continue to let go of a determination to prove a point, to seek glory, to be on top of the heap, to stand out above all others? It is as important today as before to let go of pride and vanity. There is a need for us to accept that each part of the structure is set up only to serve. Realizing that there are other points of view, that there are ways of doing things that are different from our own, and being able to be open to new ideas all fit within the Spirit of Sacrifice, in my view.

The realism that there is no need to brag about ourselves or how we do things better, but share our experience when the opportunity arises, is an act of humility.

Finally, it seems to me that Bill wanted to leave us with a reminder that the Spirit of Sacrifice is the central, single idea that should direct all of our actions and decisions when it is about the elements of helping the alcoholic.

It is a simple statement, and it is the core of all communication between A.A. and real people.

It is essential that trusted servants, A.A. members and friends of A.A. understand and internalize such a theme and base all communication and activities on it—forever remembering that Alcoholics Anonymous is a give program.

Hugo McKissic, Eastern Pennsylvania

Dr. Bob's Farewell Talk

As I read and reread Dr. Bob's farewell talk, I was struck by the simplicity of the program. Alcoholics Anonymous is no more or less than one drunk helping another drunk learn to stay sober one day at a time.

And as simple as that sounds, it requires sacrifices I was never able or willing to make prior to becoming a member of Alcoholics Anonymous. The sacrifices I see are more than the sacrifice of my time. It requires sacrificing my ego and self-will. It requires my sharing what was so freely given to me when I crawled through the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous.

I came to Alcoholics Anonymous as the last stop before institutionalization or death. But I would never have gotten here if someone had not been willing to take time out of their life to visit me and share their recovery, to show me there was a different way to live without the use and abuse of alcohol.

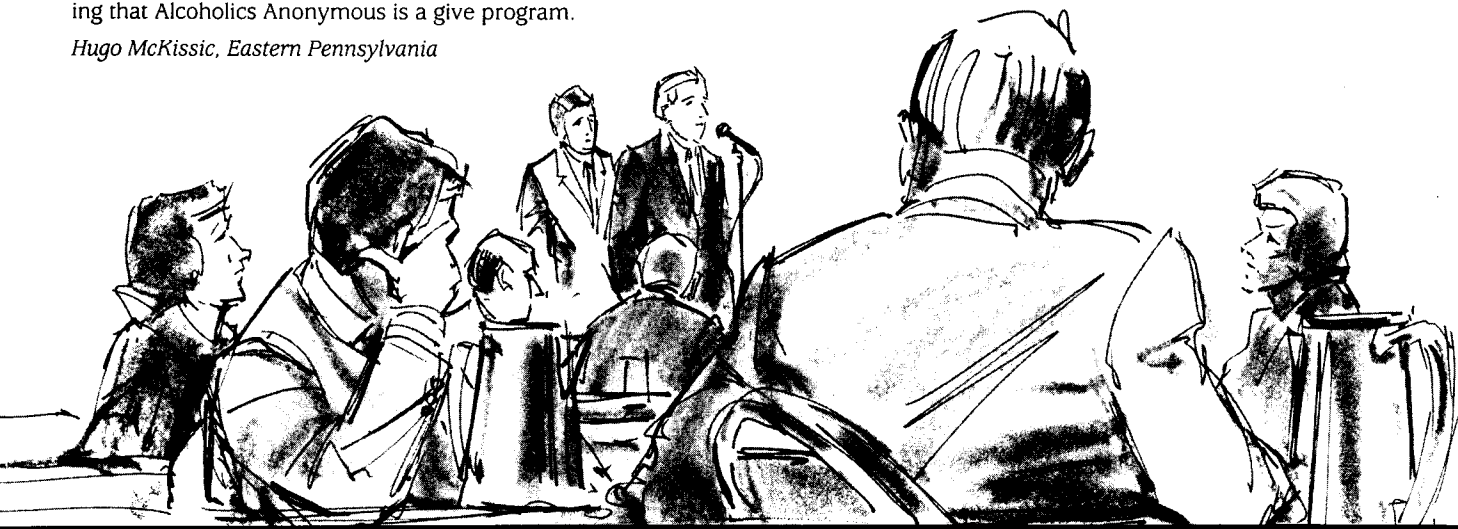
As I read Dr. Bob's talk and looked back over the years, I recalled the members of Alcoholics Anonymous who took me to meetings, even when I didn't want to go; who shared our history with me and explained time after time how the program worked, as well as why it worked. They listened to me before meetings, after meetings, and in the middle of the night when I could not sleep. They tolerated my anger and loved me out of it, as they loved me out of a lot of negative behavior. They held my hand and guided me until I was able to walk on my own. They showed me, by their actions in 1978, what Dr. Bob spoke about in 1950.

And what I learned through them is what I believe is the essence of Dr. Bob's message. This is a simple program, based on one drunk sharing with another what is found in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*. It worked when the book was written, was working when Dr. Bob spoke in 1950, continued to work in 1978 when I arrived, and is still working as we sit in this Conference in 1994.

It is a program based on a common problem, the inability to stop drinking and stay stopped. It is remembering I am not unique; that we all have the same problem. We all did the same thing. It is a program of action, requiring me to get out of self. A program which requires a deflation of my ego, a willingness to share, with another individual, what I was like, what happened, and what I am like today. It requires me to carry the message of recovery, one day at a time.

And it is a program of humility. It requires me to never forget what I was like when I came to Alcoholics Anonymous, how the people put in my life sacrificed so I would learn a new way of life, how many meetings they took me to, and how much time they spent explaining the program, never asking for anything in return. They made many sacrifices for me, not knowing whether or not I would stay until the "miracle" happened.

I want the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous to be open for all those yet to come. And it will be if I can remember to keep it





simple, to give of my time as well as myself, to be tolerant, patient, kind and understanding to all who ask for help, whether the "miracle" occurs in their lives or not, and to live and let live. I must remember this is a "we" program, not a "me" program, and I must never forget the guidance I had early in my journey of recovery.

The sacrifices Dr. Bob and Bill made to insure the success of Alcoholics Anonymous are the same sacrifices people I met early in recovery made to show me the program worked. And they are the same sacrifices I have to make to insure the future of Alcoholics Anonymous. For that, I am responsible!

Shaaron Johnson, Southeast Ohio

1995 INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

The final report of the Conference was an update on the plans for A.A.'s 60th Birthday celebration in San Diego, next July.

Imagine! In a little less than 15 months, we will meet in celebration of A.A.'s 60th Birthday at our International A.A. Convention. The sparkling city of San Diego, California, is the setting, A.A. Everywhere—Anywhere is the theme, and June 29 - July 2, 1995 are the dates—so mark your calendar!

Plans proceed apace to make the Convention a joyous event, jam-packed with meetings, meetings, meetings, panels, workshops, marathons, mini-marathons, and stadium events. We will kick off on Thursday evening, right outside the Convention Center, with a Harbor Block Party, all along the waterfront to Seaport Village and beyond.

At midnight on Thursday, two major marathon meetings get underway—one in English and one in Spanish—and run continuously until Sunday morning. And, for those who just have to dance, there's a dance right there at the Convention Center, and another just a walk away at the adjacent Hyatt Hotel, where you can join in with the young and young at heart.

Friday night at the Jack Murphy Stadium will mark the Opening Ceremonies, complete with the Parade of Flags of those countries represented at the Convention, and followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. Saturday we'll have an Oldtimers Stadium Meeting, and Sunday morning the customary Closing Meeting at the Stadium. Shuttle buses will be available to and from Jack Murphy Stadium events, the Convention Center, and any other Convention sites.

We are blessed to have the help of the local San Diego A.A. Host Committee, which is in the formation process right now, with chairperson Bobbie Coneen, as well as Gary Ulrici and Gail Nelson, at the helm. The A.A. Host Committee will perform a myriad of tasks, all designed to help make the many visitors to San Diego welcome and comfortable.

Registration/Housing forms for the Convention will go out around the world in late August 1994. Groups, delegates, central offices/intergroups and other G.S.O.s, all receive the forms, so as to better reach A.A.s who want to be there in 1995. Registering and assigning housing will begin six weeks after the completion of the worldwide mailing. Because thousands upon thousands of completed Registration/Housing forms will be returned simultaneously, housing will be assigned randomly, as closely as possible to the desired price range; it is the only way to be fair, regardless of the vagaries of mail delivery and return—from anywhere—across the street or across the world.

Dormitory housing will be available at San Diego universities, with budget package rates described on the Registration/Housing forms. The Registration/Housing form will also provide contact information for those seeking RV and campsite locations.

The registration fee for the International Convention will be \$65.00 for preregistration, and \$70.00 for on-site registration. Registration covers the entire cost of putting on the International Convention, which, in keeping with our Seventh Tradition and previous Conference Advisory Action, must be self-supporting. No group funds are used for this A.A. special event.

For the family members and loved ones that belong to Al-Anon or Alateen and will accompany us to San Diego, the Concourse Center downtown, as well as the adjacent Doubletree and U.S. Grant hotels, will offer daytime meetings, workshops, marathons and other events.

As Marco, our San Diego/Imperial Area delegate, and Larry Nelson, our trustee-at-large/U.S. who lives in San Diego, both know so well, from La Jolla, the jewel of the Pacific, to Tijuana, Mexico, just twenty-seven miles south of the border, all of the San Diego neighborhoods are beautiful and scenic in their own right—warmed by the sun and cooled by the sea breezes. And we know that many conventioners will take time out to visit San Diego's historic sites, to browse in the famed Old Town, to amble through Balboa or Mission Bay Parks, to go to the Zoo and Sea World, to visit Tijuana and Rosarito Beach in Mexico, to swim and surf along Pacific Beach, to fish at Ocean Beach, to sail in the San Diego Bay, and, of course, to eat ice cream and drink coffee at Seaport Village and Downtown—both just a stroll away from the Convention Center.

So, one day at a time, we are working toward an International Celebration of A.A.'s 60th Birthday that we trust will be a shining example of sharing, gratitude, beauty and the language of the heart—a beacon of hope for those to come, and a dynamic expression of sober joy and thanksgiving for our beloved A.A. Society.

Eileen Gatz, International Convention coordinator

A Labor of Love—and Service

Delegates often bring buttons, pins, or stickers from their state or province to trade with other delegates. Gene Benson (Oklahoma) brought 200 small needlepoint maps of Oklahoma, lovingly made by his wife Joan, also an A.A. member, over a period of several months as she sat in A.A. meetings.

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Last April, the General Service Conference exercised its collective conscience and confirmed the board suggestion that I serve again as your trusted servant. This is my second tour as a trustee and as a preface to a brief description of the board's activities for the past year, I would like to share some thoughts with you. You all have a tendency from time to time to thank nonalcoholic trustees who are serving with you, and those thanks are appreciated. I want you to know that I owe the Fellowship. You are all in the business of saving lives. You have saved some lives that are near and dear to me, including your own, and you should know that the life saving process you all are involved in has had an impact on my life. You have braced my patience and tolerance levels and have shown me, by example, a way of life which includes a form of discipline that leads to freedom. Your joy and happiness is contagious and has made my association with you so fulfilling. For these reasons, and many others, you have enriched my life, and I need to be with you.

This year, as has been the practice for several years, the chairpersons of the General Service Conference Committees were invited to the quarterly board weekend in January. The chairpersons attended sessions of the corresponding trustees' committees and were also invited to attend other meetings of the trustees, including the meeting of the board. The presence of the chairpersons at the January meetings of the trustees is part of the sharing process that brings us to this room today. This is a practice I heartily endorse; it offers another opportunity for the Conference process to continue.

The sharing that goes on among A.A. members, G.S.R.s, delegates and trustees at the Regional Forums reminds us that the Conference is in session throughout the year. There was an incredible aura of gratitude present at the Forums which took place in the United States and Canada in the last year. Over and over again we heard folks saying, "Let's talk about how best to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers." Many creative, imaginative, positive, optimistic and responsive people bring their committed strength to service in Alcoholics Anonymous. It is our challenge to work together in providing the opportunities for them to continue to carry our message worldwide.

One of the first items of new business on the General Service Board's agenda was a report made by the chairperson of A.A.W.S. that an immediate decision was required regarding a withdrawal from a lawsuit in California, and as a result, we contact all who have agreed to refrain from infringement of the circle and triangle logo to let them know of this decision. It was also agreed that we analyze the necessary steps involving modifying our position, including how to handle the use of the circle and triangle on Conference-approved literature, and prepare a statement to be reviewed by A.A.W.S. and distributed to those who may need to address this issue.

In an effort to review and report on board policy concerning the protection of our trademarks, service marks and copyrights, an Ad Hoc Committee was created. The committee met several

times and also in joint meetings with the A.A.W.S. Board's Service Committee, which had been working on the same topic and had presented its report to us in February. You have all received copies of their respective work product and it is evident, once again, that given the opportunity, our process works.

Sharing Sessions on Friday afternoons prior to board weekends have provided much insight and an opportunity to hear the wide variety of thoughts and feelings surrounding the topics of concern which come to us from the Fellowship.

The board received a letter from a group stating an intent to reprint our book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. The letter was referred to the copyright owners, A.A.W.S. Inc. The group was notified of our opposition and, in the interest of unity, they were urged not to proceed with such unauthorized action. As a postscript to that, the group has written notifying us that they will not pursue printing the book.

The members of the General Service Board travel all over the United States and Canada, attending meetings of areas, election assemblies, Regional Forums, board meetings and committee meetings—as well as planning meetings and subcommittee meetings. All of this activity has but one goal — carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to the alcoholic who still suffers. We trust and pray that working and sharing together will continue to make this possible.

Issues of controversy seem to have been overriding concerns this year. We hope this Conference will mark a turning toward the life-giving unity and spirituality which first brought us together. I pledge a renewed emphasis and attention to communication, leading to a trust which will allow us all to more effectively and constantly engage in that which Alcoholics Anonymous does best — help to save lives.

W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr., chairman

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. World Services, Inc., is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. It has the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and service literature, effected by G.S.O. The board met ten times in 1993 to: hear G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group service activity and progress on compliance with Conference and board recommendations; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish prices for literature and other materials; discuss publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A.s and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature, and address other matters as they arise.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors: currently, four are trustees, including two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; one is the G.S.O. general manager; and one is the staff coordinator. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are other G.S.O. staff members, the controller, assistant controller/business administrator, the services director, the publications director, director of human resources, and the secretary. In addition, a Grapevine staff member is usually present.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Publishing, which addresses reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; Finance and Administration, which concerns salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; Services, which addresses the needs of all service assignments; and Nominating. Long-range

planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole. For 1993, the following items of significance are noted:

Finance and Administration: The A.A.W.S. Board reviewed the results of operations at all meetings during the year, and: Met (as an audit committee) with the independent auditor to exchange information as a matter of procedure; authorized a transfer of funds not needed for working capital to the Reserve Fund; discussed and recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee, changes in the reporting format of the annual financial statements; and, through its Salary and Budget Committee, prepared, reviewed and recommended the 1994 G.S.O. budget to the trustees' Finance Committee. Management implemented a salary administration plan for G.S.O. staff, based on parity, as recommended by the 1992 General Service Conference.

At the recommendation of the A.A.W.S. Finance and Administration Committee, the board approved the following Resolutions:

Resolved:

The A.A.W.S. Finance Committee recommends that a portion of the 1994 interest earned by the General Service Board Reserve Fund (\$168,900) be used in the 1994 budget.

Resolved:

The A.A.W.S. Finance Committee recommends the adoption of the 1994 budget as presented.

Resolved:

The A.A.W.S. Board forwards both the above resolutions to the trustees' Finance Committee.

Services Committee: The recently formed Services Committee is discussing and exploring ways to improve the channels of communication between groups, areas, G.S.O. and staff, corporate boards, and the General Service Board. They prepared a statement regarding the protection of our remaining trademarks and copyrights, looked at guidelines to see how they are perceived, and are attempting to make various services we perform more visible, i.e., money awareness, etc.

The Services Committee is continuing to discuss the feasibility and need for a service piece and/or live-action voice-over video focusing on the activities of G.S.O. The goal is to communicate to the Fellowship how their support is translated into service and how G.S.O. extends the ability of each individual group to carry the message. If the committee elects to pursue this project, it would make a recommendation to the A.A.W.S. Board that this concept be forwarded to the trustees' Literature Committee for consideration and possible referral to the Conference Literature Committee.

Publications/Translations/Reprint Committee: During 1993, we sold a total of 1,740,804 books, a decline of (4.7%) or 87,380 units compared with 1992. A.A. purchases were nearly level with last year due in part to strong sales of the abridged pocket edition of the Big Book. A.A.s bought nearly 95,000 copies. Sales to non-A.A.s were (17%) under 1992. They bought 496,905 books, 103,435 fewer copies than in 1993.

The committee recommended that the Foreign Literature Assistance budget category be renamed Translations and Other Literature Assistance, so as to include translations originating in North America, such as Vietnamese, Persian and Native American languages. A report will be prepared on handling requests for Native American translations, especially in audio. New translations of Turkish and Czech items will be reflected in the 1994 budget.

Following the 1993 Conference, the board approved the recommendation of the Publications Committee to produce an abridged edition (soft-cover, sewn, no ribbon) of the Big Book,

to be priced at \$4.00.

During 1993, we granted permission/did not object to 84 requests to reprint from A.A. literature. Five requests were denied.

The following new publications and discount packages have been priced: Chinese Big Book, Persian Big Book, Hungarian Twelve and Twelve, Turkish Twelve Steps, Thai Big Book, Latvian Twelve and Twelve, Lithuanian *Living Sober*, "A Brief Guide to A.A." (recovery tape), "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" (Spanish), "It Happened to Alice" (Spanish), Anonymity Card (English and Spanish), new C.P.C. and P.I. Discount Packages—P-71, P-72, P-73, P-74. The Spanish translation "*Pass It On*" was repriced.

We declined a suggestion to put the Twelve Concepts on window shades as there has not been sufficient need or interest expressed.

The board has been discussing new approaches to pricing Spanish literature for several months, but no final decision has been reached.

The General Service Board, Great Britain, forwarded portions of a working draft of their new Service Handbook, which was preparing for submission to their General Service Conference. They asked for our comments on their proposed Twelve Concepts for Service — Great Britain. They propose to publish the original (long form) Twelve Concepts for Service U.S./Canada, without the essays, with a statement that they are copyrighted by and reprinted with the permission of A.A.W.S. This would be followed by Twelve Concepts for Service—Great Britain, containing a statement that they have been generally patterned after the Twelve Concepts for Service in the U.S./Canada. These will more accurately reflect the corporate and service structure of General Services, Great Britain, while retaining the basic principles. The A.A.W.S. Board expressed no objection with respect to how they are proceeding. We have suggested that they consider using a short introduction or preface on the history of the Concepts and the reasons for their adaptation for A.A. in Great Britain. They were receptive to all A.A.W.S. suggestions.

As the Hungarian translation of the Big Book is not going to be completed at the present time, the board approved that the \$10,000 earmarked for that project be made available for the Latvian translation of the Twelve and Twelve. This project is not to exceed \$10,000. Poland, who had initially requested financial assistance in the amount of \$8,000 to publish *Daily Reflections*, proudly informed us that they did not require financial help for this project.

Although the budgeting process for foreign literature appears to be "inexact," due to varying situations (a translation which has been budgeted does not arrive, while another one does, etc.), the Publishing Committee agreed that under the circumstances, assistance is adequately handled.

The board established a policy to limit translations of the Big Book to include only the basic text, and not the stories. It was felt that cultural differences would make identification with the stories difficult. Also, the countries would have the opportunity to develop their own stories. This would reduce our costs by about half.

We expanded our in-house type-setting activities by purchasing a complete desk top unit for our newsletters and pamphlets in both English and Spanish. We expect to realize savings of approximately \$20,000 by mid-year.

The board accepted the committee's recommendation that G.S.O. accept credit card payment (Visa and Master Card) for literature orders by mail or telephone, on a trial basis. We declined to recommend an 800 number specifically for inter-

group/central offices and area committees for literature orders, but will investigate an 800 number for all A.A. purchasers.

Two Guidelines will be discontinued — "Armed Services," and "On Current Usage of A.A. Directories."

Copyright and Trademark Matters: Following a special phone conference with the trademark attorney, Friday evening, April 23, 1993 (Conference week), the A.A.W.S. Board adopted a recommendation for submission to the General Service Board meeting the following day:

A.A.W.S., Inc., unanimously supports the following recommendations:

- That there be an orderly withdrawal, with deliberate speed, from the lawsuit in California.
- That we contact all who have agreed to refrain from infringement of the circle and triangle in the past to let them know of this decision at an appropriate time.
- That we analyze the necessary steps involving modifying our position, including how to handle the use of the circle and triangle on literature, and prepare a statement, to be reviewed by A.A.W.S., and distributed to those who may need to address this issue.

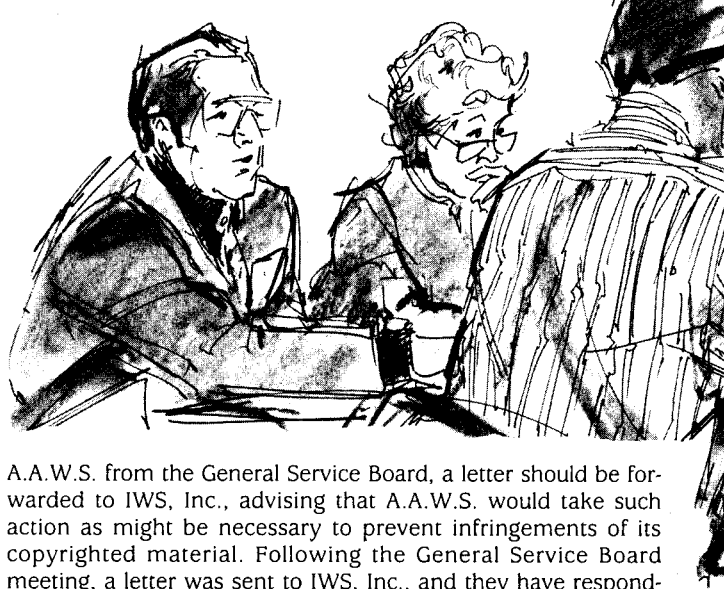
Following the May A.A.W.S. meeting, an executive session was held for the purpose of a conference call. In addition, the treasurer of the General Service Board, our attorney, and the chair of the General Service Board were present by phone. At the conclusion, the A.A.W.S. Board unanimously agreed to prepare a proposed additional statement regarding the circle and triangle, to be forwarded to the chair of the General Service Board for submission to all trustees.

An ad hoc committee of the General Service Board and the A.A.W.S. Services Committee were assigned the task of preparing a revised policy statement regarding trademarks and copyrights for presentation to the 1994 Conference. A draft of A.A.W.S. Policy on Identifying Marks was brought to a sharing session, called by Jim Estelle, on Friday, January 28, 1994. Invited to the discussion were the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors, Conference Committee chairpersons and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff. Also addressed were topics peripheral to litigation, including Intergroup World Services, Inc. (IWS).

The A.A.W.S. Services Committee met jointly with the ad hoc committee of the General Service Board in February 1994, at which time they discussed a policy statement with regard to trademark protection and copyrights. This was presented to, and accepted by, the A.A.W.S. Board to be presented to the Conference in April.

Intergroup World Services, Inc. (IWS): The board reviewed and approved for transmission to IWS, Inc. a letter from our attorney regarding IWS approaching New Zealand with an offer to print A.A. literature for them. The letter clarified that the Big Book is not in the public domain everywhere in the world. Further, it was stated that the Third Edition of the Big Book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, and all of A.A.W.S.'s other titles are protected by registered copyright in the United States. Also, their request to include the Twelve Traditions in their mini-Big Book was denied, as well as their request to reprint a Russian translation of the Big Book, as we have been supplying Russian A.A. with as many Big Books as they can use for several years now, at no charge.

The General Service Board received a letter from IWS, Inc., stating that they intended to publish *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, notwithstanding their knowledge that it was copyrighted by A.A.W.S. At the January board meeting, the board unanimously voted that following referral of the letter to



A.A.W.S. from the General Service Board, a letter should be forwarded to IWS, Inc., advising that A.A.W.S. would take such action as might be necessary to prevent infringements of its copyrighted material. Following the General Service Board meeting, a letter was sent to IWS, Inc., and they have responded that they will not publish a Twelve and Twelve at this time.

IWS, Inc. has now published a new mini-edition of the Big Book. This edition uses the title *ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS* on the cover. The board agreed that a letter go out from the General Service Office asking that they discontinue the use of the title *ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS*, and that they delete the language "The gray areas are not A.A. General Service Conference-approved" which appear on the copyright page of their book, as this may lead people to believe that the General Service Conference is in some way involved with this mini-edition. Also, it has been brought to our attention that IWS is soliciting mini-Big Book orders in Canada. The letter requested they discontinue the sale and distribution of the mini-edition in Canada. This is a violation of our Canadian copyright which is still in effect. It was suggested that a brief letter also be sent to delegates, alternate delegates, intergroup/central office managers, World Service Meeting delegates and overseas general service offices regarding our communications with IWS, Inc.

Mexico General Service Board: At the request of the General Service Board, Mexico, A.A.W.S. authorized a letter expressing no objection to the Mexican General Service Board taking action, as necessary, to prevent infringement of copyrighted literature in that country. The right to such action has been granted to the Mexican General Service Board under the terms of a licensing agreement given to them October 4, 1990.

International: George Dorsey and Danny Mooney attended a Regional Service Meeting in Obregon, Mexico, March 18-21. Over 3,000 were in attendance. Lois Fisher attended Uruguay's Second International Conference for Women in A.A., held September 11-12. There were more than 70 women in attendance from Argentina, Chile and Paraguay. Lois participated in a question and answer session with six members of their board.

George Dorsey attended the European Service Meeting (ESM) in Frankfurt, Germany, October 15-17. There were 39 attendees representing 21 countries. Some represented long-established general service boards, while others were from newly-formed service structures. There was some discussion on service structure issues, but the heavy emphasis was on carrying the message, countries assisting each other, and Traditions questions.

Staff member John Grant and John Kirwin, assistant controller, visited Cartagena, Colombia, the site of the 1994 World Service Meeting (WSM). They visited the hotel where the meeting will be held and found the accommodations to be very satisfactory.



Nominating: The committee interviewed three candidates to fill the vacancy for nontrustee/director, and a nominee was selected for submission to the trustees' Nominating Committee. The board approved the recommendation of the Nominating Committee for general service trustee to be forwarded to the trustees' Nominating Committee.

Regional Forums: A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff members coordinated and attended five Regional Forums in 1993: East Central, in Ft. Wayne, Indiana; Northeast, in Burlington, Vermont; West Central in St. Cloud, Minnesota; Southwest, in St. Louis, Missouri; and Special Forums in Charlottetown, P.E.I., Canada, and in Hawaii.

ICYPAA: The International Conference of Young People in A.A. was held in New York, May 28-31. With advance planning, 225 participants visited G.S.O. for tours. There was much interest and enthusiasm. Also, service workshops were held at ICYPAA with board and staff participation. All involved stressed the importance for A.A.'s future of young A.A. members participating in service.

Intergroup Seminar: The Seminar was held in Baltimore, Maryland, September 17-19, with G.S.O. staff and trustee/ director participation. Overall, the mood was warm and an increasing number of intergroups seem to be opening up communications with their area service structures. Attendees seemed very pleased with their relations with G.S.O. and very complimentary about improved service in fulfilling their orders. Vancouver was selected as the site for the 1994 Intergroup Seminar. The board passed a motion that the current chair of the A.A.W.S. Board act as the board's representative on the Intergroup Seminar Policy Committee.

Records Restructuring Committee: This committee was formed in order to evaluate the database structure currently employed for maintaining group and individual records.

Task Force: G.S.O. has been working to reduce duplicate mailings. The largest mailing in one issue of *Box 4-5-9* included a letter indicating how recipients may receive additional copies, if desired. The program also includes mailings for *About A.A.*, the Treatment Facilities Newsletter, and the Directories.

Distribution of Labels: Consistent with a 1993 Conference Advisory Action, we advised past recipients that we will discontinue providing mailing labels, and henceforth, will supply only those requested by delegates for groups in their area.

Data Processing Department: Bill Brennan, the manager of Special Projects, resigned after 18 years at G.S.O., and was replaced by Elaine Soroka. Since Records is so closely linked to the Data Processing operation, Elaine will report to Lillianna Murphy, who will be responsible to Tom Jasper with respect to all group matters.

In consideration of the increasingly important and effective role our Data Processing Department has played under Lillianna's supervision, she has been named manager of Information Services and will join our senior management team.

G.S.O. Staff: Past staff member Phyllis Masback returned to G.S.O. October 5, on a two-day-a-week basis. She is handling the Treatment Facilities assignment, plus attending board and Conference meetings.

Other Board Actions: Upon rotation of Harold Greene, Greg Muth and Jan Whitney, we welcomed three new directors: Jacques Filteau, Gerry Flegel, and Richard Roughton. Michael McPherson was appointed trustee/director on the A.A.W.S. Board, replacing John Quinn.

The board adopted the following resolution: "RESOLVED, that the Board herewith adopts as its own the policy previously established by management, viz.: 'Loans by the Corporation to its employees are not permissible.'"

The annual job review with the general manager was conducted on March 19, with Ann Bruning and Michael McPherson. George Dorsey was thanked for a job well done.

At the March 1994 A.A.W.S. meeting, the board heard a presentation given by Lillianna Murphy on the status of computerization in the office.

At the suggestion of a trustee director, a sharing session was held on March 18, 1994, on issues of corporate poverty, and support for and changing needs of group services. No decisions were reached, but the sharing resulted in several ideas for further consideration.

Ann Bruning, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: Our committee met three times since the 43rd General Service Conference. After 21 years of service to the Archives Committee, George Gordon, the committee's first chairman, turned in his magnifying glass and retired to a quietly private life in the hills of Connecticut. His contributions have been many and his gentle guidance will be missed.

Last fall we began sharing, via the Group Information sheet, the date that each group was first listed at G.S.O.; a date that may be essentially the group's "birthday." In some cases we have needed to ask the local archivists to help us uncover the correct date. When completed we will have the capacity to furnish areas with printouts showing group growth in chronological order, and therefore have an indication of how A.A. spread throughout the U.S. and Canada.

In the second phase of the "Gathering of Experience" project, we invited the 132 surviving Conference members of Panels 11 through 20 to share their memories of the background settings of important Conference Actions. Two dozen have responded, and the result is a wonderful collection of anecdotes and human

interest material to flesh out the starkness of individual Conference Actions. These returns will be made available to researchers for future histories.

In response to many requests, a suggested guide has been developed to clarify the disposition of the ownership of area archival property. The statement suggests methods for avoiding problems and directs local autonomous entities to consult a nearby lawyer familiar with the specific requirements within that state/province. The Ownership statement will be included in the next printing of *The Archival Handbook*.

Considerable creative energy was applied by the committee to the subject of improved physical security and facilitation of access to the Archives through the use of a scanner and specialized computer software. Plans were presented for a proposed system and this will be further refined by G.S.O.'s Information Services Department for possible procurement during 1994. This undertaking will require much time and care since much of our collection is in a very fragile condition.

John King, chairperson

Archivist's report: A great many contributions have arrived at G.S.O. Archives in the past year. Among these were: a vast amount of material from the Virginia Area Archives, including a large number of group histories and an array of oral histories of oldtimers; material from George S. —sole surviving member from Panel 1 of the General Service Conference, who continues to be a major benefactor— who provided an account of A.A.'s early growth in Wisconsin and a detailed personal report on the Samaritan Treatment as experienced in the 1930s; eight printings of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* contributed by George T. —which were sorely needed to complete a full second set; *50 Years of A.A. in Ontario*, prepared and presented by that Area Archives Committee; and a *History of A.A. in Northern Wisconsin and Upper Peninsula of Michigan*, a work of love delivered by John H.

As we complete our second year in our new location on Riverside Drive, what had seemed, in the early spring of 1992, to be a large and generous suite for our collection is beginning to feel a trifle "tight" as group and area historical files fill our shelving capacity. It is hoped that the procurement of a scanner/computer system will allow a reduction in the need to have original documents on-site for researchers, thus freeing up some precious shelf space.

Our move north to the Columbia University/Barnard College neighborhood doesn't appear to have hurt the number of A.A.s and other visitors who have come by G.S.O. to look us over. In fact, they seem to have increased. Very often these messengers can leave a poignant thought that echoes long after they have departed. One such visitor from Canada left the following reputed quote from Bill W. ringing in our ears (in the hope that we could hunt down the specific origin thereof): "A.A. is not a success story; rather, it is a chronicle of our colossal human failure turned to usefulness by the divine alchemy of a loving God."

We in Archives rejoice at being of some usefulness by serving these chroniclers of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Frank Mauser, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 1993 General Service Conference. During that period we reviewed the 1993 Advisory Actions pertaining to the General Service Conference and approved the theme for the 44th

General Service Conference, "Spirit of Sacrifice."

The committee recommended that at the 1994 Conference there be a half-day sharing session, Wednesday, April 20, 9:00 a.m. - 12:15 p.m., and that there would be three suggested topics and sharing on concerns other than the business of the Conference. The joint Trustees/Conference Committee meetings were moved to Sunday afternoon and Conference Committee meetings will be held on Monday and Tuesday mornings. An early delegate registration will be available on Saturday, April 16, from 7:30 - 8:00 p.m. The committee recommended that the daily Conference sessions end at 9:00 p.m. so as not to exhaust Conference members. The committee recommended that the chairman of the General Service Board create an ad hoc committee to review and report on our policy concerning the protection of our trademarks, service marks and copyrights. This report will be presented to the 1994 Conference.

The committee reviewed proposed agenda items submitted for the 1994 Conference and referred them, when appropriate, to the standing Conference Committee, A.A.W.S. Board or the General Service Board Ad Hoc Committee on Trademarks. All proposed agenda items were addressed and responded to, including those not placed on the agenda because of recent Conference discussion. We also reviewed and finalized the Conference agenda and assigned participants for the various presentations.

Marc Pineau, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the contact for General Service Conference members. The coordinator's desk also serves all of the area and district committee members of the 91 areas throughout the United States and Canada, as well as being the contact for past delegates.

The General Service Conference, created in 1951 by our co-founders Dr. Bob S. and Bill W., became, in July of 1955, the "guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetuator of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successor of its co-founders, Dr. Bob and Bill."

The General Service Conference is a year-long process and the Conference coordinator is actively involved with Conference members in a cooperative effort to make the annual meeting of the Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship.

All A.A. members are asked, through the area committees, to submit items for the Conference to address. These are brought to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for consideration and referral to the appropriate committee. The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme and presentation/discussion and workshop topics, which are then reviewed for selection by the Conference Agenda Committee and recommended to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for approval.
- Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Corresponding regularly with delegates, alternate delegates and all area and district committee members throughout the year.
- Working with the general manager and G.S.O. staff in planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and all material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.
- Reviewing all area and district correspondence, as well as minutes and reports received from area and district committees.

Valerie O'Neill



COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community met three times since the last Conference. Our work is based on the Twelfth Step, Twelve Traditions, and Twelve Concepts for World Service and focused on considerations and recommendations of the General Service Conference and the General Service Board.

The following Advisory Actions of the 1993 General Service Conference were implemented: The changes recommended for page 1 of "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community" have been implemented; and, the phrase "A.A. and Alcoholism" has replaced the heading "A.A.'s Position in the Field of Alcoholism" in all C.P.C. pamphlets, and the suggested change is being applied to other literature at reprinting.

The subcommittee on Literature Review undertook to determine the original intent of "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics," and researched the scope, focus and current need for the pamphlet, as suggested by the 1993 Conference C.P.C. Committee. Subsequently, the trustees' C.P.C. Committee recommended that the changes suggested to the 1993 Conference C.P.C. Committee for "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics" will best serve local C.P.C. committees, as well as be useful for professionals interested in A.A., and forwarded this information to the Conference committee for their consideration.

The subcommittee for Policy on A.A. Exhibits at Meetings of Professional Associations is reviewing the background and history of exhibits in an effort to respond to requests from some members of the Conference C.P.C. Committee. The trustees' committee feels that the practice of exhibiting at meetings/conferences of organizations whose membership and attendance reflect a professional involvement with practicing alcoholics is sound and in keeping with A.A.'s Traditions.

The committee recognized that the panel designs for the A.A. exhibits needed to be updated, and established a subcommittee to bring forward suggestions. The Conference C.P.C. Committee was invited to offer ideas. The designs selected were the Preamble, If You Are a Professional (circles of help) and the Man on the Bed portrait. This project will be implemented this year.

Two intergroups suggested that the pamphlet "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" be reviewed to see if the con-

tent could be revised to better describe how we cooperate with the employer's efforts to help alcoholic employees. A subcommittee was established to review the pamphlet, and their work continues.

The 1993 schedule of 74 exhibits was completed successfully, and members of the committee and/or local C.P.C. chairpersons made presentations to eight professional gatherings. The 1994 schedule for A.A. exhibits is moving forward with the full cooperation of local C.P.C. committees. Plans for presentations on A.A. at three conferences of professionals are completed, with planning underway for others later in the year.

The committee is excited about increasing reports of local C.P.C. committees' contacts with professional groups and individuals. We continue to communicate requests from professionals that come to G.S.O. to the committee serving their locale in order that the inquiry may receive personal attention.

Topics for *About A.A.* ranged from "A Health Care Professional Looks at A.A." to "A.A.'s Continued Link with the Professional Community" through the election of two new nonalcoholic trustees. The most recent issue (Winter 1993-94) included the personal recollections of an A.A. member, who, when in trouble with the law for driving drunk, found A.A. through the guidance of his attorney and the judge hearing his case. That issue also reported on the splendid cooperation with local police by A.A.s in Oregon, and the latest A.A. Membership Survey.

We discussed using the Grapevine in conjunction with A.A. literature for A.A. exhibits. The Grapevine staff cooperated with the decision to use Grapevine magazines, when practical.

John Hartley Smith, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The purpose of the Cooperation With the Professional Community assignment is to provide A.A. information to individuals and groups who may be in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic in their professional capacities.

The C.P.C. staff person serves as a link to all C.P.C. committees in Canada and the U.S., and shares background and other information with A.A.s overseas upon request. Currently, there are more than 420 area, district and intergroup/central office C.P.C. committees. We communicate with these committees through the chairperson. When we learn of a new C.P.C. chairperson, he or she is sent a letter of welcome and background information. New area C.P.C. chairpersons receive a C.P.C. Workbook, which is available to all C.P.C. people through the literature catalog.

The C.P.C. Discount Packages were revised several months ago to increase the number of pieces in each category. A committee may now purchase 2,200 pamphlets and flyers for a net cost of \$89.68; smaller packages are also available.

The P.I. staff person and other staff people worked with us to revise the "no charge" packet of literature sent to all nonmembers who fill out a "P.I. label," usually offered at health fairs and meetings of professional groups. The new C.P.C./P.I. Packet includes sample literature and a friendly, informative letter.

Over the past year, we have received hundreds of inquiries from nurses, physicians, attorneys, teachers, members of the clergy, social workers, alcoholism counselors, professionals working with mentally or physically disadvantaged people, employers, therapists, organizations involved in the treatment or prevention of alcohol abuse, court officials and others. Each professional received a personal response and was put in touch with the local C.P.C. committee chairperson.

Periodically, C.P.C. news is carried in *Box 4-5-9. About A.A.* is published and mailed two or three times a year to professionals who ask to be on this mailing list, now numbering over 17,000.

A growing number of local C.P.C. committees are purchasing portable exhibits for use at these national meetings, as well as for A.A. exhibits at local or statewide events sponsored by professional organizations. Often the C.P.C., P.I., Treatment and Correctional Facilities Committees will share use of a portable exhibit.

The success of any phase of cooperating with the professional community is measured the same way as any other service: Are we doing all we can to see that the A.A. message is available to everyone, and do we strive to see that the information conveyed about A.A. is accurate and easy to understand?

Joanie Moncrief

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend actions that support carrying the A.A. message to those alcoholics confined in correctional facilities. One of the tools for this purpose is distribution of literature. We have realized that our budget simply will not allow responding to all requests for literature and have made efforts to ask area Correctional Facilities committees to assume much of the responsibility for determining local literature needs.

During the year, the committee completed two items for consideration of the 1994 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee. The first was a report on proposed changes in the pamphlets "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" and "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators," as requested by the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee last year. The second was suggested guidelines for making presentations to inmates and correctional professionals, to be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook at its next printing.

At our January meeting we discussed some long-range goals for correctional work. These included: To have an A.A. meeting in every correctional facility, including juvenile detention centers in the United States and Canada; to identify the outside A.A. sponsor and staff contact for each facility; to find more A.A. members to go into prisons; to provide more and better information about A.A. to prison staff and administrators; to cooperate and communicate with other A.A. service committees; to

seek outside, male A.A. members who are willing to correspond with inmates to join the Corrections Correspondence Service.

John N. Chappel, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment is responsible for carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous to those alcoholics confined in correctional institutions.

This assignment receives an average of 250 letters a month from inmates, some asking for names of outside A.A. members with whom to correspond, or for help in making contact with A.A. upon release. We try to facilitate many of these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. Many of the requests have been for Big Books to use in substance abuse classes. We respond that we can give quantity discounts to the administration if they are buying material. We also ask area Correctional Facilities committees to help determine literature needs for "inside" A.A. groups. Even with these reservations, we did send out 15,650 units of complimentary literature in 1993 at a cost of \$6,350.

The Corrections Correspondence Service is coordinated by this desk, and we are concerned about the continuing need for outside A.A. members to correspond with inmates. We have offered this service for years but we currently have a waiting list of more than 150 inmates who have not been "hooked up" with outside members. On the other hand, area Correctional Facilities chairpersons have become more involved in helping us to find volunteers, for which we are grateful.

As the prison population expands and alcohol-related crimes continue to increase, the General Service Board and Conference and local Correctional Facilities committees are truly on the front lines of carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics who are still suffering.

Richard Bush

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: Both G.S.O. and A.A. Grapevine were able to lower their costs to offset at least part of the decline in revenues. Because of good cost controls and the strong position of the Reserve Fund, G.S.O. continues to be in good financial shape, despite the weakness of sales and contributions. Contributions, sales of literature, and circulation at the A.A. Grapevine were weak in 1993, continuing the trend of the past three years.

Contributions in 1993 were \$3,808,700, down 7.8% compared with 1992; literature sales continued to fall for the fourth consecutive year. Unit sales to A.A. entities were flat, while sales outside of A.A. fell 17 percent. Overall literature sales were down 5.2%, to \$9,314,770. A.A.W.S. sold 98,980 copies of the abridged pocket edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* in 1993 for total sales of \$343,830. This edition was not available in 1992. Total gross margin from literature fell 4.7% to \$5,359,260. Total G.S.O. revenues, that is gross profit from literature sales plus contributions, fell 6.3% to \$8,341,300, a decline of \$563,300 from 1992 (utilizing the revised report presentation). Total operating expenses were under excellent control and declined by \$469,900 from 1992, offsetting 83% of the decline in revenues. Net income for the year was \$710,520, compared with a net loss of \$1,401,050 in 1992. The loss in 1992 included \$2,204,930 of office construction and duplicate rent expense related to the move to 475 Riverside Drive. Excluding these nonrecurring expenses, G.S.O. would have had net income of

\$803,880 in 1992. Compared to 1992 operating income, 1993 net income was down 11 percent. Net sales were 0.7% and contributions were 4.75% below the 1993 budget. Because costs were considerably better than budgeted, net income exceeded the 1993 budget of \$231,700 by \$478,000.

The costs of providing services was \$5,258,900 in 1993. This amount exceeded contributions by \$1,447,500, a difference that was made up by literature profits. New accounting procedures and reporting formats were implemented in 1993. Under the former accounting method, services would have been shown as costing \$4,871,770. The difference between these two numbers, \$387,000, would have been charged to publishing under the old method. The new method presents a better picture of how much services and publishing actually cost because costs are allocated more accurately.

The G.S.O. budget for 1994 was prepared based on the assumption that literature sales decline by 9.3%, with most of the decline coming from outside A.A. entities. Gross margin from literature have been budgeted to decline by 11.3 percent. Contributions are expected to rise 0.4% (essentially flat). Both projections take recent trends into account. Total revenue will likely decline by 6.9% to \$7,768,900, while operating costs are budgeted to rise by 4%, including a 2.6% increase in salary expense. The budget shows an operating deficit of \$168,900, and this deficit will be offset by downstreaming \$168,900 of interest income from the Reserve Fund to G.S.O. to balance the budget. The 1994 budget will allow G.S.O. to maintain the current level of services without raising literature prices.

Reserve Fund assets equaled \$9,163,930 at the end of 1993, \$1,147,025 of which was held for the account of the A.A. Grapevine for subscription liabilities, leaving \$7,942,970 as the principal amount. The Reserve Fund earned \$506,440 in 1993, net of the A.A. Grapevine's share and received transfers of \$600,000 from A.A.W.S. and \$115,000 from the A.A. Grapevine. After transfers to the Reserve Fund of 1993's net income of \$700,000 from A.A.W.S. and \$80,500 from the A.A. Grapevine, the Reserve Fund amounts to 11.8 months' combined operating expenses. Under the previous method of calculating the number of months expenses, which has been used since 1977, the Reserve Fund equals 10.7 months' expenses. The difference between the two methods is that the new one excludes direct shipping and warehousing costs from operating expenses, while the old method includes them. With the old accounting system, it was impractical to exclude direct shipping and warehousing from other expenses. Under either accounting method the Reserve Fund is healthy.

Weak magazine sales at the A.A. Grapevine were offset by strong income from magazine-related items. Paid circulation dropped from 123,100 at the start of the year to 121,400 at end, a decline of 1.4 percent. Gross profit on the magazine dropped by 4.6%, or \$44,815, to \$931,410. Other publishing income rose 14.4% to \$339,815. Total gross profit was down 0.2% to \$1,271,315. Total costs and expenses rose by \$39,550, or 3.2% to \$1,285,970. The A.A. Grapevine lost \$14,655 from operations, which was more than offset by interest income of \$82,650. Net income was \$67,990. Last year, income from operations amounted to \$26,855 and interest income, \$89,150, for net income of \$116,000.

Compared with its 1993 budget, the A.A. Grapevine's magazine income was \$26,650 below budget because of lower circulation. Other publishing income was \$16,340 below budget; costs and expenses were \$44,270 below budget. Since costs were more under budget than magazine and other publishing income, net income was \$33,100 higher than budgeted.

For 1994, the A.A. Grapevine budget assumes average circula-

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1994

	Groups	Members
United States	50,541	1,134,500
Canada	5,287	96,500
Correctional facilities	2,137	52,182 ¹
Internationalists		170
Lone members		369
Total	57,965	1,283,721
Outside U.S. & Canada	32,190	778,659 ²
Total	90,155	2,062,380

1. U.S. and Canada only.

2. G.S.O. has records for 40 foreign G.S.O.s, as well as individual groups in 104 countries that do not have a general service office. We attempt to contact all general service offices outside the U.S. and Canada annually. Groups are contacted in countries where there is no G.S.O. Last year, of the 40 foreign G.S.O.s, 22 responded with updated figures. Of the 18 remaining foreign G.S.O.s, figures used for 13 of them are from their last previous response, while 5 have not forwarded any membership figures. Since we cannot substantiate the international figures, no attempt is made to estimate membership figures for the countries not responding.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

tion rises by 0.9% to 123,000. Magazine gross profit is expected to drop by 3%, due to higher production costs largely attributable to the double issue in June which will celebrate the Grapevine's 50th anniversary. Other publishing income is expected to drop 3.2 percent. Total magazine and other publishing gross profit will drop 3% to \$1,234,100; total costs and expenses will rise by 1.8% to \$1,309,600. The Grapevine's loss from operations will increase to \$75,500 from \$14,660 in 1993. After projected interest income of \$82,600, 1994 net income will be \$7,100.

Gary Glynn, chairperson

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: The three General Sharing Sessions since the last General Service Conference discussed issues of specific interest to the board and the Fellowship.

"A.A. Unity" was the topic for the August 1993 session, reflecting on how, by a natural progression, taking our inventory, and thus renewing our focus on self-sacrifice, serves to foster unity.

The first presenter posed the question, "Is unity important to me as an individual member of A.A.?", and shared how her understanding of the need for unity in and beyond the group

grew slowly, as her group members helped her to understand that all the Traditions concern unity. "Our unity depends on our needing each other, the oldtimer and the newcomer, each practicing humility and tolerance to the best of our abilities.... If we stay openminded, we learn from each other and we grow," she said.

The second speaker, citing Bill's description of unity as "...an incredible sensation of oneness," went on to say, "One antonym for unity is multiplicity, and multiplicity certainly suggests my character before finding A.A. I had a thousand ideas on any subject, and was happy to expound my theories on the slightest suggestion." However, in order to live one day at a time, he later came to accept the unifying ideals of A.A., and realized that "A.A. unity is an inside job, beginning inside the individual member — working outward to the group and to the Fellowship."

In the discussion that followed, many ideas on how best to foster and attain unity were exchanged: focusing on our primary purpose; becoming more honest, open and willing to serve; respecting others' viewpoints, and bowing to the informed group conscience; maintaining the delicate balance between conformity and autonomy; looking to our A.A. literature for guidance; heightening our awareness that the unity we have today was built on the sacrifices of many dedicated and anonymous A.A. members; striving for greater self-sacrifice as a daily practice. It was remarked that, with humility and love, we can stay unified, and thus be better able to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

During the July board weekend, Jim Estelle had announced the formation of a group to study Corporate Board Relationships, and requested that the group make a presentation at the October Sharing Session. The group met in September and discussed a number of problems, including communication, structural relationships, areas of responsibility and expectations of the General Service Office, and the need for the best possible communications at this time.

"Are there problems with our present structure?" "Is it time for a structure change?" A.A.W.S. chair Ann Bruning asked. "Does the answer to any real or perceived difficulties require so drastic an action? Would a structural change of any sort work for the good of A.A. as a whole? At this time, I see no reason for a

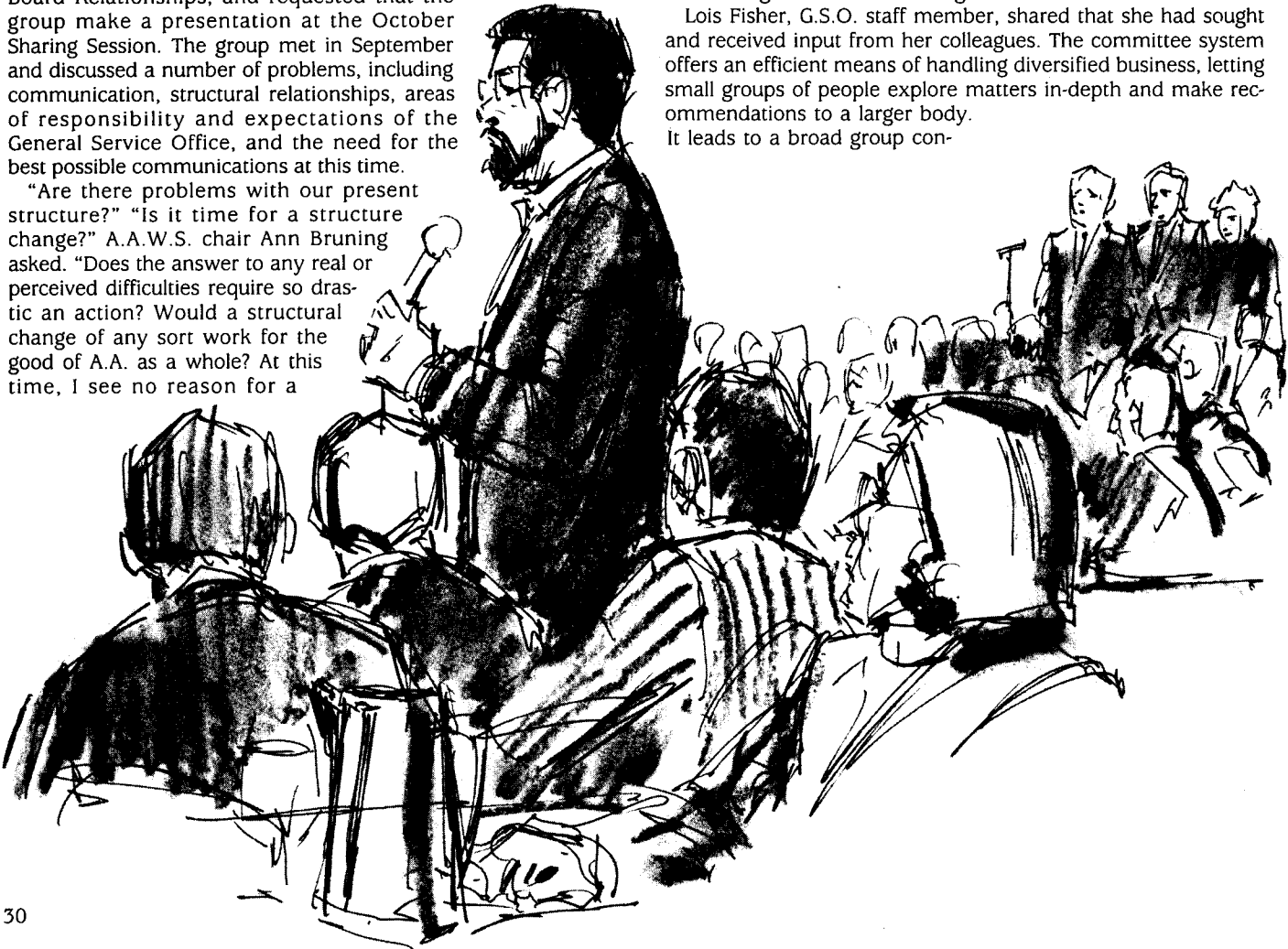
structure change, since whatever perceived difficulties we have can be handled with love and action. In the present structure, any inefficiencies are tested by Alcoholics Anonymous' adherence to tradition, which is truly a blessing to our Fellowship."

Grapevine chair Jake Ham began by proposing the incorporation of the General Service Office as a third wholly-owned entity of the General Service Board. He continued: "Our inventories, taken as a result of the theme of the 1993 General Service Conference, 'A.A. Takes Its Inventory — the General Service Conference Structure,' seem to have one common thread running through them, and that is communication or the lack thereof."

Sharing from those present included the following: The Higher Power and circumstances dictated this sharing session, following up yesterday's focus on unity with today's theme of trust. How can we, by precept and example, represent unity to the Fellowship? Interdependency of units at G.S.O. makes it impossible to separate into two corporations — both publishing and services are distinct and interdependent.

In January the topic was "The Committee System." Marc Pineau, Eastern Canada regional trustee, pointed out that at all levels of service the committee members are elected by A.A. members. He reviewed the flow chart of Conference Advisory Actions to appreciate how many Conference committees there are and how many corresponding trustees' committees have been formed over the years. The "legislative power" is found in members, groups, districts, areas and the Conference, he said. They make the decisions. He also noted that in the past ten years, less than 20% of Advisory Actions from Conference T.F., C.P.C., P.I. and C.F. Committees have had to do with carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.

Lois Fisher, G.S.O. staff member, shared that she had sought and received input from her colleagues. The committee system offers an efficient means of handling diversified business, letting small groups of people explore matters in-depth and make recommendations to a larger body. It leads to a broad group con-



science which is healthy and good for A.A. Diverse opinions from two extremes keep us in the middle where we need to be. Are all committees necessary or could some be combined? Are new committees needed to meet current needs? The unity of A.A. is the most cherished quality our society has. Our lives, the lives of all to come, depend squarely upon it. Without unity, the heart of A.A. would cease to beat; our world arteries would no longer carry the life-giving grace of God.

Burke Dykes, delegate from the state of Washington, provided a delegate's point of view. Burke asked, "The committee system is efficient, but is it effective? Is it effective in involving the A.A. groups in the process that started in 1955 at St. Louis? Does the system give the groups a sense of their responsibility? Or could we possibly have drawn away from the groups in our quest for efficiency?" If there is a flaw in our committee system, it is in the difficulty we occasionally seem to have in balancing Bill's Concepts with our Second Tradition.

Mike McPherson, general service trustee, started his sharing with an observation: "We drunks know that we constantly remind newcomers and ourselves that we have to change — some even say that if we don't change we will surely drink again. But when it comes to looking at changing the way A.A. operates — even suggesting that we discuss the possibility of changing — all sorts of near violent reactions occur." How does this relate to the committee system? Mike suggested that the current system is too cumbersome, is too costly, and very often does not achieve the desired results. He suggested that without trust it makes absolutely no difference whether we keep the current system, throw it out, or simply modify it.

Those assembled shared: we all struggle with how best to do what we are supposed to do (once we figure out what that is); are we crippling our effectiveness by trying (too hard) to accept all ideas that come to us? Other comments included: Change is very difficult to discuss — change requires trust. Local area committees are a tremendous resource and facilitate communication throughout the Fellowship. The silence at the beginning of the Sharing Session might have reflected the tremendous richness of the presenters' sharing. The complexity of the committee system focuses on simplicity of carrying the message.

Jean Smith, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: To better serve the groups, the General Service Office provides service material to the Fellowship, based on an indicated need, to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. A three-page list describes the service items in detail. Examples of service material include: Regional Forum Reports; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; Special Needs items, such as information about A.A. literature in Braille and on audiocassettes and special literature for deaf alcoholics.

Current ongoing projects involving Group Services are as follows.

- Group Records System Restructuring Project. The objective is to develop a new records management system. The staff member on Group Services serves on the committee overseeing this project.
- Coordination and production of three A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and Canadian. The staff member on Group Services works closely with the special projects manager regarding group printouts to areas and central/intergroup offices' records.

- Supervision of G.S.O. Service files. There is a variety of service material available, upon request, to A.A. members, groups, and for service workshops.

- Supervision/production of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, and G.S.R. kits.

- Liaison with Intergroup/Central Offices, including serving on the Policy and Site Committees of the Intergroup Seminar, which will next take place in Vancouver, British Columbia, November 10-13, 1994.

The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary for the trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees, in addition to handling correspondence and inquiries from the Northeast Region. Suggestions from the Fellowship regarding ways to improve our service to groups are welcome and appreciated.

Lois Fisher

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—Since the last Conference, the committee recommended that a sunburst design be the 1995 International Convention logo.

The committee reviewed its procedures and time frame regarding inviting the proposed local Host Committee chair, Bobbie Coneen, to attend one of its upcoming meetings. Subsequently, an invitation was extended to Bobbie to attend the October 1993 committee meeting. Following that meeting, and a review of the preliminary Host Committee duties, the committee recommended that Bobbie serve as the local Host Committee chairperson for the 1995 Convention.

The committee discussed setting a registration fee, which is based on a conservative budget that takes into account the possibilities of gain or loss, and the committee's responsibility in this matter. It was recommended that the preregistration fee be \$65.00 per attendee, and that the on-site registration fee be \$70.00 per attendee (U.S.).

The committee reviewed and approved program titles for the 1995 International Convention, with the understanding that some titles may be added or deleted, depending on final needs.

Regional Forums—Dr. Jack Norris, late trustee emeritus of the General Service Board (Class A trustee), in his recognition of the need for continuing dialogue between the board and A.A. members in all regions, had the vision to describe and initiate Regional Forums. This vision is being fulfilled as A.A. service people in the United States and Canada regions share directly with the trustees of the General Service Board, the directors of

Julio Colon (Puerto Rico) chose Georgia delegate Randy Sellers (who has a *strong* southern accent) as his sponsor—"because we won't be able to understand each other."

One delegate confessed that he felt nervous when he saw G.S.O.'s Frank Segui on the dias with a big roll of tape (which he used to stabilize the timing light). "In my area," the delegate said, "tape is what we use instead of the bell."

the two service corporations, A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, as well as G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members and employees. There have been 78 Regional Forums since they began in 1975; five were held in 1993. They were: East Central, Northeast, West Central, Southeast, and a special Eastern Canada Forum at Charlottetown, Prince Edward Island.

Each Regional Forum has an agenda which includes workshops, presentations, sharing sessions, reports and Ask-It-Basket. Topics for presentations and workshops are suggested by the region's delegates and other A.A. service people.

Over the past year a subcommittee reviewed the purpose and procedures of Regional Forums. After hearing their report, the committee recommended that all previous recommendations of the trustees' Committee on Regional Forums be treated as suggestions only, to allow for more flexibility in Forum planning.

In addition, the committee suggested that: Special Forums be expanded to include urban areas; the format of the Special Forums be made more flexible in terms of time and number of participants; Forum agendas be made more flexible, as needed, by reducing the number of delegate presentations, and asking some delegates to participate in another way; Conference-approved videos continue to be shown during Forums, but not necessarily at general sessions; the Forum Report be shortened considerably.

The Regional Forum coordinator and host trustee will work closely in planning variations in the agenda, tailoring each a little more to the particular Forum. It was also suggested that the General Service Board chairman continue to host a Saturday breakfast, which is to include the region's sitting delegates and current members of the boards who are in attendance.

The committee considered and approved plans for a Special Forum to be held in the Lake St. John-Saquenay geographical area of Quebec (Area 89), May 12-13, 1995.

1994		
February 4-6	Western Canada	Saskatchewan
February 18-21	Pacific Special	Hawaii
June 17-29	Pacific	Boise, Idaho
September 16-18	Eastern Canada	Thunder Bay, Ontario
December 2-4	Southeast	Biloxi, Mississippi

Les Leuthaeuser, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention— The International Convention assignment entails coordinating the myriad processes involved in producing our A.A. anniversary International Conventions. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as a celebration of A.A. sharing and thanksgiving.

Plans proceed apace for the 1995 International Convention, which will be held in the sparkling city of San Diego, California, June 29-July 2, 1995. The Convention theme, chosen from the many suggestions sent in by the Fellowship, is "A.A. Everywhere-Anywhere." The 1995 International Convention will kick off Thursday night with a harbor "block party" at the Convention Center on the waterfront. There will be stadium Big Meetings, Workshops, Panels, Regional Meetings, Topic Meetings and Marathons, all of which include about 1,000 speakers. The traditional flag ceremony of nations in attendance will take place at the Friday night Big Meeting at the Jack Murphy Stadium.

The Convention Center will be the major daytime focus of activity on Friday and Saturday. San Diego A.A.s will serve as members of the local Host Committee. Excitement abounds as this wonderful 60th Anniversary event draws nearer.

Eileen Gatzka

Regional Forums — The Regional Forums assignment involves the coordination and follow-through for all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These weekends of sharing help to foster better communication and deeper understanding between A.A. service workers, the General Service Board, the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards, and the General Service Office, with A.A.s in all of the regions. Regional Forums are held at the region's invitation every two years and there are usually four Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator requests topics for presentations and ideas for workshop themes from the area delegates. Invitations are mailed to G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, central offices and intergroups, past delegates and past trustees. The staff member prepares the agenda for the Forum weekend, using the ideas for presentation and workshop topics that have come in from the areas within the region for which the Forum is being planned, and works with the hotel to make sure that all of the requirements for the meetings, workshops, sharing sessions, as well as coffee and other details, are covered. He or she is also responsible for seeing that there are displays of A.A. Conference-approved literature and other service literature, as well as Archives material, at each Forum. Interpreters and simultaneous translations, when needed, are also arranged by the Forum coordinator. The work for a Regional Forum often begins three or four years in advance. Every effort is made to ensure that a climate of open sharing and communication can take place in a comfortable setting.

The chairman of the board, other Class A and Class B trustees, directors of the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Corporate Boards, and staff members from G.S.O. and the Grapevine, usually attend and participate in each Regional Forum. When the weekend of sharing is finished, a Forum Report is prepared by the coordinator and sent to all A.A. members who registered for the Forum.

Under the present structure of G.S.O., the staff member on the Regional Forums assignment also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, and correspondent to groups in Western Canada.

Sarah Price

INTERNATIONAL/WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: The International Committee serves as a link between the General Service Board and the World Service Meeting. It has the responsibility of developing policies that enable the A.A. message to be carried to alcoholics overseas, especially in countries where there is no service structure.

World Service Meeting—The Thirteenth World Service Meeting will be held in Cartagena, Colombia, October 9-13, 1994, and will be attended by our trustees-at-large U.S./Canada. We anticipate 39 delegates from 24 countries in attendance. The theme of the meeting will be "Back to Basics."

Foreign Literature Assistance—Some translations included in the 1994 budget are the Romanian, Hungarian, Bulgarian, Ukrainian, and Slovenian Big Books. Numerous translations of

pamphlets and other A.A. literature are also anticipated in 1994. Some of the expenses for these translations are being paid by the International Literature Fund, which was established in 1990 at the World Service Meeting in Munich, Germany. A.A. in Sweden has translated the Big Book into Estonian and plans to distribute it in Estonia shortly.

Overseas Information—To help assess needs, the committee requested that the staff prepare a report on the status of A.A. in Asia and Africa. The report was reviewed and a subcommittee was established to address the criteria for translation of A.A. literature.

The committee heard a report from the general manager on the Seventh European Service Meeting, which he attended in Frankfurt, Germany, October 1993. There was some discussion on service structure but the emphasis was on carrying the message, countries assisting each other, and Traditions questions. He also spent several hours discussing literature distribution with two delegates from Russia.

I attended the Ninth General Service Conference in Rimini, Italy, as their guest along with the chairperson of Great Britain's General Service Board. We were asked many questions and felt a lot was accomplished by our presence there. I have maintained communication with some of the members I met there and, at their request, have sent public information material to help carry the message in Italy.

David O'Leary, chairperson

Staff report: Correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 39 general service offices and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada.

World Service Meeting—Coordinating the biennial World Service Meeting is an absorbing aspect of this assignment. The primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, anywhere in the world. The World Service Meeting seeks ways of accomplishing these goals by sharing the experience, strength and hope of delegates who come together every two years from all parts of the world. The staff member on this assignment and G.S.O.'s assistant controller traveled to Cartagena, Colombia, in October for a site inspection of the facilities to be used for the 1994 World Service Meeting. They also visited with members of the Colombian General Service Board in Medellin regarding their participation as the host country.

Interim Service Meetings—The European and Ibero-American Service Meetings are also held biennially, alternating with World Service Meetings. These meetings provide an opportunity to share experience for countries not yet able to participate in World Service Meetings. The staff member on this assignment is often invited to participate in these meetings.

A.A. Literature Translations—To ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message, careful consideration is given prior to granting permission to print A.A. literature in various languages. Translations are reviewed and, if found to be satisfactory, the means of financing are explored. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to the A.A.W.S. Board. The staff member on this assignment serves as the intermediary for translations of A.A. literature.

Since the last General Service Conference, the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, has been published in Thai, Persian, and Chinese. *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* has been published in Latvian and Hungarian.

International Directory—The staff member also oversees the updating of the International A.A. Directory, which can be used by traveling A.A. members to find meetings and also as a useful tool for Twelfth Stepping.

John Grant

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee: This report offers a summary of the projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 1993 General Service Conference.

Projects Completed—The Anonymity Display Card was printed June 1993; A.A.W.S. produced a pocket-sized version of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, with all front matter (Preface and various forewords, Doctor's Opinion), basic text, Dr. Bob's story and Appendices. First printing of this abridged version was July 1993.

Projects in Progress—The Twelve Concepts (short form) will be included in all appropriate service pamphlets as they come up for reprint; the trustees' Literature Review Subcommittee met once, reviewed A.A. literature and a new A.A. Guideline for Literature Committees; the trustees' Literature Committee has continued to emphasize our commonality and discouraged usage of the term "minorities" wherever possible; a subcommittee of four will continue to review "The A.A. Group" pamphlet and rewrite three sections on pages 15-18.

Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee—(1) The Literature Review Subcommittee forwarded a report of their January 29, 1994 meeting to the Conference Literature Committee, asking for their guidance on whether the committee should continue to meet; (2) consider proposed changes to "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" pamphlet; (3) consider proposed changes to "G.S.R." pamphlet; (4) review draft of A.A. Guidelines for Literature Committees; (5) consider adding "District Meetings" to the inverted triangle in "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" pamphlet; (6) review letters from Areas 24, 28 and 30 regarding A.A. literature logos (note also a letter from Area 40).

Additional trustees' Literature Committee considerations:

- Area request to delete the sentence "Mood-changing medications—including uppers, sedatives, and antidepressants—are usually a threat to sobriety and you may want to learn more about this." (Page 18 from "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?") Also, the request that the parenthetical statement: "(The pamphlet 'The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs' discusses the problem in detail)" be moved to the end of the paragraph, on page 19, was forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee.
- Area request to publish a pamphlet of the Twelve Steps (half of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, pp. 5-9 and 21-125) was forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee, requesting more research and that A.A.W.S. provide the background information.
- Request to add material on "Service Sponsorship" to the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."
- Big Book issues: (1) Area request for a fourth edition was forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee, with the suggestion that more information be gathered on need and interest from the Fellowship. (2) Discuss feedback from areas regarding a new book containing stories from the first, second and third editions of the Big Book. The trustees' Literature Committee

took no action on this because area response was mainly negative. (3) Review the 1993 General Service Conference Advisory Action that: "A.A.W.S. produce a pocket-sized version of the Big Book with all front matter (Preface and various forewords, Doctor's Opinion), basic text, Dr. Bob's Story and Appendices." (4) Request from an area to print a pocket edition of the Big Book with stories included.

- Area request that the 1994 Conference institute the process of Conference approval of an "Accessibilities" pamphlet. The committee thought the "Accessibilities" pamphlet was an important service piece to consider. It will be sent to Publications for review and to the trustees' Literature Committee for their July meeting for further discussion.

- Letter from an alternate delegate regarding discrepancies and possible changes in the wording of certain items mentioned in *A.A. Comes of Age* and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* was forwarded to A.A.W.S. for guidance and direction on how to deal with inconsistencies in the statistics included in some of Bill's writings.

- Area request to consider a booklet on Service (Our Third Legacy) was forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee.

Fran Polek, chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees and works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. The coordinator, along with the editor, follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. We maintain contact with all current area, district, intergroup and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and material to assist them in this vital responsibility. Additionally, the literature coordinator is the liaison with the French Literature Service in Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

Under the present structure of G.S.O., the staff member on the Literature desk serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, published bimonthly in English, French and Spanish, and works closely with the editor of the Publications Department and a small editorial committee to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O.

Susan Ulseth

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are about 332 Loners in 142 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists. There are about 155 Internationalists and 36 Port Contacts. Sixty-one Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 122 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group.

Loners, Homers and Internationalists stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with

other A.A.s around the world through letters and tapes.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer or Internationalist. Additionally, each receives directories of Loners, Homers and Internationalists, and complimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners-Internationalists Meeting (LIM)*, which is a bimonthly discussion meeting in print, sharing excerpts of letters received at the General Service Office from LIM members.

About 1,067 A.A.s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing group activities and personal experience with Loners, Homers and Internationalists. With approximately 1,926 A.A.s (including Loner Sponsors) participating in the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting*, we might call it the largest A.A. group in the world. A.A.'s phenomenal worldwide growth can be attributed largely to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists sailing the Seven Seas who carry the A.A. message wherever they may be.

The mail received on the Loners Desk often makes you feel the same as you would sitting in the front row of an A.A. meeting. The openness and earnestness about A.A. and how it's working in our lives is the same. Following is a letter received from a Loner:

Mireille M., from Shanghai, China, reports: "I am sharing my gratitude with all of you. My life keeps getting better! People in the program told me so when I first joined A.A., and I couldn't believe it. But since I got sober, it really came true! Things are happening that I would never have dreamt. I now have a new job in Shanghai, and am able to put my rudimentary knowledge of the Chinese language into practice!

"I have wonderful news to share with you: At the age of fifty, I met a special person in China. We are engaged to be married sometime next year and we will remain in this country. I owe this very happy development to the program too. Yes, I met this man because of the A.A. program. He was traveling through Shanghai and had been given my name as an A.A. contact. Our higher power gave us the gift of love that would not have happened without sobriety. There is so much to be grateful for.

"Happiness doesn't come from the outside, or from another person. Happiness is born within oneself. It is essentially derived from self-love, self-esteem and self-confidence, all of which had been lost through the years of drinking. This program gave me the opportunity to regain these values and now I have this inner happiness to share with a new partner in a sober life."

Sarah Price

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: Since the 1993 General Service Conference, the Nominating Committee met several times during each of the three board weekends. At each meeting, the committee's work was guided by principles of love, responsibility, mutual respect and substantial unanimity.

Since the 1993 Conference Committee on Trustees made specific recommendations and suggestions relevant to the Nominating Committee, the focus of the committee's work has been to satisfy those requests. Listed below are the recommendations and suggestions from the Conference Committee followed by the actions taken by the Nominating Committee.

- The Conference Committee recommended that hereafter, Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees be limited to two (2) consecutive three-year terms.

The committee proposed an amendment to the by-laws with additional wording to clarify that the limitation would not apply

to Class A trustees who were serving during the 1993 Conference, and referred this back to the 1994 Conference Committee for approval.

- The Conference Committee recommended that the chairperson of the General Service Board serve for no more than four years.

The committee proposed an amendment to the by-laws in accordance with the recommendation. The amendment was approved by the General Service Board in October and will be included in the next printing of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

- The Conference Committee suggested that the position of chairperson of the General Service Board not be restricted to a Class A trustee, and that the trustees' Nominating Committee look at the procedure necessary to implement this and report back to the 1994 Conference.

A report on the procedures to elect a Class B (alcoholic) trustee as chairperson of the General Service Board was accepted and it was recommended that this report be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees for consideration.

- The Conference Committee requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee report back on the development of guidelines for forming new regions and that this subject be placed on the agenda of the 1994 Conference Committee on Trustees.

A report was prepared regarding a procedure for the formation of new regions and/or making alterations to the regional map. The report was accepted with the recommendation that it be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees for their review.

- The Conference Committee suggested that — when considering applicants for the upcoming Class A trustee vacancies in 1994 and 1995 — the trustees' Nominating Committee look at "friends of A.A." with spiritual and corporate backgrounds.

With a focus on spiritual and corporate backgrounds, the Nominating Committee reviewed the resumes of "friends of A.A." for the Class A trustee vacancy in 1994 and developed a list of nine candidates from which the committee recommended that three be invited by the chair of the General Service Board to attend the January 1994 board weekend. Following the board weekend, when the three "friends of A.A." were interviewed, the committee recommended that Peter Roach serve as Class A trustee.

- The Conference Committee strongly suggested that, when appointed committee member and nontrustee director vacancies occur, experience in the A.A. service structure be considered.

The Nominating Procedures were revised. The statement, "Experience in A.A. service structure is desirable" now appears in the Procedures for Nominating Corporate Board Directors (Procedure No. 2) and on the resume forms for nontrustee directors and appointed committee members. The same statement with the phrase "if applicable" is included in Procedures for Finding Appointed Committee Members. (Procedure No. 3)

- The Conference Committee requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee report back to the committee on the method of Conference approval of trustees' slate, officers of the General Service Board and directors of corporate boards and that it be placed on the agenda of the 1994 Conference Committee on Trustees.

A study was made of the method of Conference approval of trustees' slate, officers of the General Service Board and directors of the corporate boards. A report was presented and accepted and it was recommended that the report be passed on to the Conference Committee on Trustees.

- The Conference Committee recommended that no trustee

should serve as chairperson of the same trustees' committee for more than two years during his/her term of service on the General Service Board. (This recommendation received less than 2/3 of the Conference votes, but with more than 1/2 in favor it was considered a strong suggestion of the Conference.)

The Nominating Committee concluded that implementing this suggestion should not cause a problem with any trustees' committee except the Finance and Budgetary Committee where it could result in the possible loss of management control and audit issues — besides the loss of continuity. Therefore, after much deliberation and further discussion with the chair of the Conference Committee, it was the sense of the committee that the strong suggestion from the Conference Committee not apply to the chairmanship of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.

- The Conference Committee suggested that item #6 of Nominating Procedure No. 6 (Now No. 5) be amended to read: "After approval by the Board of Trustees, the applicant's name is presented to the Conference Committee on Trustees and to the General Service Conference for disapproval, if any." (This amended wording is to be added to the next edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*.)

The addition was made to *The A.A. Service Manual*. The Nominating Procedure was not amended because it was the sense of the Procedures Subcommittee that the issue would be more appropriately addressed in the consideration of the method of Conference approval of the General Service Board slate.

The report from the Procedures Subcommittee was presented and the Nominating Procedures were accepted, as revised, for presentation to the General Service Board with the recommendation that the Procedures be accepted.

The Search Subcommittee presented a report containing historical information on the balance of professional backgrounds/areas of expertise of past Class A trustees. In addition, a breakdown of professional backgrounds/areas of expertise was provided for the currently-sitting Class A trustees.

The committee discussed the reduction of nontrustee directors terms from four (4) years to two (2) years to increase the pool of potential applicants for general service trustee vacancies. It was recommended to the General Service Board that the term of nontrustee directors be two (2) years and this be referred to the Conference Committee on Trustees for consideration.

However, this motion was defeated by the General Service Board. It was moved that the report from the January meeting of the trustees' Nominating Committee be forwarded to the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards and the Conference Committee on Trustees with the minutes of the January 31, 1994 meeting of the General Service Board attached, in order to solicit and obtain their input. The matter is on the Conference Committee on Trustees Agenda for discussion.

The committee reviewed a proposal for a change in the voting procedure for regional trustees and suggested that additional background information on this subject be provided to the Conference Committee on Trustees — including sample voting sheets illustrating the actual numbers of Conference members who will be voting in each regional election if the proposed change is implemented.

The committee reviewed and approved as eligible for election all candidates for regional trustees from Eastern Canada and Pacific U.S.

The committee recommended the following nominations: A.A. World Services Board: Peter Brock, general service trustee, replacing Jean Smith; Gerard L. Ouellette, A.A.W.S. director,

replacing Peter Brock; Gay Garner, Southeast regional trustee, replacing Ann Bruning. *A.A. Grapevine Board:* Donald Weaver, East Central regional trustee, replacing Jake Ham.

The proposed slate of General Service Board members, officers of the board, A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine directors was forwarded to the 1994 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any.

The committee reviewed and will recommend the following slate of trustees at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1994 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

John N. Chappel, M.D.	John E. King
W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.	Peter Roach
Gary A. Glynn	John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.	

Class B

Peter Brock	Michael McPherson
Ann Bruning	David F. O'Leary
Gerry Flegel	Fran Polek
Gay Garner	Jane Murphy Schulberg
Jacob B. Ham	Donald Weaver
Les Leuthaeuser	

(Two Class B regional trustees to be elected at the General Service Conference in 1994.)

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
<i>First Vice-Chairperson</i>	John Hartley Smith, M.D.
<i>Second Vice-Chairperson</i>	John E. King
<i>Secretary</i>	Ann Bruning
<i>Treasurer</i>	Gary A. Glynn
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Pat Rosenstiel

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1994 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Peter Brock	Michael McPherson
George Dorsey	Gerard L. Ouellette
Jacques Filteau	Pat Rosenstiel
Gerry Flegel	Richard Roughton
Gay Garner	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1994 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Charles Crist	Jane Murphy Schulberg
John E. King	Ames Sweet
Les Leuthaeuser	Francine Ward
Tom Maguire	Ann Warner
Fran Polek	Donald Weaver

Greg Muth, *chairperson*

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public

Information Committee include: Creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; preparing health fair and other community exhibits; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey.

Much of the work of this committee was done through subcommittees and the P.I. staff coordinator in the office. Following is list of work over the past year:

- Revised the annual anonymity letter to the media and included a reply card for further information in the February mailing.
- Approved a mailing to area delegates of questions and background on anonymity in keeping with the Advisory Action from the 1993 Conference, "That each area delegate encourage discussions within all A.A. groups on the spiritual principles of Anonymity, including photographs, publications and posthumous Anonymity, as related to our Eleventh and Twelfth Traditions."
- Approved an exhibit for the National Broadcast Association for Community Affairs in Chicago, Illinois. The booth was staffed by the P.I. Committee in Chicago.
- Thoroughly reviewed the P.I. Workbook with an eye toward updating the text and creating a simple, concise and less expensive format. The third draft of this work is available to be reviewed by the Conference P.I. Committee.
- Recommended that the A.A. Preamble be added to the flyers "A Message to Teenagers" and "Alcoholics Anonymous 1992 Membership Survey" at their next printing.
- Reviewed the radio spot R-09 in keeping with a 1993 Conference Advisory Action and, after listening and reviewing the text, found nothing objectionable. Instead, the message was found to be positive and honest.
- Initiated a thorough review of the Membership Survey in keeping with the 1993 Conference Advisory Action #28. One thousand, four hundred (1,400) questionnaires were sent to delegates, trustees (current and past Class A's), and area P.I., C.P.C. and T.F. chairs, asking if and how they use the Survey, and if they feel it is in keeping with our "singleness of purpose." From the 170 responses returned, a preliminary report was prepared for consideration by the 1994 P.I. Conference Committee.
- Discussed the newspaper clipping service in-depth and, since it was felt that there was minimal benefit to P.I. at this time, suggest that this service be discontinued. Since there may be some archival use for these clippings, the P.I. Committee suggested that this service be considered by the trustees' Archives Committee.

Gerry Flegel, *chairperson*

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, potential alcoholic and the general public through the media, health fairs, and schools. It is a crucial part of Public Information work here at G.S.O. to be a resource and a central collector of sharing for Public Information committees throughout the United States and Canada. The staff member and staff assistant respond to hundreds of written and telephone inquiries that come into the office from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff person is responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what we can and cannot do, and providing accurate information to the media, researchers and the public about Alcoholics Anonymous.

During the past year, literature has been provided for a large number of health and community fairs. In many cases, local Public Information committees provide this literature for their

participation in the fairs. When possible, we try to connect the community resource with local A.A. Public Information committees so that they can become involved with the decision about how A.A. can best participate in the event.

It has also been our responsibility to read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and television feature stories since the last Conference. Anonymity breaks have decreased over the past few months, but for those we receive information on, we try to contact the person involved through area delegates.

New area Public Information chairpersons are automatically sent the Public Information Workbook, and all P.I. committee members receive *Box 4-5-9*, as well as any new public service material. Discount packages and one-way displays about the Membership Survey are also available to P.I. committees.

Radio and television public service announcements have been widely aired on major networks and local stations and requests for help in planning programs that include references to Alcoholics Anonymous have also abounded. We have ongoing contact with major networks, as well as the PBS and cable channels. Many film companies have contacted us for permission to use our literature as props in scenes depicting an A.A. meeting.

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured in the same way as any other service: are we doing what we can to see that the A.A. message is available to all, and do we strive to see that the information conveyed about A.A. is accurate and easy to understand?

Helen Turnquest

SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Throughout the years, G.S.O. has provided services in several languages, including Spanish. But it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated.

In our general service structure there are more than 30,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members, who do not speak English, meeting in 1,200 groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services staff person, who does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of material from the other staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. All Spanish-speaking groups receive *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving; the groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added to the areas in our service structure. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our Publications Department. Spanish Services helps answer the correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments and especially by the International assignment.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature and attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, Regional Forums, the World Service Meeting and the International Convention, as well as greeting Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.

Danny Mooney

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups and members are provided through 12 staff assignments. In addition to assuming the responsibility for Treatment Facilities, Public Information, etc., staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, as well as with A.A.s in overseas countries. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. These staff assignments are monitored by the staff coordinator.

The staff is divided into three units so that G.S.O. mail is processed and responded to as soon as possible. Unit A consists of P.I., C.P.C., C.F., and T.F. Unit B includes coordinators of Staff, Conference, Regional Forums, Loners/Internationalists and Group Services. Unit C includes International/World Service Meeting, Literature and Spanish Services. The International Convention assignment works parallel to all of the other units.

During a typical year, G.S.O. staff receive approximately 40,000 pieces of mail, and the staff coordinator ensures that mail is handled, including times when staff members are involved with large projects, and in times of sickness and vacation. Weekly staff meetings are chaired by the staff coordinator; at these, discussion centers on problems that require direction from the group conscience, and more and better ways of providing service to A.A. groups and members are sought.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of required staff trips to area assemblies/conventions, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. She also serves as a liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. The staff coordinator also supervises the Support Services (secretarial/clerical) department, ensuring that the paper work is done accurately and in a timely manner.

Whenever there is a staff opening, a letter is sent to trustees and directors announcing the opening and briefly describing the requirements for the job. The information is also posted in *Box 4-5-9*. Six years of sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member. Business experience, excellent communication skills, A.A. service experience and geographic considerations are among the criteria used in the selection process. The staff coordinator trains new staff members.

During 1993, staff attended a total of 80 conventions, assemblies, roundups and Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These provide staff with an opportunity to communicate about G.S.O. services, to meet A.A.s throughout the U.S. and Canada and to receive information that can be shared with other groups.

In the past year, approximately 1,237 visitors from around the world came to G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices, learning about the services to the Fellowship. Often visiting members and guests attend the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on most Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance materials, and preparing the minutes of the General Service Board meetings; she also serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, the summary of the boards' activities.

The staff coordinator also produces the summaries of General Sharing Sessions, held during board weekends. At these sessions, trustees, members of all board committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. staff members share on a wide range of topics.

The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference, and serves as secretary of the trustees'

Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is also a director of A.A. World Services, Inc.

Pat Rosenstiel

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committees on Treatment Facilities is "...to further the acceptance of A.A. in hospitals, rehabilitation centers, and similar facilities, and to bring additional help to alcoholics under treatment there." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, 1993-94 edition, p. S123.) Consequently, the way in which the A.A. message is finally heard by alcoholics in treatment facilities is a matter of concern, attention and development by the committee.

Since the 1993 General Service Conference, our committee has met three times. At the August meeting it was reported that approximately 800 letters were sent to administrators of major treatment facilities in the U.S. and Canada regarding A.A.'s primary purpose, nonaffiliation and anonymity.

A subcommittee of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities has prepared a revision of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" which was forwarded to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities for their consideration at the 1994 General Service Conference.

At the suggestion of the committee, the paper entitled "What A.A. Is and What A.A. Is Not" for alcoholism treatment program professionals and clients was split into two papers — one directed to the professional administrators and one to the clients. The committee also agreed that there be two separate mailings of the annual letter to treatment facilities administrators—one to the administrators and one to the chairpersons of area treatment facilities committees. This is the letter which states our primary purpose and explains our Traditions of nonaffiliation and anonymity.

There was much discussion about the fact that in many areas some facilities are closing, primarily because government funds are no longer available. Also, it appears that fewer A.A. members are working in a professional capacity in treatment facilities. Detox units are more often being used, so the patient's stay in a therapeutic setting is frequently much shorter. This, of course, means that newly sober alcoholics will be more than ever dependent on the Fellowship.

Experience and mail to G.S.O. indicate that many area treatment facilities committees are functioning extremely well, and are busily fulfilling our primary purpose. The trustees' committee fully supports this local autonomy because it is realized that the A.A. members in the areas have more up-to-date information on local needs and opportunities for service. Two reports of local A.A. projects involving carrying the A.A. message to treatment facilities will appear in a future edition of the Treatment Facilities Newsletter.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D., chairperson

Staff report: The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to help A.A. members carry the message to alcoholics in treatment. We have now over 400 Treatment Facilities committees functioning in the U.S. and Canada, 91 of which are area committees. We try to keep an up-to-date list of the chairs of these committees and to provide them with considerable

information and literature.

In order to carry the message "inside," the A.A. member must meet with the professional administrators and personnel in many different kinds of treatment settings. He or she must become familiar with the rules and regulations of the facility and be willing to comply with them. As an oldtimer once said, "If we can't get in, we can't carry the message!" The local A.A. member also provides information about A.A. groups in the patient's hometown and encourages active participation upon leaving the facility. This is called "bridging the gap."

Area chairs and committee members are sent a Treatment Facilities Workbook, a comprehensive how-to guide to carrying the message "inside," which contains shared experience, suggestions, general information, guidelines and literature. District and other treatment facilities chairs also receive the Workbook. In addition, treatment facilities people receive Box 4-5-9, *About A.A.*, the Treatment Facilities Newsletter, and a current list of the 91 chairs in the U.S. and Canada. All chairs have copies of our directory of U.S. and Canadian intergroups and central offices for referral purposes.

Mail comes from three sources: (1) newly sober alcoholics in treatment facilities, (2) local A.A.s who have become active on treatment facilities committees, (3) treatment facilities administrators or personnel requesting information about A.A. and assistance in setting up meetings.

The other major staff activity entails being secretary to both trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities. Responsibilities in this area include responding to mail from committee members, helping to prepare agendas for committee meetings, preparing background material and, of course, preparing minutes at the conclusion of meetings. The staff member also gathers material for an occasional treatment facilities article in Box 4-5-9 and prepares biannual editions of the Treatment Facilities Newsletter.

Phyllis Masback



Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board, originally incorporated in 1946 when A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada had just named the two-year-old Grapevine their national magazine. As the A.A. Grapevine approaches its 50th Anniversary of continuous publication, the corporation looks back at many years of growth, and forward to new challenges and opportunities in our second 50 years.

The primary purpose of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. remains what it has been from the beginning: to publish a monthly magazine. The corporation also produces a number of other materials associated with the magazine. The corporation is self-supporting through sales of the magazine and related materials, and accepts no contributions toward operating expenses. The Grapevine can accept only contributions expressly designated for the purpose of providing subscriptions for A.A. members who are unable to pay for them (often those in correctional facilities).

There are ten voting directors. Five are trustees (two general service, two regional, and one Class A); three are nontrustee directors; and two are paid employees (the executive editor and the managing editor). Also attending board meetings but not voting are the controller/business administrator and the assistant secretary. A member of the G.S.O. staff usually attends for liaison purposes, and this year the chair of A.A. World Services has been present at most quarterly meetings. The chair rotates annually between a regional trustee and a general service trustee.

The board has four quarterly meetings as well as four meetings in which it convenes as a planning committee of the whole, to engage in ongoing strategic planning for the future health of the corporation and the magazine, without pressure to take specific actions.

Finances: Year-end results for 1993 were positive, in spite of the fact that both magazine and other publishing income were below budget. Net income was \$67,900 (with an operating loss of \$14,750), compared to a budgeted \$34,790 net income and a \$51,120 operating loss. The fact that expenses were well controlled and ended the year well below budget accounts for the favorable results in the face of low circulation and sales of related materials. At the January quarterly meeting, directors voted to forward a total of \$80,500 to the General Service Board Reserve Fund. Of this amount, \$13,250 covers the subscription liability and \$67,250 is a donation to the Reserve Fund.

1994 Budget: At the January meeting, the board approved a 1994 budget calling for a net income (after interest) of \$7,060, with a loss from operations of \$75,440.

Desktop Publishing: In July, the board requested a budget adjustment from the trustees' Finance Committee to cover, among other things, the purchase of desktop publishing equipment for the magazine (as well as the *GvR News* and various flyers, order forms, etc.). The result was a Macintosh computer, printer, and scanner (and later a CD-ROM drive) which, beginning with the June issue, will be used for magazine design and prepress production. The editors are climbing the learning curve, through a combination of in-house training and hands-on practice when time permits.

Circulation: Circulation ended the year below the budgeted 123,000, at a monthly average of about 122,000. In an optimistic spirit, the board has again budgeted an average of 123,000 for 1994, since directors are confident that the downward trend of the past several years will take a turn for the better in the magazine's anniversary year. A circulation task force of the board has been busy looking at possible reasons for the downturn and discussing ways in which it might be reversed.

A major emphasis of both board and staff has been to provide resources for A.A.s in the service structure who are working to increase awareness of the Grapevine.

A poster with the theme "Carry the Grapevine—Carry the Message" is available. In addition, an A.A. member has been hired to work part-time on editorial and other projects, and has been engaged in calling area Grapevine chairs to garner news from the areas and offer help when needed from the office. This is an ongoing project that has already resulted in better communication between the office and the GvR network, and has provided a number of ideas that can be shared with GvRs via the quarterly "GvR News."

The A.A. Grapevine Workbook was revised this year, and the new publication, available since November, includes a wealth of ideas and projects shared with the office by GvRs all over North America. The new Workbook is in a soft-cover format rather than the former ring binder, which made possible a price cut from \$7.50 to \$6.00.

A Grapevine History package, being offered through the GvR network, is available free on request. It contains reprints of three articles on Grapevine history, some excerpts from the new Workbook, and suggestions for Grapevine history displays.

The all-in-one catalog order form has been redesigned as an eight-page, four-color leaflet, and places more emphasis on the magazine itself than did the former catalog. In addition, a 50th anniversary order form has been produced, providing information on the anniversary and offering to every new subscriber in 1994 an anniversary gift of a thirteenth issue, a back issue featuring A.A. history.

Distribution of Back Issues: The November 1993 issue included an order form for packages of 50 back issues of the Grapevine for the cost of postage (\$8.00), and the result was a deluge of orders. Almost 150,000 back issues have been mailed out (including about 25,000 sent free for the use of service committees). One result is that the supply of back issues was virtually wiped out, and many orders had to be returned. The offer will be reinstated when the supply of print overruns again builds up.

Related Materials: A new booklet, *The Home Group: Heartbeat of A.A.*, came off press in May 1993 and met a positive response from the Fellowship. Similar in format to the booklet *Living Sober*, it contains 34 articles on the home group reprinted from past issues of the magazine. The editors are working on production of a set of two cassette tapes on A.A. history/old-timers, endorsed by the 1993 Conference Grapevine Committee and intended to enhance the historical emphasis of the 50th Anniversary year.

In response to a 1993 Conference Advisory Action asking the Grapevine Corporate Board to "continue to explore different ways of carrying the message to the Spanish community through Grapevine materials," the board authorized in October a translation of *The Language of the Heart* into Spanish. The soft-cover book will be available some time in 1995.

Communication with the Service Structure: One of the board's primary concerns over the past year has been—and continues to be—ways to achieve more effective communication with the service structure. A communications task force was appointed and met several times, and a major result was the decision to institute conference calls between directors and delegate members of the Conference Grapevine Committee three times a year.

Editorial: A number of special issues or sections have been published since the 1993 Conference, including a three-part issue on Recovery, Unity and Service; a special issue commemorating 50 years of A.A. in Canada, A.A. in Prison, A.A. in the 90s, "What's Going on in Your Group?," A.A. in the Workplace,



and Twelfth-stepping.

A Step series was a feature of every issue in 1993, and in January 1994 a new Traditions series began, featuring both reprints and new material.

Magazine redesign: The editors and Editorial Advisory Board have been working throughout the year on the magazine redesign project. Based on comments from readers (especially in the Grapevine Inventory questionnaire of February 1993) and others interested in the magazine, the editors began more than two years ago to think about an overall redesign of the magazine, bringing it more up-to-date in appearance and hopefully making it more appealing to a wider cross section of A.A. members. In addition to input from readers, the Editorial Board invited a group of young people to a meeting as consultants (on both content and appearance). At another meeting, the Editorial Board invited some A.A. members with design backgrounds to join the discussion. After looking at concepts submitted by four designers, the Editorial Board selected an overall approach and the editors have been working with a graphic artist over the past several months to work out all aspects of the final design. The result is a mix of new and old, hopefully attractive to new readers and still appealing to longtime subscribers.

The June 1994 issue, celebrating the magazine's 50th Anniversary, introducing the new overall design, makes history in more than one respect: a double issue commemorating the anniversary, it is the first Grapevine to be produced electronically with the new desktop publishing equipment.

Writing in the June 1945 Grapevine, when the magazine was just one year old, Bill W. said: "Though the Grapevine is young, it is commencing to have its own tradition. All of us are very sensitive to the thought that it ought never to be sectional in its appeal nor should it take sides on any controversial question. While it must constantly talk of people in its news and views, it ought never to glorify or belittle anyone, nor lend itself to a commercial undertaking, nor become a mere mouthpiece for

any of us, even the central offices or the Alcoholic Foundation.

Of course, everybody will see pieces in the Grapevine now and then with which he or she will not agree. So it must always be understood that these pieces reflect the thoughts and feelings of their authors but not necessarily those of the Grapevine. To crystallize these traditions and principles we ask for more contributions from all parts of the country."

Today, the editors receive more manuscripts each day than they can publish in a month, contributed by members from all parts of the country, the continent, and indeed the world. As we enter our second fifty years, our hope is that the Grapevine will continue to grow in its ability to carry the message in the words and experiences and thoughts of the members who today are the living, breathing embodiment of the A.A. program and its principles.

Jacob Ham, chairperson

Staff report: The Grapevine office staff consists of 19 people: two A.A. staff members, along with a freelance copyeditor and a designer, who are responsible for content and appearance of the magazine, and 15 nonalcoholics who make sure the financial state of the Grapevine is in order, that subscriptions are entered, and that special item orders go out on time. Team management through the joint efforts of the executive editor, managing editor, and controller/business administrator ensures a healthy operation and good overall communication.

Editorial: The executive editor, Ann Warner, has oversight responsibility as chief executive for the Grapevine operation, and reports directly to the Grapevine Board. Ames Sweet, the managing editor, is responsible for all aspects of magazine editorial and production and oversees the Grapevine representative program. Together, the two editors evaluate all material for publication, select the content of each issue, and stay in touch with everyone who writes for the magazine. To bolster these efforts, the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board (made up of volunteer

A.A. members who are professionals in the fields of publishing and communications) meets nine times a year to discuss the format, content and direction of the magazine, and to consider from a creative angle the development of future special items or determine a particular emphasis for the magazine.

The Editorial Department is also responsible for publishing the quarterly "GvR News," and with the help of the GvR coordinator tries to keep GvRs at all levels informed about what's going on in the office and what's happening with other GvRs around the world.

Unlike A.A. staff positions at G.S.O., Grapevine staff positions do not rotate, and the executive editor and managing editor share the responsibility of representing the Grapevine at Regional Forums and, when invited, other events. Both also currently serve on the Corporate Board and are voting members of the General Service Conference. These two A.A.s are assisted by a nonalcoholic editorial secretary.

Financial: Controller/business administrator Bob Scherer manages all business aspects of the corporation and heads up the bookkeeping-accounting department, assisted by a bookkeeper who supervises four accounting clerks and the shipping operation. The bookkeeping department keeps track of all incoming and outflowing funds, and prepares the financial analyses and reports required by the Corporate Board, the General Service Board, and the Grapevine's outside auditor. While the magazine and the bulk of the Grapevine's special item orders are packaged and mailed by outside mailers in Pennsylvania, the in-house shipping department is kept busy mailing a variety of small orders, back issues, letters, books, tapes, and complimentary materials for conferences and conventions throughout the U.S. and Canada.

Office Management: Office manager and corporate secretary Naomi Strassberg's multifaceted job includes ensuring the general efficiency of the office as a whole, administering the health insurance program, supervising the day-to-day work of the GvR coordinator, and handling all copyrights and permission requests.

Circulation: Circulation supervisor Zola Bodden oversees three data entry clerks who enter all subscriptions and address changes into the computer, and a customer service clerk, who handles special requests and any problems that may occur.

Like any other professional operation, we have our ups and downs—our good days and our bad days. Some days are filled with nothing but complaints and gripes—aimed at or coming from each one of the different departments. Yet, overall, if the early "ink-stained wretches" who founded the Grapevine with Bill W.'s blessings were to return to our modern-day office, through all that is familiar and unfamiliar, they would certainly recognize the spirit of Alcoholics Anonymous which flows throughout the entire operation.

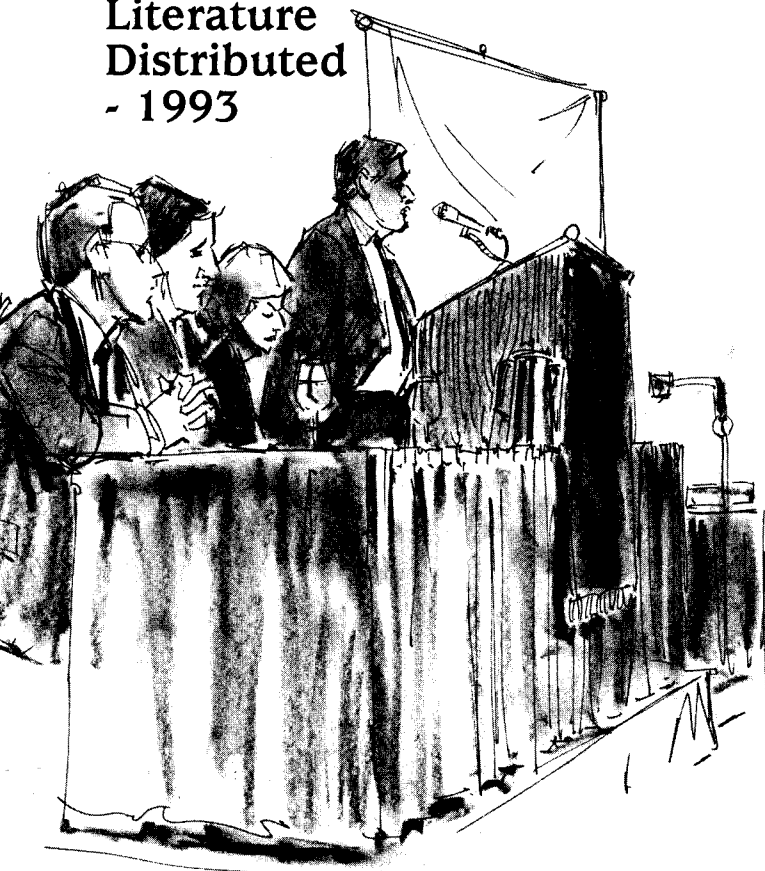
Ames Sweet, managing editor



GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION — GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1994	APRIL 1993	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,273	1,447	— 174
Alaska	522	533	— 11
Arizona	1,549	1,555	— 6
Arkansas	707	668	— 39
California	11,363	11,796	— 433
Colorado	1,568	1,539	— 29
Connecticut	1,947	1,965	— 18
Delaware	423	432	— 9
District of Columbia	279	301	— 22
Florida	5,787	5,551	— 236
Georgia	2,678	2,784	— 106
Hawaii	395	423	— 28
Idaho	545	521	— 24
Illinois	5,220	5,406	— 186
Indiana	1,731	1,810	— 79
Iowa	1,486	1,576	— 90
Kansas	1,511	1,586	— 75
Kentucky	1,073	1,010	— 63
Louisiana	1,146	1,198	— 52
Maine	862	777	— 85
Maryland	1,915	1,976	— 61
Massachusetts	3,848	4,026	— 178
Michigan	3,440	3,427	— 13
Minnesota	3,115	3,176	— 61
Mississippi	718	709	— 9
Missouri	2,131	2,269	— 138
Montana	659	687	— 28
Nebraska	1,393	1,494	— 101
Nevada	620	609	— 11
New Hampshire	674	679	— 5
New Jersey	3,473	3,619	— 146
New Mexico	614	667	— 53
New York	7,809	8,040	— 231
North Carolina	2,726	2,836	— 110
North Dakota	489	463	— 26
Ohio	3,541	3,733	— 192
Oklahoma	1,410	1,379	— 31
Oregon	1,303	1,311	— 8
Pennsylvania	4,780	4,778	— 2
Rhode Island	536	552	— 16
South Carolina	1,191	1,239	— 48
South Dakota	466	475	— 9
Tennessee	1,520	1,521	— 1
Texas	5,109	5,162	— 53
Utah	560	518	— 42
Vermont	406	420	— 14
Virginia	2,507	2,606	— 99
Washington	3,388	3,370	— 18
West Virginia	514	549	— 35
Wisconsin	2,699	2,744	— 45
Wyoming	344	369	— 25
Puerto Rico	72	92	— 20
U.S. Possessions	79	52	— 27
Total	106,114	108,425	—2,311
CANADA			
Alberta	1,221	1,160	— 61
British Columbia/Yukon	1,668	1,709	— 41
Manitoba	556	586	— 30
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	532	512	— 20
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	830	779	— 51
Ontario	4,027	3,913	— 114
Quebec	446	432	— 14
Saskatchewan	842	795	— 47
Total	10,122	9,886	—236
FOREIGN			
	1,507	1,492	— 15
Grand Total	117,743	119,803	—2,060

Literature Distributed - 1993



ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	503,005
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	417,979
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	6,958
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	99,715
Daily Reflections	136,701
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	258,357
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	36,727
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	177,392
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	3,684
A.A. Comes of Age	16,265
As Bill Sees It	64,798
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	12,675
"Pass It On"	14,576
Total	1,748,832

Booklets

Living Sober	187,564
Came to Believe	89,377
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	17,396
Total	294,337

Pamphlets

A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs	18,251
A.A. and the Armed Services	7,988
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	33,436
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	28,908
A.A. for the Native North American	24,711
A.A. for the Woman	128,124

The A.A. Group	72,352
A.A. in Your Community	36,680
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	11,874
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	23,516
The A.A. Membership Survey	48,600
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	98,884
The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	14,234
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	33,095
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	12,695
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	119,359
Circles of Love and Service	24,713
Bridging the Gap	25,253
The Clergy Ask About A.A.	14,753
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	18,326
Do You Think You're Different?	146,405
44 Questions	220,958
G.S.R.	35,399
How A.A. Members Cooperate	16,044
How It Works	61,213
If You Are a Professional	29,584
Inside A.A.	45,677
Is A.A. for You?	285,048
Is A.A. for Me?	117,609
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	95,446
It Happened to Alice	55,004
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	50,451
The Jack Alexander Article	41,511
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	12,480
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	84,578
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	49,959
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	40,762
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	5,770
A Newcomer Asks	291,351
Problems Other Than Alcohol	109,768
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	259,064
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	13,526
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	16,457
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	72,294
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	40,074
The Twelve Traditions of A.A.	5,726
This Is A.A.	276,672
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	20,381
Time to Start Living	72,041
Time to Start Living (large print)	13,230
Too Young?	91,155
Understanding Anonymity	64,010
What Happened to Joe	55,333
Young People and A.A.	121,310
Total	3,712,042

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	708,873
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	98,578
Wallet cards-Anonymity	59,155
Anonymity Display Card	17,462
Parchment-scrolls	4,529
Placards	603
C.P.C. Workbook	714
Correctional Facilities Workbook	810
P.I. Workbook	883
Treatment Facilities Workbook	553
A.A. Guidelines	29,693
Group Handbook	3,242

Wire Racks	2,767
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	3,188
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	3,907
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	289
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	1,899
TV Spots (video cassette)	144
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	259
Twelve Steps Shade displays	393
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	207
Fact Files	1,577
Total	939,725
Grand Total	6,694,936

SPANISH

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous)	26,785
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	6,134
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	2,239
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,188
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	5,212
Total	42,558

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	12,687
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	1,878
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	22,605
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	6,598
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	3,081
Total	46,849

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	5,450
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	18,828
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	33,350
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	65,034
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	4,374
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	10,299
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	6,516
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	2,303
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	3,413
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	2,926
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	14,724
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	8,288
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	9,899
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	5,027
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	5,122
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	7,327
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas	

(The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	3,042
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	3,474
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	5,069
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	11,148
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? A.A. Tradition - How it Developed)	2,563
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	5,997
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	5,659
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	6,463
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	7,847
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,167
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,850
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,806
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,313
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	1,441
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	10,262
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	6,461
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,343
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales (A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs)	2,053
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	5,958
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living)	3,447
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	5,896
Total	299,139

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	5,455
Parchments, Spanish	614
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	22,141
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on Cassette)	449
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on Cassette)	691
Total	29,350
Grand Total	417,896

FRENCH

Books

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	3,446
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	3,421
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,678
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	3,477
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	825

Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	2,856
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	4,274
Total	19,977

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,968
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	2,452
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	2,187
Total	6,607

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	15,890
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	4,954
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	26,929
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,285
Cooperation des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	580
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	561
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,282
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	300
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	316
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,330
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,151
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	403
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	1,686
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	1,584
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	607
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	661
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	4,490
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	3,475
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	921
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,571
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	599
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	491
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	2,334
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	1,049
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-Founders of A.A.)	876
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	965
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	261
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,934
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	865
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	932
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	303

Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	983
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,771
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	474
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,800
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,759
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	281
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,688
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	1,665
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	751
Sondage de 1992 sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	2,686
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,822
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,994
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	1,065
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	6,163
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,801
Favoriser de rapprochement	272
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	3,073
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	774
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the native North American)	740
Total	114,047
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	Total 1,879

Divers (Miscellaneous)

Le Gros Livre (cassettes)	68
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	2,808
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity Wallet card)	178
Cassettes	167
Notre Methode (How It Works)	22,678
Les Meilleurs Articles de Bill	4,422
Manuel de Groupe	136
Manuel de l'Information Publique	34
Manuel des Centres de Detention	11
Manuel de la CMP	45
Messages d'Interet Publique (Radio P.S.A.)	3
Priere Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	28,454
Slogans (serie de 5) (Five A.A. Slogans)	274
Suggestions Reunions Debutants (Guide for Leading Beginners Meetings)	230
Manuel des Centres de Traitement	15
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (fact file)	1,925
Total	61,448
Grand Total	203,958



Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alaska: Our area has approximately 235 groups, in 13 districts, covering an area one-third the size of the lower 48 states. Area assemblies rotate within the districts and meet twice a year, with a state convention in the fall of the nonvoting year. We are proud to have just hosted the 1994 Pacific Regional A.A. Service Assembly, in Juneau. Some of our districts have started to use L.C.M.s and all districts hold monthly meetings. Our area assembly has seven committees that are active and responsive to the needs of the districts and groups. A recent area inventory reflected a need for better communications from the area assembly to the groups, which is our focus over the next two years. A major problem within Alaska is our lack of road systems to major populations; as a result many G.S.R.s cannot attend because funding isn't available. We are looking at new avenues to assure all G.S.R.s an active voice and a vote at the area assemblies. We look forward to the next two years as an opportunity to improve communications, and G.S.R. participation.—*Larry Cagnina*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Our area has approximately 7,800 members and 520 groups, in 59 districts. We are situated mainly in the Province of Alberta, and the Northwest Territories, the north- and south-eastern corners of British Columbia, with a few groups in Saskatchewan and the Northwest Territories. Because of the vast area, travel within and between the districts is a challenge. Translations of our literature into the various native languages and dialects is also proving difficult. There has been some translating done, but very little. We have two area committee meetings and two area assemblies a year. Two years ago, we adopted the use of the committee system, similar to the Conference. There is more discussion on Conference activities and therefore our membership is much more informed and involved. We have a computer system, to be used by the delegate. We hope this will help to keep our group records more current and improve our communications.—*Raymond Massey*

Arizona: Our area service structure parallels that of the Conference with G.S.R.s, D.C.M.C.s, D.C.M.s and intergroup liaisons assigned to a committee panel for a two-year rotation. This has given the area a greater focus in that it: reflects group conscience between the groups and the assembly; provides the area with a continuing workshop in the Traditions; provides an expanded opportunity for participation; and provides a more efficient administration of area business. We have four assemblies per year. We've increased participation in the Hispanic and Native American groups and now will try to increase that outreach to the rural areas and the inner city. Our area workshop teams travel throughout the area to explain general and area services. In 1993 we celebrated 50 years of A.A. in Arizona. Challenges? More group participation at the area level; better communication to small communities in outlying parts of Arizona; and a workable budget. The combination of good Fellowship, active participation in A.A. and January temperatures in the 70s makes Arizona an attractive place to practice the principles of our program.—*Linda Bluth*

California (Mid-Southern): Our area consists of 2,445 groups in 23 active districts (four are Spanish speaking). Area meetings are simultaneously translated into Spanish and American Sign Language. We hold three regular area assemblies yearly that meet in a central location; our area service committee meets six times a year at different districts. Approximately 10% of our membership is represented at area meetings. We have a pre-Conference symposium in the spring, a Spanish-speaking service event in the summer, a service event in the fall and our

biannual election assembly. We are fortunate to have ten past delegates of our area staying active in area service. We are looking forward to enjoying the experience of being of service at the 1995 International Convention in San Diego.—*Manuel Ysais*

California (Northern Interior): Our area is at a nice point in its cycle of development; it is "Coming of Age." With many past delegates actively involved, we can draw on past experience, yet remain flexible and innovative. Our current D.C.M.s are well informed; our officers are hard working and cohesive, with a primary commitment to ensuring the area's continued growth. Two of our four annual assemblies are multi-day events and we make good use of panel presentations, especially by G.S.R.s. We feel that the area belongs to the groups and have been trying to make that message clear. This was demonstrated last year when the assembly decided to withdraw its application for a new delegate area and devote its energies to strengthening our existing structure and communication instead. The addition of our first linguistic district shows that we may now have a solid foothold for forward growth. Our mission is to keep the G.S.R.s involved, stressing the importance of shared information, education and commitment.—*Inez Yoakum*

California (San Diego/Imperial): Our area has over 1,000 groups, with 26,000 members, in 22 districts (including two Spanish-speaking districts). We recently proposed that our ad hoc Contact Upon Release Committee become a permanent standing committee of the area assembly. We celebrate A.A.'s anniversary with Unity Day, and participate, with the Southern and Mid-Southern Areas, in a Three Area D.C.M. Sharing Session. Five area assemblies are held each year, and area committees meet monthly. The area also has an annual Remember Our Old Timers Stories, and many districts sponsor service workshops. One of our challenges is to increase attendance and participation in area activities by G.S.R.s and to improve representation of the groups. Our area assembly and groups eagerly anticipate being the host city for the 1995 International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Marco Roman*

Delaware: Area 12 has 13 districts and approximately 160 registered groups. We may be small in stature, but we are big in spirit and service. We have four committee meetings and four assembly meetings each year. Our annual state convention is held in May. The state is divided into three counties with an intergroup for each. Our area consists of the usual offices plus a registrar, who handles the groups information changes. Our standing committees include C.P.C., Treatment, Archives, Grapevine, Corrections, and Convention. Each committee communicates and interacts with their intergroup counterparts. Each intergroup sends a representative to the area committee and assembly meetings as an active participant along with the G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. In March of this year, the Wilmington Group celebrated its 50th Anniversary. One of our area goals for this year is to help the Grapevine celebrate its 50th anniversary by requesting that groups purchase at least one Grapevine subscription.—*Doug Thompson*

Georgia: Our area has a state office, located in central Georgia and funded by groups. This is to enhance the communication and unity between groups throughout the state and G.S.O. in New York. The office is under the supervision of an office committee, consisting of a delegate, state chairperson, state treasurer state secretary, alternate delegate, and immediate past state chairperson. We have five cluster workshops located around the state, and host a prepaid state convention, funded

by groups. This year we have added three service workshops with presentation by chairperson of C.P.C., P.I., Correction, Treatment, Archives, and Grapevine. We have our assembly three times a year. We have 100% attendance of D.C.M.s, with 60% to 70% of our G.S.R.s in attendance. We are fully self-supporting and our primary purpose is to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic.—*Randy Sellers*

Idaho: Area 18 is over five hundred miles wide, stretching from Vale, Oregon in the west to Afton, Wyoming, in the east. We serve from Riggins and Salmon in central Idaho, our northern boundary, to Jordan Valley, Oregon and Jackpot, Nevada, our southernmost points. The area is divided into ten districts. As with most of the Western areas, there is much opportunity to travel. We fund six special service committees on the area level, and the past few years we have made great strides in making our Hospital and Institutions Committees self-supporting. Our Archive committee has a fine display and collection. We have 75-85% representation at our two area assemblies. We strive to inform the groups, and it is understood that we want group conscience, not personal opinion. We conduct three area committee meetings each year for information and planning. The hardest work is done by the D.C.M.s. Without their dedication to travel their districts and keep the groups informed we would not be the great area we are today.—*Mike Ward*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 covers 30 counties from the Indiana border on the east to the Mississippi River on the west. To the south we start just north of Peoria and cover to the Wisconsin border. There is a state conference every August, and we host a Northern Illinois Area Spring Conference every March, which is primarily a service conference. We have 25 districts with 1,014 registered groups and 18,388 members. The area committee and the area assembly each meets four times a year. In 1993 the area started a delegates workshop to discuss the Conference Agenda items, and this year the area voted to add a post-Conference delegates workshop. We have ten area committees and this year the area assembly created the position of record keeper, to keep a better record of our groups and to help register the many unregistered groups in our area. We are self-supporting with regular contributions to G.S.O. and we remember the November Birthday Plan started in 1986, with all contributions to this plan going to G.S.O. Northern Illinois is beginning to realize that it is not them or us. It is we, all members of A.A. trying to find the best way to achieve our primary purpose—to carry our message to the still-suffering alcoholic.—*Russ Van Dran*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 has 24 districts with more than 500 registered groups. The area committee meets four times a year and we have an annual weekend assembly in October. Our standing committees are active; our newsletter, "The Handout," is published quarterly. The Convention committee alternates annual responsibility for conducting the Indiana State Convention with Area 22 (Northern Indiana). Most of our districts have monthly meetings and many have their own standing committees. Some districts conduct G.S.R. workshops, hold Traditions or gratitude meetings, and some jointly sponsor one-day mini-conferences. We feel our progress and challenges may be met through continuous service and ever improving communications throughout the area. We are also in the process of revising our area structure. The opportunities for service are many and the challenges are interesting.—*Jim Wilson*

Kansas: Our area has 370 groups in 30 districts. Our area

assembly meets in January and July, with the area committee meeting in April and October. Our Corrections committee has been actively placing yellow cans in all the groups to collect money to buy literature for correctional facilities, and our second annual area Corrections conference was held in March. In a further effort to reduce expenses, we have moved our area service office from rented space into the basement of our office manager's home, and have moved our archives collection to the home of our area archivist. We have our state conference in Wichita in September. Area 25 has been successful in facilitating an orderly transition between the old and the new area committee so as to avoid a lapse in our efforts to carry the message, and is currently blessed with a service structure comprised of a lot of hardworking A.A. members who truly practice placing principles before personalities.—*Donald Popejoy*

Kentucky: Our area has 32 districts; 30 are in Kentucky and the remaining two are in southern Indiana. We hold area committee meetings each January, April and July. Every October we have an area assembly; the site of these meetings rotates. Our newsletter, "The Kentuckiana News," is published six times a year. Area standing committees of Grapevine, Corrections, P.I., Treatment Facilities, C.P.C. and Archives are very active. Each D.C.M. is encouraged to coordinate local workshops with the standing committee chairpersons. Plans are underway to form an ad hoc committee to explore the possibility of establishing an accessibilities committee. We hold a state convention every February and plan to host the Southeast Regional Conference in August 1995.—*Charles Williams*

Maine: In February 1995 our Maine Area will host the fourth Northeast Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly (N.E.R.A.A.S.A.), in Portland. Currently the area, with 10,000 members and 750 groups, is divided into 18 districts covering 16 counties, as well as a portion of New Brunswick, Canada. Nearly all districts have local hotlines and the Portland Central Office has a statewide 800 number. Beside our area Archives, we have a mobile traveling Archival display. Many of our old-timers have been recorded on tape and more than 250 local A.A. group histories are now in the Archives. In 1995 we plan to publish a 60th Anniversary Maine Area History Book. This year our May Post-Conference Forum will include an area committee meeting. We have two weekend assemblies. It is our focus to reaffirm the primary importance of local group conscience in all A.A. decisions.—*Will Ruliffson*

Manitoba: Our area has 160 groups in 15 districts. Although Manitoba is officially bilingual (English/French) only one group is registered as unilingual and it is Spanish. Four assemblies plus two area committee meetings are held in various parts of the province. The majority of Manitoba's population is in the southern area of the province and this causes some difficulty in carrying the message to the remote northern area. Two central offices serve the province. All service committees are functioning well. Special needs groups, including new and older members, are one of our special interests. A recent inventory indicated two major concerns: a pronounced lack of service communication; and money management. An initial remedy is in place with more service communication. The area adopted a committee structure with each committee being responsible for finances. A preliminary budget revealed only 41% of groups contributed regularly. This is a major concern to our area. Our inventory certainly highlighted the areas in which we can best place our resources.—*David Wilson*

Maryland: Area 29 covers all of Maryland, with the exception of the Washington, D.C. suburbs. Our committees are active, mostly traveling to district workshops and conventions. Committees include: Archives, C.P.C., Corrections, Grapevine, Intergroup, Literature, "Margenser" (area newsletter), two area conventions, P.I., Treatment Weekend Assembly, and Workshop. While we have over 800 registered groups, total attendance at our five rotating area assemblies is usually around 150; half of the D.C.M.s attend our four rotating area committee meetings. Obviously, many groups are not participating in the general service structure. Group contributions to the area have decreased and the area committee has recommended a reduced budget for 1994. We are striving toward improved communications to attract A.A. members into service and to have a more informed group conscience.—*Valerie Wethered*

Massachusetts (Western): Our area has six districts, serving approximately 250 meetings a week. District 6 includes five northern Connecticut towns. We are including in our area agenda this year the possibility of some redistricting, as well as putting forth a concerted effort in establishing an area newsletter. Our main challenge is to get the communication flowing effectively and to strengthen the "Pass it on" philosophy to the new guy when anyone rotates out of a position. Our Archives, Grapevine, P.I., C.P.C., and relatively new Treatment Facilities committees are small in membership but big on work. The Institution committee is always well attended and active. Western Mass. Young Peoples Conference Committee is alive and well. We now have a two-year-old daytime P.I. committee that has helped in relieving the load. We will host the 31st Massachusetts State Convention, in cooperation with Area 30 and we are looking forward to hosting the 1995 Northeast Regional Forum (N.E.R.F.).—*Linda Bridge*

Michigan (Western): Service remains a strong emphasis in Area 34, which saw the addition of about 25 groups in the last year. While many of these groups are committed to all three A.A. Legacies, others emphasize only Recovery and pay little heed to Unity and Service. The area has wonderful support from past delegates and officers, which helps ensure that our Fellowship's history and Traditions are introduced to newcomers unfamiliar with the structure of A.A. There are 16 districts in our area; 14 hold monthly meetings well attended by G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. D.C.M.s meet monthly at our area assembly, where each offers a report of the district's activities. Our work in C.P.C. and correctional institutions is thriving in some sections of the area and struggling in others. We are grateful for the opportunity to host two conventions this year: the State Convention of the Great Lakes Regional Conference of Young People in A.A., and the Michigan State Convention, to be held in May.—*Pearl Runyon*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 covers the northern half of Minnesota and some cities in N.W. Wisconsin. We have about 530 groups in 20 districts, which are divided into four zones for the purpose of rotating the site of our assemblies and annual service workshop. Last year's area inventory revealed the importance of providing opportunities for G.S.R.s to express themselves, and we have found it beneficial to have a G.S.R. orientation session and sharing session at the assembly. One of our most exciting projects is a school presentation, which has been made to over 1,600 students in nine high schools. We have an active Archives committee; our C.P.C. committee has had a booth at several professional conventions; and our Correctional and Treatment Facilities committees are active. We keep in contact with each other through our newsletter, the

"Northern Light." We receive consistent financial support from the groups, and are in the process of implementing a Financial Responsibility Resolution. Clear and open communication encourages enthusiastic participation in all area activities, and we are grateful to the A.A. members and groups who keep Area 35 vigorous and healthy.—*Bruce Bates*

Mississippi: Our area has 24 districts and 224 groups. We have made great progress since separating our area assembly meetings from the conventions and roundups, and now have the time to have quarterly standing committee meetings. P.I. has a library containing A.A. video tapes, TV and radio spots; C.P.C. has an active committee in every district. The Treatment Facilities committee is busy, and every treatment center has an active A.A. name and phone number to call for help. The Correctional committee has made great strides in getting Big Books and A.A. pamphlets into jails and prisons and setting up A.A. meetings for the inmates. The Archives committee has a permanent repository at the intergroup office. The future holds much promise as we continue improving our system and getting our G.S.R.s involved more. We are all looking forward to improvements and challenges to keep us busy in the future.—*Billie Hobart*

Montana: Our area hosted the West Central Regional Service Conference for the first time and interest in service was expanded as a result. Our area assemblies, two a year, have a packed agenda, but we devote some time to workshops for committees and for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. We have a new district in the Bitterroot Valley; another district, which covered a lot of geography but contained few groups, merged back with a district it had previously split from; so our total number of districts remains at 16 serving approximately 350 groups. We assigned each D.C.M. to an area service committee and anticipate increased committee activity at the area level and, hopefully, in the district committees and in the ability of the groups to carry the message. We are beginning to get many more people trained through the prison orientation to better carry the message behind the walls. Many of these volunteers drive more than 200 miles each way. In Area 40, carrying the message often requires a willingness to travel great distances.—*Mark Sullivan*

Nebraska: Area 41 hosted the West Central Regional A.A. Service Conference in March. It is a privilege for our area to bring so many alcoholics together in Fellowship to help our region share experience, strength and hope. We recently adopted a set of financial guidelines to help the area be more accountable to the Fellowship; a very healthy endeavor for our area, which helps us to become more unified with the groups. We have a G.S.R. liaison who was a voting member of the area. As a result of our area inventory it was voted to remove the vote from the G.S.R. liaison because it was considered redundant. There are other ideas being considered concerning the budget allocation which comes with this position, which will be decided at our next area assembly. We look forward to the growth which will surface as a result of fresh new perspectives and ideas which will accompany the new people. Area 41 is doing the job at hand to the best of its ability—helping the alcoholic to achieve sobriety.—*Marvin Rumery*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: There are approximately 225 groups in 13 districts, which include English, French, and Native-speaking meetings. Our area includes two provinces: Prince Edward Island and New Brunswick. Area committees

include: Grapevine, Correctional and Treatment Facilities, P.I., C.P.C., Literature, and Conference and Roundups. Two assembly meetings (combined with roundups), two workshops and two committee meetings are sponsored each year. The highlight of 1993 would have to be the Eastern Canada Special Forum, in Prince Edward Island, last September. Since the Forum, we have had only positive results regarding all presentations, discussions and improved communications. A.A. is growing in Area 81, but our growth must be stimulated for continued Sobriety and Serenity.—*Raymond Steeves*

New Hampshire: Our area assembly includes over 600 groups in 15 districts. Rural geography and erratic participation have us reviewing various redistricting plans. Our area assembly office is fully computerized and annually ships nearly \$90,000 worth of Conference-approved literature. We publish a newsletter, meeting list, and various in-house bulletins. Unlike a central service office or intergroup, our assembly office takes part at every level of the general service structure. Currently 15 district committees contract separate hotline answering services, but we are considering a single statewide 800 number. At present we have no intergroups operating in New Hampshire; our assembly meets quarterly; our monthly committee meetings boast 75% attendance, but assemblies fail to attract the number of G.S.R.s we'd like. After several years of struggle we have a balanced budget and a stabilized prudent reserve. New Hampshire's spirit of sacrifice is shared as a group in Area 43. We are growing, hopefully with renewed dedication to our service responsibility.—*Karl Lamberg*

New Jersey (Southern): Our area has over 600 meetings, divided into four sections, subdivided into 31 districts (including one Spanish-speaking nongeographical district). We conduct committee and assembly meetings on a quarterly basis. Area 45 has 12 standing committees and three intergroups. Among our many events are: regular section and district meetings; area and district workshops; miniconference; area convention; assembly/intergroup day of sharing; a New Year's Eve alkathon; a deaf meeting (by the deaf for the deaf). We are bidding for the 1995 Northeast Regional Convention. There is a great potential for growth in both the number of meetings and the expansion of our geographical area. Our primary concerns for improvement at the present time are carrying the message through improved area communications, individual and group involvement, service sponsorship, and the Seventh Tradition.—*Ike Treadwell*

New Mexico: Our area has 326 groups in a geographical area that is almost 450 miles border to border and 500 miles corner to corner, with very few communities of high population. Many of these groups have just a few members and can barely afford group expenses, so there is little money left to contribute to other service activities. However, by their very existence the message is being carried to the most remote corners of our area. At our area inventory, we decided we were doing a commendable job but that some things could stand some improvement. We feel we definitely need to improve communication in order to promote unity. We also decided to change our committee system. In the past we have operated our standing committees with an area chair assisted by volunteers. This seems inefficient, so we are going to try to expand these to full committees of about five members. We are also going to look into computerizing our operations; the money for this is available due to the success of our State Convention. Our area is doing a very good job of carrying the message.—*Jesse Leming*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Our area has 840 groups in 13 districts. We have cities with near round-the-clock meetings and mountain villages with one meeting a week. Historically, our area has elected a treasurer who subsequently rotated to secretary, chairperson and delegate. The May 1993 assembly changed this. We now individually elect the chair, alternate chair, secretary and treasurer. The area chair continues to rotate to area delegate. We also added alternates for secretary and treasurer. This necessitated the realignment of duties for all officers. The area believes these changes will strengthen our services and communications to the groups. The area has revised its financial procedures and is well on the way to sound and consistent reporting. A new standing committee, Area Functions, will select the locations and assist in the planning of all area functions. Where have we been? Out there in the mountains and valleys carrying the message and growing. Where are we now? Facing the need to have the courage to change and doing so. Where are we going? Where-so-ever the Spirit and Strength of our Higher Power leads us.—*Jeanne Mattis*

New York (Western): This is a rich and exciting time for us. For the first time in our history, we have set up financial guidelines which have been adopted on a six-month trial basis. Cooperation is continuing to grow between our assembly, the central committee and two intergroups. We now have outstanding, active C.P.C. and Treatment Facilities committees. They function as a group, and group conscience has proven to be such a rewarding, effective and essential addition to these service areas, that our P.I.C., Grapevine, and Corrections chairs are forming functional committees as well. There are over 360 groups, in 23 districts. We hold ten assemblies a year in different locations. We are host to three major events this year: NER-AASA '94, WNY GSA's Spring Service Convention and the New York State Convention. We have elected, active D.C.M.s and district meetings in about 20% of our districts. Our growth in this area has been steady and it is a joy to watch our members and area reap the benefits of committed service.—*Shawn D'Luhy*

North Dakota: Our area has 2,871 active members in 171 reported groups and 13 districts. Our committee system is still in a stage of development; the committees are: Agenda/Structure; P.I./GvR/C.P.C.; Institutions; Finance/Budget; Archives; Literature/Newsletter. We are looking forward to growing and being able to spend more time on our primary purpose. The area holds three assemblies a year, rotating between the east and west side of the state, allowing more groups to become involved. The September assembly is held in conjunction with the state convention. D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s are encouraged to approach their groups and stress the Seventh Tradition; today we can pay our expenses because the groups came through. We have a very enthusiastic group of area trusted servants and I am optimistic that Area 52 will grow spiritually, physically, and emotionally in the Fellowship.—*Dorothy Neurohr*

Ohio (Northwest) and Michigan (Southeast): Area 55 has 15 districts with approximately 300 groups. We operate with a Prudent Reserve of \$2,000, with any excess being sent to G.S.O. quarterly. Our area assembly meets monthly and has an area conference in March. Our D.C.M.s have bimonthly meetings prior to our area assembly, along with visiting their G.S.R.s throughout the year. Our committees include: C.P.C., Grapevine, Archives, New Group, Shut-in, and Audiovisual. All other committees are handled through their local intergroup. The New Group committee helps newly formed groups get registered, explains the service structure, along with self-support,

and shares experiences. The Shut-in committee services those unable to attend meetings. This is done through cards, phone calls, and visits. We are hosting the 1994 Ohio State Conference and our Spanish community will have a meeting room, program in Spanish, and translation of speeches.—*Roger Smith*

Ohio (Southwest): Our area has 30 districts, serving 538 groups in 16 counties. Half our districts are active and hold regular district meetings. We hold monthly general assemblies, and time is allowed for more input from G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. We have good communications with the two intergroups in our area. At our general assemblies the Education committee provides a class for new G.S.R.s. They also go to groups, new and old, for information sessions and maintain a service sponsorship list. Our Grapevine and Literature committees have been successful, and are now developing traveling displays to take to groups that do not have literature at their meetings. The P.I./C.P.C. committee has been communicating with high schools and retirement communities, sending out literature and providing speakers. The Correctional Facilities committee held a workshop for staff and inmates at the Dayton Monday Program. Our Archives committee is collecting group histories and recording oldtimers. The computerization of area records allows D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s access to group information that may be more current than G.S.O. records.—*Jack Connors*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 has 550 groups in 23 districts. The area committee meets three times a year and we have two assemblies; districts hold 23 monthly meetings. Our area is divided geographically and there are subcommittee chairs in both sections for P.I., C.P.C., Treatment, Corrections, and Grapevine. The area also supplies service literature to the districts upon request. Our alternate delegate serves as intergroup liaison. We have seven intergroups in the area and have been working toward improved cooperation and communication. In 1993 we conducted an area inventory. The feeling was that we could be doing better in providing the link between the groups and the Conference, and stimulating an interest in general service. Improved communications between all levels of service and increasing the number of groups supporting our service structure are goals of our new area committee.—*Judy Allard*

Oregon: We now have 740 registered groups and 34 districts, of which 33 are active. Our newest district is a Spanish-speaking district at large, which started last year with ten groups and is now at 15. We have area chair and co-chairs of P.I., C.P.C., and C.T.F. committees. We also have an area Archives chair. All our committees are active and cooperating with districts and groups. We have four assemblies a year, one general election and three quarterly with the G.S.R.s voting at each assembly. Our assembly moves to different districts to give more groups an opportunity to participate. It's a 10- to 12-hour drive from one corner of the state to the other. Our quarterly assemblies have workshops on topics such as the Conference, group problems, Traditions, Concepts and any other A.A. subjects groups express a need for.—*Don Johnson*

Puerto Rico: In Puerto Rico A.A. functions with only one structure of service. The service area committee is divided into seven districts, with 124 groups and one G.S.R. per group. The district and service area hold meetings each month. Our general service office is located in the town of Bayamon, with two employees working full-time distributing literature, answering the Twelfth Steps calls, helping the P.I. committee, and being in touch with the media and the professional community. At last year's annu-

al convention we had the honor of having the Surgeon General of the United States, Dra. Antonia Novello de Coello, as our guest speaker, who emphasized the problem of child alcoholism throughout the nation. Recently we published the history of A.A. in Puerto Rico.—*Julio Colón*

Quebec (Northwest): Our area covers the entire northwestern province of Quebec. The majority of our 420 groups, divided in 21 districts, are located in the southern portion, while a small number of groups are scattered in the James Bay region, isolated from each other and from the services provided by the area. Our project to offer our help to these groups is moving along despite numerous difficulties, such as language and cultural barriers, great distances, and hard to reach villages that can only be visited by plane and contacted by radio. On the other hand, Area 90 has built up sufficient structural capabilities and enough maturity to propose area assemblies and meeting participation to our southern minority groups. We extended our last assembly to a weekend-long session. Our area is looking into the possibility of maximizing the use of moneys from contributions, sales of literature, conventions etc., in order that our primary purpose will be our only concern.—*Fernand Lachaine*

Quebec (Southwest): Our area has 30 districts, 591 groups and a membership of about 16,000. We have meetings in French, English, Spanish, Greek and Italian. There are ten area committees: P.I., C.P.C., Treatment, Corrections, Montreal Bilingual, A.A. Conventions, Helpline, Group Services, Internal Communications, Grapevine and the Vigne A.A. We are in the process of forming an Archives committee. We hold three general assemblies a year. One general assembly is to welcome and inform the new D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s and coordinators. We are very proud of our Training Session Program which gives future trusted servants a better knowledge of the A.A. structure. 1994 is a great year for A.A. in Quebec. We are celebrating our 50th anniversary and you are all invited to the Montreal Bilingual Convention which will be held in October.—*George Bellefeuille*

Rhode Island: Rhode Island is "uniquely small in size—Lucky for us." We rent two rooms, which house our Archives and feature a fire-resistant safe. The standing committees meet there regularly, as do two districts and the area committee. All groups consist of two speakers sharing their service message, introductions of service reps., a question and answer period, along with Conference-approved literature, and a raffle. We have a registrar, who meets with district and group secretaries, and the area treasurer makes himself available to district and group treasurers. Districts are encouraged to offer a structure school at each district meeting. So, as you can see, we can easily carry the message to the groups. Our main thrust in the next two years will be to bring the new groups to us.—*Betty Mac James*

Saskatchewan: We have 329 groups, about 4,500 members, and 18 districts. After a 19-month evaluation, one of our urban centers decided to redistrict from two to four, resulting in a more manageable number of groups. About 95% of our members live south of the geographic center of the province. The remaining 5% are scattered over the north country and have awesome problems in maintaining communication. There are groups in many small centers that are great distances apart. The necessity of air travel to those communities with no roads makes it a near impossibility for the groups and districts to be self-supporting. Our area established a District Development Fund to bring some northern people into assemblies and to carry workshops into the north wherever possible. We plan to

expand the sphere of activity to some of the more southern groups. For several years we have had an elected area Corrections chairperson and for the last two years we have appointed area chairs for C.P.C., P.I., Literature, Institutions and Grapevine, with the objective of identifying opportunities for improved information flow to the districts.—*Dawson Young*

South Carolina: Our area has 22 districts. We have three area committee meetings per year that are approximately 30 days before each of our three assemblies. Input is used to plan the agenda for the upcoming assembly, which are weekend meetings. The program usually consists of: standing committee meetings; an informal D.C.M./delegate sharing session; a service-related workshop, and an evening open speaker meeting; and a business session with area officers' and D.C.M. reports, and G.S.R. time. All voting is done on Sunday. We have very active standing committees, with not only a chairperson, but also regional cochairmen from other parts of the area. This action, along with several district splits over the last few years, has brought an influx of new people into service, who bring new enthusiasm, energy, and appreciation for A.A. This, we hope, is being gently and lovingly nurtured by past officers and old-timers. We currently have six past delegates still active. Recovery, Unity and Service are alive and growing in South Carolina.—*Wil Scarborough*

South Dakota: Our area has 14 districts, 149 registered groups and a membership of over 3,200. Being a large rural area, our assembly meets four times a year; two assemblies rotate, while the two workshops are centrally located. Our P.I., C.P.C., Institutions, Literature and Minority committees hold workshops on how to better carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. It has been encouraging to see more districts putting on P.I. and C.P.C. luncheons and involved in health fairs. The delegate's report to the area assembly, along with plenty of time for discussion, has kept the lines of communication open between the delegate and D.C.M.s. All of the area officers, committee chairs and many D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s have just rotated and it is very spiritual to see new people as our trusted servants.—*Kevin Ernst*

Tennessee: A.A. in Tennessee is doing an outstanding job of carrying the message of recovery through its 468 groups in 38 districts. Our area assembly meets on a quarterly basis, in a different host city. We have a G.S.R. orientation program and an area committee meeting for the area officers and the D.C.M.s. We maintain a state assembly office in Nashville, which also is the depository for our Archives. We have just published the second edition of our Area 64 Newsletter, which includes the minutes of our assemblies and financial reports. Communication to the membership is the main focus. We adopted a service structure in 1967 which embraces the same language and principles of the A.A. Service Manual. Our greatest assets are love for our fellow man and service to our Fellowship in the spirit of anonymity.—*Charles Matthews*

Texas (Northwest): Our area stretches over 500 miles from north to south. In 1993 we approached the task of redistricting, trying to distribute over 260 groups into 10 districts. In El Paso, a Spanish-speaking district was formed. The area bought translation equipment for use in our quarterly assemblies and wherever needed in the area. The State Hispanic Convention was held in El Paso in February. We have added Archives and Literature committees to our standing committees. There are new prisons going up all over and our Correctional Facilities chair devotes an extraordinary amount of time and energy visit-

ing these new facilities. The treasurer raffles Conference-approved literature at assemblies to help defray the cost of the assembly. This has proven to be a very effective method of self-support for our assemblies. Our main challenge is to generate interest and support for our area committees.—*Mary Ann Boggess*

Texas (Southwest): The increasing number of prison units in our area has required more widespread coverage of meetings. The decrease in treatment centers has resulted in a renewed interest in Twelfth Step work. More Spanish districts have formed, and a committee is raising funds to purchase translating equipment. Grapevine subscriptions have increased. Mini workshops were held all over the area at a rate of about one a week; two new conferences were held, and the first Corrections Conference was held in the area with members from four states attending. The area continues to fund literature for correction facilities. We now have 411 groups, 31 districts, and 28 D.C.M.s. At our January area workshop an ad hoc committee was formed to study the resources available to reach the hearing impaired. The area strongly urged the reinstatement of the A.A. logo on all Conference literature and pamphlets.—*Sandy Champ*

Vermont: Area 70 is where Dr. Bob plied his medical trade and probably not coincidentally also the birthplace of Bill W. And while we sometimes hidebound recovering Vermonters do not confuse the personalities with the principles, it's still an incredibly powerful feeling to be so centered. Our area assembly meets quarterly; our service seminars include an April pre-Conference sharing weekend, where we work on developing an informed group conscience. We also hold a November orientation for new G.S.R.s and others interested in the benefits of service. In June we hosted the New England Regional Forum in Burlington. Plans for 1994 include working toward increased financial responsibility and service participation at the area level, an area newsletter, area meetings and an increased role for the D.C.M.s. A.A. is a program of action—"How it Works," not "How It Happens." We hope to help Area 70 groups carry the A.A. message that we can stay away from a drink one day at a time together. As the billboard in Las Vegas proclaimed: "You must be present to win!"—*Mary Ellen O'Brien*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 has approximately 630 registered groups. As a result of growth in the area, we are redistricting. For over two years, the area worked on drafting by-laws, which were ultimately defeated. This, in a sense, seemed at first to tear down our Unity, but with a new effectiveness and a new spirit of cooperation, Area 74 moved ahead once more. Area business is handled at the two assemblies per year. The time at the conferences will be devoted to the delegate's report and a continuation of the mini-service seminar. There will also be service workshops, service panels and meetings of the standing committees. Because of geographical distance, we now have two Corrections chairpersons, one for Wisconsin and one for the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. Our area is fortunate to have many of its past delegates actively involved in service. With the Spirit guiding our thoughts and actions, Area 74 will continue to grow and aggressively pursue our primary purpose.—*Doreen Mathison*

Gay Walters (Utah) was spotted outside a N.Y. restaurant, soliciting funds with a styrofoam cup. (A skill he used to be quite good at in the old days.) He collected 50¢!

Additional Committee Considerations That Did Not Result in Recommendations

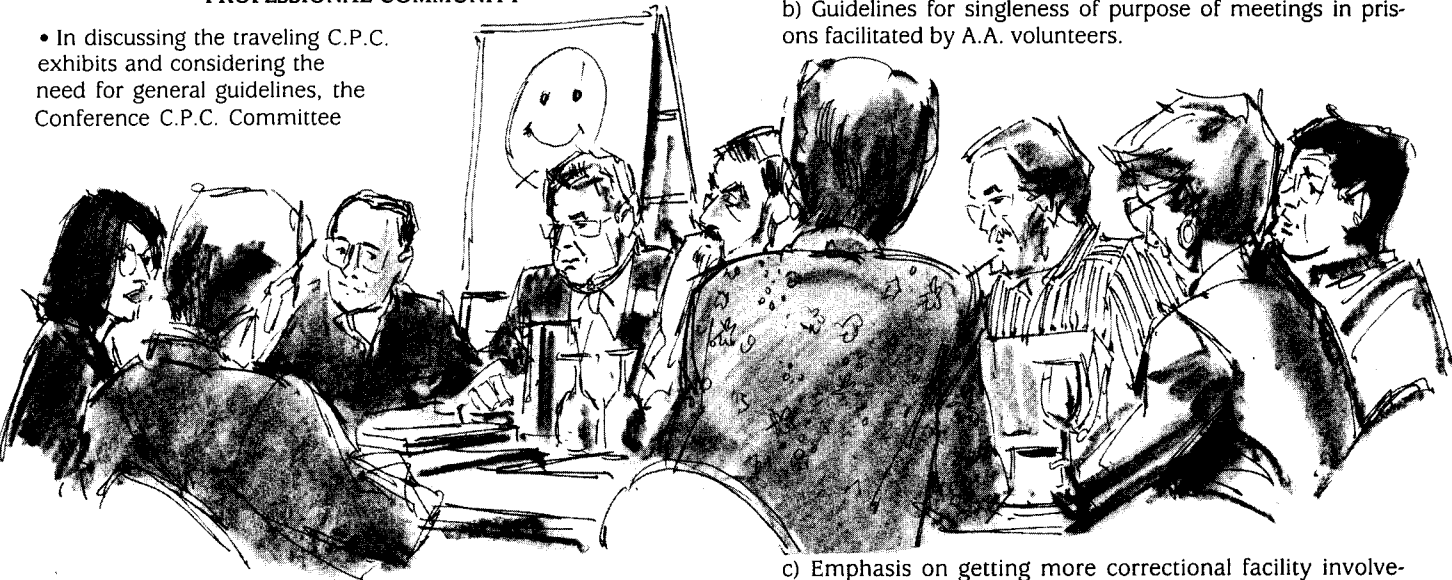
Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Conference Report." Those committee recommendations which are not adopted (less than 2/3 of the total Conference votes in favor), but which received at least a simple majority of the votes, are considered "strong suggestions" of the Conference. All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The Annual General Service Conference Questionnaire and Questionnaire Summary Results were reviewed and the committee suggested some editorial changes which will be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for their consideration.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- In discussing the traveling C.P.C. exhibits and considering the need for general guidelines, the Conference C.P.C. Committee



requests that their recommendation regarding traveling C.P.C. exhibits, as described below, be referred to the trustees' C.P.C. Committee for consideration, and that a report be sent to the 1995 Conference C.P.C. Committee as background.

- a) The C.P.C. exhibit continue to be sent, upon invitation and within budgetary constraints, to such national conventions of professional organizations that may be reasonably presumed to have a significant concern with alcoholics.
- b) The list of exhibits at professional conventions be reviewed by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee at least twice a year.
- c) Local committees be encouraged to exhibit at local or regional professional conventions, and that such exhibits be supported at the most appropriate local level, i.e., district, intergroup, area.
- d) The C.P.C. staff person continue to facilitate such requests, bearing in mind the principles of attraction, cooperation and self-support.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee considered a suggestion that a letter providing information about Alcoholics Anonymous and its Correctional Facilities services be sent to wardens of correctional facilities in the U.S. and Canada and asked the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee to consider having the staff develop and distribute such a letter.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee have staff develop a letter to all U.S. and Canada correctional facilities chairpersons outlining long-term goals and current discussions going on about A.A. correctional services, and to ask them their needs and what can be done by trustees' and Conference C.F. Committees and G.S.O. to help them with their work.
- The committee asked the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee to review the C.F. Workbook with particular attention to the following:
 - a) Consider removing "being concerned" with inmates coping with denial on page 23.
 - b) Guidelines for singleness of purpose of meetings in prisons facilitated by A.A. volunteers.

- c) Emphasis on getting more correctional facility involvement at the district and group level.
- d) More guidelines for working with young offenders or juvenile detention units.
- e) Guidelines for setting up permanent, statewide or area post office box addresses for receiving communication on correspondence service with inmates, pre-release contacts and literature requests.
- f) Guidelines for men working with men and women working with women as pre-release contacts.

FINANCE

- The committee considered publication of a one-page explanation of the Reserve Fund and suggested that the explanation of the Reserve Fund from the Finance Guidelines be included in the self-support pamphlet.
- After review the committee concluded that the General Service Office General Ledger is a viable, workable package which can be used on a current ongoing basis to provide up-to-date infor-

mation to the general manager and board of trustees. Further, we believe the information goes a long way in helping explain to the Fellowship where the money goes and we will keep striving to make it more meaningful.

- The committee reviewed a letter and the trustees' Finance Committee's reply concerning proposal to split G.S.O., and took no action.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reaffirmed 1992 Conference Advisory Action #23:

"In order to achieve some uniformity of procedure and to gain desired Conference input to Grapevine special items, yet not to compromise the Grapevine Board's 'right of decision' to manage the fiscal affairs of the Grapevine, let it be proposed that:

"Based on the positive model of mutual Conference and Board involvement in the production of *The Language of the Heart*, the Grapevine Corporate Board offer to the Conference Grapevine Committee on an ongoing basis, a general list of proposed special items at least two years in advance of possible production, in order that the Conference could offer any guidance or register any disapproval they might have. Having so presented the conceptual basis of these special items to the Conference Committee, final approval for the completed items would rest with the Grapevine Corporate Board."

- The committee discussed a suggestion to cease production of all special items that do not contain articles taken directly from the magazine, and took no action.

- The committee discussed the feasibility of discontinuing Grapevine special items that no longer seem useful and review the Grapevine Corporate Board's preliminary guidelines for discontinuance of items. The committee encouraged the process of establishing guidelines for the future and suggested the board consider informing the Conference Grapevine Committee prior to any final discontinuance of magazine-related items.

- The committee endorsed the Grapevine Corporate Board's proposal for producing an undated, generic Grapevine in 1996, and suggested that the Grapevine Corporate Board also consider producing it in Spanish.

Strong suggestion of the Conference (recommendation where the vote was less than 2/3, but more than 1/2 in favor):

- That, because the Wall Calendars and Pocket Planners do not seem to adhere to the Grapevine's primary purpose, these items be discontinued after production and distribution of the 1995 edition of the Calendar and Pocket Planner. Based on recent experience, the financial impact on the 1995 budget could be an estimated net loss of \$35,000 to \$40,000.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

- The committee suggested that area/state/provincial convention committees be lovingly requested to consider not planning conventions six weeks before or after the 1995 International Convention, since attendance at local events during the period might be adversely affected.

LITERATURE

- The committee discussed a request from an area to produce a

pocket-sized edition of the Big Book stories and have it packaged with the pocket-sized edition of the first 164 pages, and suggested there did not seem to be an expressed need for this book at the present time.

- The committee discussed the Literature Review Subcommittee report and suggested that the committee continue to convene when necessary.

- The committee reviewed suggested changes to the pamphlet "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" and suggested that, in light of new requests for additional changes, the pamphlet be sent back to the Trustees' Literature Committee for further deliberation.

- The committee reviewed a draft of A.A. Guidelines for Literature Committees and accepted same as written.

- The committee reviewed requests for a 4th Edition of the Big Book and suggested a letter be sent to all delegates seeking Fellowship input on the desirability of a 4th Edition.

- The committee discussed feedback from a letter sent to delegates regarding production of a book with stories from the 1st, 2nd and 3rd Editions of the Big Book, and determined no expressed need existed at the present time.

- The committee reviewed all correspondence regarding the 1993 Conference Advisory Action #19, i.e. "A.A.W.S. produce a pocket-sized version of the Big Book with all front matter (Preface, and various Forewords, Doctor's Opinion). Basic text, Dr. Bob's Story and Appendices," and concluded that the proper Conference process was followed in regard to the book and that an expressed need for the book had been demonstrated.

- The committee discussed a request to print a pocket edition of the Big Book with stories and suggested that an expressed need was not exhibited at the present time.

- The committee discussed a request from an area to publish a pamphlet of the Twelve Steps only and returned it to the trustees' Literature Committee for further research, at the urging of the area that originally submitted the idea.

- The committee discussed a request to consider publication of a booklet on "service" and determined that the need for material on service is addressed in the *A.A. Service Manual* and also in the piece which has been included in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."



- The committee discussed a request from an area to produce a pocket-sized edition of the Big Book stories and have it packaged with the pocket-sized edition of the first 164 pages—and suggested there did not seem to be an expressed need for this book at the present time.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed a request to set the Conference theme two Conferences ahead instead of one, and decided that the custom of setting the theme on an annual basis provides a means for the Conference to remain sensitive to current needs and requirements of the Fellowship.
- The committee discussed a request to consider the inclusion of central offices/intergroups in the general service structure and affirmed that central offices/intergroups perform vital functions independent from the General Service Conference structure; and that the local A.A. community has the responsibility to recognize, support, communicate and cooperate with their central offices/intergroups.
- The committee considered some suggestions to improve relations with intergroups/central offices and reaffirmed the suggestions of the 1991 Policy/Admissions Committee that "...many of the problems and concerns are local and vary from area to area and that doors of communication and participation continue to be opened at the area level. The committee would again like to stress the importance of delegates maintaining contact with offices in their areas and assuring them they do have a voice in the Fellowship through their existing service structure."
- The committee considered a request that, based on health considerations for some Conference members, the General Service Conference adopt a nonsmoking policy. The committee suggests:
 - a) The General Service Conference not adopt a nonsmoking policy at this time.
 - b) The smoking/nonsmoking sections remain the same as at the 1994 Conference.
 - c) That each committee exercise autonomy with regard to smoking in committee meetings.
- The committee considered suggestions for changing the deadline for proposed Conference Agenda items and reaffirmed the 1993 Advisory Action #26 as follows:



"In order for groups/districts/areas to fully participate in the Conference process, the following steps be taken:

"a) Conference agenda items be submitted as early as possible but no later than January 15 each year.

"b) Final Conference committee agendas be automatically sent to all Conference members by February 15 each year.

"c) Background material for each specific committee be sent to its members by February 15 each year, with other committees' background material available upon request."

- The committee considered a suggestion that all delegates receive copies of all material sent to any delegate from the General Service Office and the committee encouraged the General Service Office to continue to forward to all Conference members any material which could affect the Conference as a whole.
- The committee considered a request that major publications be brought to the body of the A.A. Fellowship to determine the need for such material prior to Conference approval and felt that no action was necessary.
- The committee considered reaffirming the 1989 Advisory Action #38 (regarding questionnaires) and felt that reaffirmation was not necessary.
- The committee considered a suggestion that new or collateral issues raised on the floor of the Conference be tabled pending a



Profile of a Delegate

The average age of a delegate is 52.6 years, with the oldest being 72 and the youngest 32 years; average length of sobriety 13.8 years, longest sobriety 36 years and shortest 6 years; average length of service 11.5 years, longest 23, shortest 5 years. (Compiled on responses from 80 delegates.)

presentation to groups and reaffirmed the right of decision of the Conference since all Conference members act in the best interest of A.A. as a whole.

- The committee considered that all recommendations be accompanied by a sheet initialed by each one of the committee members who had reviewed them and decided that no action was needed.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and suggested that paragraph two (2) of the Composition be revised to be in keeping with the procedure of how the committee is selected.
- The committee listened to radio spot #5 in Public Service Announcement R-09 and agreed with and accepted the trustees' Public Information Committee's report that this spot contains a positive and honest message.
- The committee discussed the suggestion that a tag line be added to existing radio and TV Public Service Announcements indicating that this is a "Public Service Announcement" and agreed that this can sometimes be done by the station when requested by local Public Information committees. The committee suggests this notation be included in the Public Information Workbook.
- The committee considered the suggestion that a special anonymity letter or packet of information be prepared for talk show producers and hosts. The committee agreed that the annual anonymity letter to the media is sufficient and follow-up should be left to local autonomy.
- The committee accepts with substantial unanimity the report and recommendations from the trustees' Public Information Committee on the Membership Survey as requested by the 1993 Conference. These recommendations are:

- a) that it is worth going forward and conducting a sample survey of the A.A. membership.
- b) that we delay the survey for one year to enable us to ensure that the formation of the questions on the questionnaire and that the methods of gathering data are sound and in accordance with accepted statistical practice.

The committee suggests that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider the sharing from Eastern Ontario in formulating questions for the next Membership Survey.

- The committee reviewed the anonymity discussion questions prepared in 1993 and sent to delegates for distribution to groups in their areas. Since there has been an absence of feed-

back from the Fellowship the committee requests that the trustees' Public Information committee continue to encourage discussion on the spiritual principles of anonymity, focusing specifically on posthumous anonymity of our co-founders in some format that generates open-ended discussion and report back to the Public Information desk. The committee also requests that consideration be given to include these questions with a future mailing of Box 4-5-9 so that all groups listed will have the opportunity to participate in this discussion.

- The committee requests the Public Information secretary carefully review the contents of the P.I. Discount Packages.

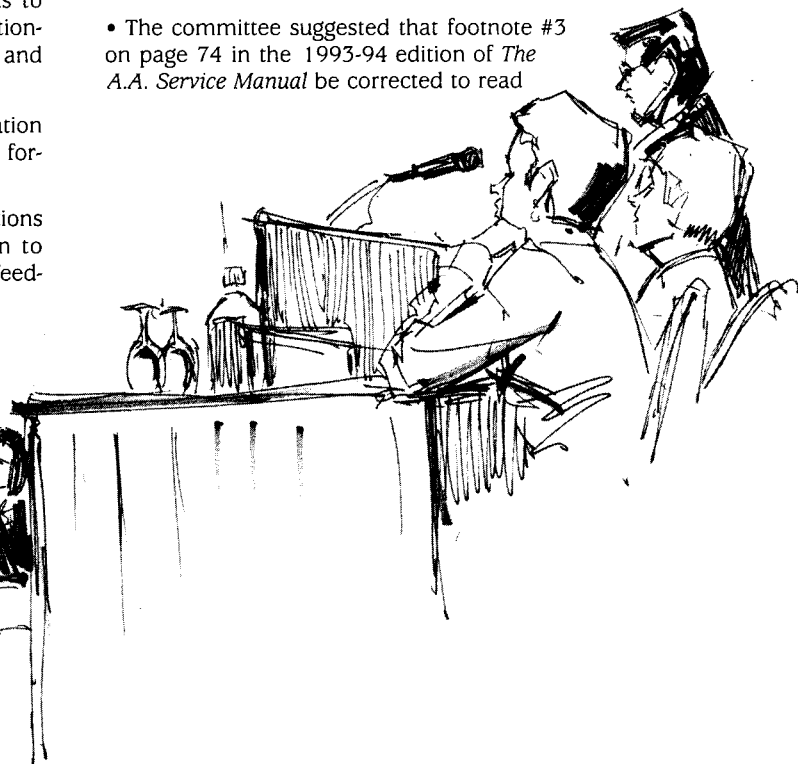
REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee suggested that the following footnotes appear at the bottom of S103 in *The A.A. Service Manual*:

"In 1993, Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc., announced that official use of all of the several circle/triangle trademarks and service marks was being discontinued — that is, those symbols would no longer be employed as trademarks and service marks. Therefore, A.A.W.S. would no longer object to the use of the logos by others, whether A.A.s or non-A.A.s. A.A. groups, service entities, and members, are free to use the circle/triangle designs, similar to their use of slogans and the like. Alcoholics Anonymous will continue to oppose unauthorized use of the registered trademarks "AA" or "Alcoholics Anonymous," whether or not used with the circle and triangle, as well as our other registered marks: "The Big Book," "Box 4-5-9," "The Grapevine," "GV," "A.A. Grapevine," and "Box 1980."

***Prior to 1993, much of the unauthorized use of A.A. trademarks and service marks by both non-A.A.s and A.A.s was concerned with the circle/triangle symbols. As indicated in the preceding footnote, the circle/triangle design is no longer being used as an A.A. trademark or service mark.*

- The committee reviewed a revised version of the "Structure of the Fellowship" Chart for page S23 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*, and took no action.
- The committee suggested that footnote #3 on page 74 in the 1993-94 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* be corrected to read



"However, the name Alcoholics Anonymous and the abbreviation A.A. were legally registered in 1972."

- The committee discussed the request that a distinction be made in *The A.A. Service Manual* between Advisory Actions and informational text, and felt that there is no need for this change.
- The committee discussed the suggestion to eliminate the last sentence in the last subparagraph on page S34, in the section entitled The General Service Board: Composition, Jurisdiction, Responsibilities, which reads: "It is nevertheless understood that the Board shall at all times reserve the right to decide which of its actions or decisions may require the approval of the Conference," and replace it with: "It is nevertheless understood that the Conference shall at all times reserve the right to decide which actions or decisions of the board have negatively impacted A.A. as a whole and have the option of reversing those actions or decisions by Conference action" and felt that there is no need for this change.
- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the following paragraph deleted from *The A.A. Service Manual*, in the section Working Together—General Services and Local Intergroup Services: "In areas where there are central offices providing the services mentioned previously, general service committees *do not attempt to duplicate these services*, but in those areas where there is little or no central office activity, the general service committee has frequently undertaken to provide many of these services," and felt that there is no need for this change.
- The committee discussed initiating a review of *The A.A. Service Manual* to consider if it adequately serves the Fellowship in its current form, and felt there is no need at this time.
- The committee considered a request from the trustees' Conference Committee to review the size and content of the *Final Conference Report* and the committee suggested that the *Final Conference Report* be shortened, possibly by:
 - a) Further editing the General Service, A.A.W.S., Grapevine Board, trustee and staff reports, and trustee biographies.
 - b) Eliminating the Regional Map.
 - c) Eliminating the Conference Membership Chart.
 - d) Only list Contributions by Delegate Area.
- The committee discussed the Early Bird, and suggested that the size of the Early Bird edition of Box 4-5-9 be reduced to four pages to include an overview of the Conference, highlights of Advisory Actions, and an overview of finances, eliminating the General Service, A.A.W.S., Grapevine Board, trustee committee and staff reports; these reports will appear in the June/July Conference issue of Box 4-5-9. The projected cost savings will be between \$8,000 and \$9,000 based on a production run of 10,000 copies.
- The committee considered the suggestion to write the biographies of the trustees in the *Final Conference Report* in the past tense, stating the committee the trustee served on at the time of the Conference, and what the new committee, if any, will be after rotation in April, but took no action.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the Treatment Facilities Workbook and felt that no changes were necessary at this time.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed and unanimously approved as eligible for election all candidates for regional trustee for the Pacific U.S. and Eastern Canada regions.
- Recognizing that the By-Laws of the General Service Board allow for either a Class A or Class B trustee to serve as chairperson of the board, the committee thanked the trustees' Nominating Committee for their report.
- The committee reviewed a preliminary procedure for the formation of new regions and/or making alterations in the regional map presented by the trustees' Nominating Committee and agreed that more specific procedures are needed, taking into account such factors as: 1) Possible balance change in terms of regional representation; 2) Possible ratio of Class B to Class A; 3) Possible change in ratio of board members elected/coming through the Fellowship; 4) Possible concurrent reduction in at-large/General Service/Class A trustees; and 5) Expenses. The committee requested that the Nominating Committee continue working with the Conference Committee on Trustees to develop a procedure for establishing new regions and/or making alterations to the regional map and report back to the 1995 Conference Committee on Trustees.
- The committee suggested that the method of Conference approval of trustees' slate, officers of the General Service Board and directors of corporate boards be referred to the 1995 Report & Charter Committee to examine the wording used throughout the "Current Conference Charter," By-Laws of the General Service Board, and *The A.A. Service Manual* for consistency with Article #10 of the Charter. In addition, the committee suggested that the matter of whether to approve the new trustees individually be considered by the 1995 Conference Committee on Trustees.
- The committee considered the proposed change of procedure to elect regional trustees and suggested that no change be made at this time.
- The committee discussed adding "four years' area committee experience" to the requirements for applicants for appointed committee member and nontrustee director vacancies and is satisfied with the current practice regarding requirements for applicants, which includes an emphasis on experience in the A.A. service structure.
- The committee discussed a proposal to reduce nontrustee director terms from four (4) years to two (2) years and could reach no consensus. The committee referred this matter back to the trustees' Nominating Committee for further consideration and additional background information.

Written one night, after a late committee meeting, by Hucky Dredhart (Northeast Ontario):

Somehow my gift seems so small

After seeing what A.A. has done for one and all

Caring, sharing and trying to help those who have continually fought

Remembering it would all be for naught

If we took and gave back nothing from what we got

From time to time I must remember where I might be

If it weren't for the gift of sobriety

Come then and help those who may come our way

Enabling them to enjoy a new life each and every day

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
COMBINED STATEMENTS OF INCOME, EXPENSES AND CHANGES IN NET ASSETS
Years Ended December 31, 1993 and 1992

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Combined 1993	Combined 1992
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE							
Gross Sales				\$ 9,720,488	\$ 2,044,174	\$ 11,764,662	\$ 12,281,398
Less: Discounts				405,722	43,365	449,087	455,861
Net Sales				9,314,766	2,000,809	11,315,575	11,825,537
Cost of Literature Distributed							
Printing				(2,999,007)	(345,578)	(3,344,585)	(3,531,056)
Royalties on books				(956,499)	-	(956,499)	(1,007,032)
Gross Margin				5,359,260	1,655,231	7,014,491	7,287,449
Direct shipping and warehousing				(834,404)	(383,916)	(1,218,320)	(1,450,858)
Gross Profit from Literature				4,524,856	1,271,315	5,796,171	5,836,591
CONTRIBUTIONS — A.A. groups and members	\$3,808,665					3,808,665	4,131,124
INVESTMENT INCOME	2,738	\$ 503,550		4,996	82,646	593,930	579,873
Total Income	3,811,403	503,550		4,529,852	1,353,961	10,198,766	10,547,588
OPERATING EXPENSES (Schedule A-1)							
Salaries	2,373,980			1,239,635	682,179	4,295,794	4,220,967
Payroll taxes	190,802			100,074	53,713	344,589	326,043
Health and group insurance	401,909			206,101	98,323	706,333	647,558
Retirement expenses	189,207			93,600	41,842	324,649	288,980
	3,155,898			1,639,410	876,057	5,671,365	5,483,548
Other operating expenses	2,102,967			732,462	409,913	3,245,342	3,669,884
Total Operating Expenses	5,258,865			2,371,872	1,285,970	8,916,707	9,153,432
Relocation, construction and duplicate rent (includes expenditures on capital projects - 1992 - \$1,743,841 - see contra below)							2,204,930
Total Expenses	5,258,865			2,371,872	1,285,970	8,916,707	11,358,362
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(1,447,462)	503,550		2,157,980	67,991	1,282,059	(810,774)
NET ASSETS							
Balance, January 1	57,013	6,724,422	\$ 2,206,557	2,312,606	549,577	11,850,175	11,313,761
Increase - expenditures on capital projects (see contra above)						13,132,234	10,502,987
							1,743,841
			2,206,557			13,132,234	12,246,828
Decrease - depreciation on capital projects			(348,054)			(348,054)	(396,653)
			1,858,503			12,784,180	11,850,175
Intercompany donations	1,447,462	715,000		(2,047,462)	(115,000)		
Balance, December 31	57,013	7,942,972	1,858,503	2,423,124	502,568	12,784,180	11,850,175

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
SCHEDULE OF OPERATING EXPENSES BY ACTIVITY**

Years Ended December 31, 1993 and 1992

	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	Regional Forums	International Convention	Publishing	Grapevine	Supporting Services	1993 Total	1992 Total
Operating Expenses										
Salaries	\$ 575,188	\$ 657,823	\$ 94,707	\$ 84,526	\$ 26,572	\$ 690,729	\$ 408,424	\$ 1,757,825	\$ 4,295,794	\$ 4,220,967
Payroll taxes	43,021	53,117	7,330	6,648	1,480	55,359	28,943	148,691	344,589	326,043
Health and group insurance	116,194	82,294	11,066	9,569	3,078	103,880	49,285	330,967	706,333	647,558
Retirement expense	40,183	49,436	6,847	6,130	1,543	51,795	22,958	145,757	324,649	288,980
Other program printing	284,173	40,773	74,932	12,218		727		5,728	418,551	509,825
Mailing labor	79,151	591	2,185	2,259				1,262	85,448	34,707
Postage and express	112,359	8,720	6,755	9,793		85,057	11,546	27,865	262,095	212,745
Writers fees	1,373		7,683			4,933		12,979	26,968	214,697
Foreign literature assistance		98,501				181		825	99,507	100,338
Selling expenses	568					33,422	135,399	6,722	176,111	157,850
Professional fees								208,419	208,419	245,994
Contracted services	10,833	58,341	367	1,167		10,619	10,803	21,110	113,240	28,955
Occupancy	70,254	73,563	5,817	5,817	1,284	95,713	57,669	290,704	600,821	645,867
Telephone	19,947	15,028	2,170	2,002	530	17,959	13,553	41,130	112,319	100,165
Furniture and equipment maintenance	2,669	633			104	404		73,500	77,310	83,005
Furniture and equipment	2,056	17,157	1,469	1,381	1,381	20,441		59,330	103,215	86,751
Stationery and office	54,069	902	2,529	5,731	3	986	16,398	81,960	162,578	144,043
Office service and expense	5,877	6,915	5,634	1,612	38	8,127	16,398	142,312	186,913	313,970
Travel, meals and accommodations	262	18,250	293,500	46,634		8,061		292,161	658,868	832,434
Bad debts								18,476	18,476	26,902
Conference fees			(65,497)						(65,497)	(68,364)
	1,418,177	1,182,044	457,494	195,487	36,013	1,188,393	771,376	3,667,723	8,916,707	9,153,432
Allocation of supporting services to activities	849,234	707,832	273,957	117,062	21,565	1,183,479	514,594	(3,667,723)	-	-
Total Operating Expenses	<u>2,267,411</u>	<u>1,889,876</u>	<u>731,451</u>	<u>312,549</u>	<u>57,578</u>	<u>2,371,872</u>	<u>1,285,970</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>8,916,707</u>	<u>9,153,432</u>
Services	<u>\$ 2,267,411</u>	<u>\$ 1,889,876</u>	<u>\$ 731,451</u>	<u>\$ 312,549</u>	<u>\$ 57,578</u>				<u>\$ 5,258,865</u>	<u>\$ 4,869,231</u>
Publishing						<u>\$ 2,371,872</u>			<u>2,371,872</u>	<u>3,037,784</u>
Grapevine							<u>\$ 1,285,970</u>		<u>1,285,970</u>	<u>1,246,417</u>
									<u>8,916,707</u>	<u>9,153,432</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
COMBINED BALANCE SHEETS**

Years Ended December 31, 1993 and 1992

	<u>General Service Board of A.A.</u>			<u>A.A. World Services, Inc.</u>	<u>A.A. Grapevine, Inc.</u>	<u>Combined 1993</u>	<u>Combined 1992</u>
	<u>General Fund</u>	<u>Reserve Fund</u>	<u>Capital Projects Fund</u>				
ASSETS							
Cash	\$ 491,151	\$ 281,422		\$ 898,260	\$ 249,537	\$ 1,920,370	\$ 2,044,344
Accounts and interest receivable		152,657		227,220	22,561	402,438	419,694
Intercompany balances	(672,560)	(1,220,959)		682,739	1,210,780	-	-
Inventories							
Books, pamphlets, etc.				1,142,671	157,502	1,300,173	1,483,058
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.				58,340	46,366	104,706	115,532
Investments							
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 1994/2003, at cost (market value: 1993 - \$9,213,425; 1992 - \$7,383,863)		8,729,852				8,729,852	6,954,002
Fixed Assets							
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software (net of accumulated depreciation - 1993 - \$1,367,188, 1992 - \$1,019,134)			\$1,858,503			1,858,503	2,206,557
Deferred charges	263,413			55,741	72,790	391,944	308,686
Other assets				20,751		20,751	20,751
Total Assets	<u>82,004</u>	<u>7,942,972</u>	<u>1,858,503</u>	<u>3,085,722</u>	<u>1,759,536</u>	<u>14,728,737</u>	<u>13,552,624</u>
LIABILITIES							
Accounts payable				\$ 376,109	\$ 103,262	\$ 479,371	\$ 308,801
Accrued royalties				245,862		245,862	228,893
Deferred income	\$ 24,991			40,627	1,153,706	1,219,324	1,164,755
Total Liabilities	<u>24,991</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>-</u>	<u>662,598</u>	<u>1,256,968</u>	<u>1,944,557</u>	<u>1,702,449</u>
Net Assets (Exhibit A)	<u>57,013</u>	<u>\$7,942,972</u>	<u>\$1,858,503</u>	<u>2,423,124</u>	<u>502,568</u>	<u>12,784,180</u>	<u>11,850,175</u>
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	<u>82,004</u>	<u>7,942,972</u>	<u>1,858,503</u>	<u>3,085,722</u>	<u>1,759,536</u>	<u>14,728,737</u>	<u>13,552,624</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITOR'S OPINION

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

February 28, 1994

Ladies and Gentlemen:

We have audited the accompanying combined balance sheets of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. and its wholly owned subsidiaries, ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC., as of December 31, 1993 and 1992, and the related combined statements of income, expenses and changes in fund balances for the years then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the organization's management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audits.

We conducted our audits in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audits provide a reasonable basis for our opinion.

In our opinion, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the combined financial position of the three corporations named above as of December 31, 1993 and 1992, and the combined results of their operations for the years then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Respectfully submitted,
Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO COMBINED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 1993 AND 1992**

Note 1 Organization

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. is a not-for-profit corporation organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world. In furtherance of that objective, the organization also publishes books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to the A.A. program through two wholly owned not-for-profit corporations, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in three separate funds, as follows:

The *RESERVE FUND*—established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was redefined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. That committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the board of

trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers, and, therefore, they are reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The *CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND*—This fund was established in 1990, with retroactive effect to 1989, to account for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects; and also to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The *GENERAL FUND*—is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies

The corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. Contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and donations have been eliminated in the combined totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Inventories

Inventories held by A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are recorded at cost under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Fixed Assets

The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Project Fund. In accordance with consistent practice, the costs of these expenditures continue to be recorded as an expense of the General Fund, but are then capitalized and depreciated through changes in net assets in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are considered to be immaterial and are charged to expense in the year of purchase.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 1993 and the accumulated reserves for depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Reserve
Leasehold improvements				
475 Riverside Drive	Terms of Leases	\$1,625,457	\$ 171,100	\$ 299,426
Furniture	8 Years	689,598	86,200	186,836
Computer—hardware	5 Years	638,965	37,171	638,713
—software	5 Years	271,671	53,583	242,213
		<u>3,225,691</u>	<u>348,054</u>	<u>1,367,188</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis.

Investments

Investments held by the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board of A.A. are carried at cost. No recognition is made in the accounts for any changes in aggregate market value above or below cost because all of the investments are U.S. Treasury Notes with short or medium terms that are normally held to maturity.

Note 3 Retirement Plan

The trustees of General Service Board adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible employees of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The plan has been amended from time to time to improve benefits and to comply with current statutory requirements.

The report of the plan's actuaries stated that as of January 1, 1993, the most recent valuation date to these financial statements for which information is available, the present value of accrued benefits under the plan was \$3,914,531, of which \$3,646,804 was vested. The market value of the assets of the trust fund at the same date was \$6,793,726. The assumed rate of return used in determining the actuarial value of vested plan benefits was 7.5%.

Pension expense has been consistently reported as the contribution made to actuarially fund plan benefits. That method of accounting was in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles that had been in effect since the issuance of Accounting Principles Board Statement No. 8 in 1966.

Effective as of 1987, however, Financial Accounting Standards Board (FASB) Statement No. 87 introduced a new concept of "net periodic pension cost," in which pension cost would be accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon actuarial factors which would not necessarily be the same as those presently used in calculating the annual funding requirement. In addition, FASB No. 87 would require, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the organization's balance sheet depending upon whether the plan was considered to be over- or under-funded. It is clear from the above actuarial data that there is no unfounded liability in the A.A. Retirement Plan. Management still believes the annual funding requirement is a more relevant measure of pension expense, and that the cost of additional actuarial calculations is not warranted. The actuaries have stated that the difference would not be a material amount.

Pension expense for 1993 and 1992 was \$324,649 and \$288,980, respectively.

In addition to providing pension benefits, the corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they reach normal retirement age while working for the corporations. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the corporations, 25% of the cost of which is reimbursed by the retirees.

The cost of providing health care benefits to retirees is recorded as the insurance premiums are expensed, and were \$60,000 and \$50,000 for 1993 and 1992, respectively.

Note 4 Lease Commitments

At December 31, 1993, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$347,275 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective July 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

\$132,994 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective September 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 1992 is \$3,722,000.

The rental expenses for the years ended December 31, 1993 and 1992, were as follows:

	1993	1992
Total Rent Expense	\$ 567,700	\$ 620,600
Allocated to:		
A.A. World Services	\$ 145,600	\$ 296,600
General Service Board	336,900	221,600
A.A. Grapevine	85,200	102,400
	<u>\$ 567,700</u>	<u>\$ 620,600</u>

In addition to the rental expense shown above, a rent premium of \$476,700 (1991- \$357,500, 1992- \$119,200) incurred for a one year extension to March 31, 1992 of the lease for the organization's previous office at 470 Park Avenue South, as well as the entire rent of \$382,300 (1991- \$240,700, 1992- \$141,600) paid at 475 Riverside Drive prior to occupancy on that same date, have both been borne by the General Service Board as part of the overall cost of the construction and relocation project.

Note 5 Tax Status

The organizations are exempt from federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code. They are also exempt from the New York State Franchise Tax.



Budget Highlights

1994 G.S.O. Budget

Income: The 1994 sales budget of \$8,822,000 is approximately \$898,000 less than 1993 sales and \$985,000 less than budgeted for 1993. The 1994 budget reflects continued lower volume expectations. Projected gross margin from literature sales is \$4,757,400, approximately \$600,000 less than 1993 actual gross margin.

Contributions for 1994 have been anticipated at \$3,825,000. This compares with actual contributions received for 1993 of \$3,810,000 and a 1993 budget of \$4,000,000.

Total Revenue (literature sales less manufacturing, royalties, and shipping, as well as contributions) is budgeted at \$7,768,900. This is approximately \$578,000 less than the 1993 results.

Total Operating Expenses for 1994 have been budgeted at \$7,937,800. This is an increase of \$306,000 (4%) over 1993 results, but only \$25,300 greater than the 1993 budgeted expense.

A preliminary operating loss of \$168,900 has been projected for 1994. This loss (if realized) will be covered by a drawdown of current earnings of the Reserve Fund, leaving a net for the period of zero. This drawdown of current earnings of the Reserve Fund allows for an orderly, prudent use of Reserve Fund earnings, at a time when the Reserve Fund is approaching its upper limit. Were it not for this resource, a reduction of services or an increase in revenue would have been required. Either of these actions could have sent a message of fiscal crisis that does not exist.

1994 Grapevine Budget

Net income of \$7,100 is about \$60,900 less than 1993 actual, a decrease of 89.6%.

Gross profit on the magazine, \$905,300, is 60.1%, compared to \$931,500, or 62.8%, in 1993.

Gross profit on other publishing income, \$328,800, is 65.5%, compared to \$339,815, or 65.6%, in 1993.

Total gross profit of \$1,234,100 is down \$37,200 from \$1,271,315 in 1993. Higher costs of product, the extra cost for the double issue in June, and the normal decline in volume of magazine-related items combine to account for the decrease.

Total costs and expenses of \$1,309,600 is an increase of \$23,600, or 1.8%, over the 1993 actual.

We feel this is a conservative budget with realistic volumes and costs of products, and other expenses kept to a minimum.

The General Service Office

1994 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	1993 Actual	1994 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$ 9,720,488	\$ 8,822,100
Discounts allowed	405,722	377,400
<u>Net Sales</u>	9,314,766	8,444,700
Cost of Literature Distributed		
Manufacturing	2,999,007	2,809,300
Royalties	956,499	878,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	5,359,260	4,757,400
Direct Shipping and Warehouse	834,404	815,000
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	4,524,856	3,942,400
Contributions Received	3,809,894	3,825,000
Interest Income	7,728	1,500
<u>Total Revenue</u>	8,342,478	7,768,900
 OPERATING EXPENSES		
Salaries	3,613,615	3,706,000
Payroll taxes	290,878	288,500
Insurance	608,011	650,000
Retirement expense	282,806	295,400
Other program printing	418,551	450,000
Mailing, labor, etc.	85,449	85,000
Packing supplies	193	1,000
Postage & express	250,357	270,000
Writers' fees	26,967	39,000
Other literature assistance	98,312	136,000
Selling expenses	40,711	57,500
Professional fees	186,106	143,000
Contracted services	98,590	100,000
Occupancy	512,627	535,000
Telephone	98,762	102,000
Furniture & equipment maintenance	86,010	81,200
Furniture & equipment	68,645	54,000
Stationery & office expense	155,436	161,200
Office service & expense	134,644	143,000
Travel, meals, & accommodations	560,608	615,000
Bad debts	14,529	25,000
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	7,631,807	7,937,800
Operating Income (Loss) for period	710,671	(168,900)
Interest draw down from Reserve Fund	0	168,900
Net Income for period	710,671	0

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1994 BUDGET

	<u>1994 Budget</u>	
PAID CIRCULATION—AVERAGE		<u>123,000</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE		
Subscription income	\$ 1,482,100	
Single copies and back issues	<u>25,400</u>	
<u>Total magazine income</u>		\$ 1,507,500
<u>Total direct costs</u>		<u>602,200</u>
GROSS PROFIT ON MAGAZINE		905,300
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	502,300	
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>173,500</u>	
GROSS PROFIT ON SPECIAL ITEMS		<u>328,800</u>
<u>TOTAL GROSS PROFIT</u>		<u>1,234,100</u>
COSTS AND EXPENSES		
EDITORIAL COSTS		
Salaries, including temporary help	221,700	
Payroll taxes and benefits	45,500	
Occupancy costs	54,600	
Office supplies and expenses	12,000	
Product development	<u>27,500</u>	
<u>Total Editorial</u>		361,300
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	481,600	
Payroll taxes and benefits	163,900	
Occupancy costs	54,600	
Office expense	20,100	
Subscriber services	13,700	
Selling expense—regular	67,200	
—GvR program	37,500	
Postage	<u>11,000</u>	
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>		849,600
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	4,000	
Insurance	4,500	
Professional fees	24,500	
Meetings and conferences	30,600	
Furniture and equipment	5,600	
Canadian exchange and other	<u>29,500</u>	
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>		<u>98,700</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES		1,309,600
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS		(75,500)
Add: Interest earned		<u>82,600</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD		<u>7,100</u>

() denotes red figures

1993 Contribution From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W.Fla	418	224	53.5%	\$ 28,044.90	7,875	\$3.56	59.	Pennsylvania						
2.	Alaska	241	96	39.8	9,296.92	3,653	2.55	60.	East	1,414	749	52.9	108,880.90	32,924	3.31
3.	Arizona	840	366	43.5	53,896.11	15,195	3.55	61.	West	747	366	48.9	37,726.11	10,988	3.43
4.	Arkansas	260	142	54.6	14,213.40	4,173	3.41	62.	Rhode Island	251	100	39.8	10,155.93	5,459	1.86
5.	California							63.	South Carolina	292	189	64.7	28,728.60	5,933	4.84
6.	Southern	1,942	790	40.7	98,385.13	64,129	1.53	64.	South Dakota	151	65	43.0	6,584.18	3,486	1.89
7.	N. Coastal	2,010	1,260	62.7	172,737.41	59,417	2.91	65.	Tennessee	490	237	48.3	34,158.39	9,265	3.69
8.	N. Interior	708	315	44.4	36,236.68	17,707	2.05	66.	Northeast	435	203	46.6	45,523.59	15,425	2.95
9.	San Diego/Imp.	833	407	48.8	51,933.87	26,447	1.96	67.	Northwest	225	106	47.1	12,489.60	6,048	2.07
10.	Mid-South	1,787	791	44.3	87,574.77	54,566	1.60	68.	Southwest	428	190	44.3	33,114.58	16,920	1.96
11.	Colorado	593	336	56.6	41,418.55	16,111	2.57	69.	Utah	283	186	65.7	30,623.19	9,814	3.12
12.	Connecticut	1,398	548	39.1	67,420.91	32,251	2.09	70.	Vermont	224	92	41.0	23,430.08	4,859	4.82
13.	Delaware	182	105	57.6	16,844.62	3,035	5.55	71.	Virginia	1,105	601	54.3	81,480.96	22,055	3.69
13.	D.C.	454	244	53.7	48,915.32	14,786	3.31	72.	Washington	1,290	702	54.4	103,933.94	27,509	3.78
14.	Florida							73.	West Virginia	289	144	49.8	10,921.55	3,439	3.18
15.	North	640	353	55.1	51,116.94	13,561	3.77	74.	Wisconsin						
15.	South/							74.	N. Wis./Upper						
16.	Bahamas/V.I.	1,520	773	50.8	110,362.77	28,515	3.87	75.	Pen. Mitch.	615	284	46.1	23,428.55	10,012	2.34
17.	Georgia	689	458	66.4	58,966.32	16,501	3.57	76.	South	898	434	48.3	47,287.62	17,772	2.66
17.	Hawaii	256	157	61.3	28,139.26	5,432	5.18	77.	Wyoming	130	63	48.4	5,751.73	2,187	2.63
18.	Idaho	206	95	46.1	7,822.10	2,960	2.64	78.	Puerto Rico	118	73	61.8	4,512.09	1,521	2.97
19.	Illinois	1,140	362	31.7	47,741.34	26,527	1.80	79.	Alberta/N.W.T.	596	242	40.6	28,403.31	8,034	3.54
20.	Chicago	982	396	40.3	41,966.20	20,415	2.06	80.	B.C./Yukon	748	393	52.5	55,735.69	13,217	4.22
21.	North	982	396	40.3	41,966.20	20,415	2.06	81.	Manitoba	158	69	43.6	8,448.19	4,022	2.10
21.	South	454	203	44.7	25,848.55	7,713	3.35	82.	N.B./P.E.I.	230	106	46.0	8,535.54	3,588	2.38
22.	Indiana							83.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	283	128	45.2	12,968.75	3,531	3.67
23.	North	661	293	44.3	32,865.58	10,642	3.09	84.	East	601	276	4.59	42,716.61	14,484	2.95
23.	South	518	280	54.1	29,413.95	10,489	2.80	85.	Northeast	180	76	4.22	9,893.23	2,395	4.13
24.	Iowa	635	332	52.2	36,848.93	12,674	2.91	86.	Northwest	88	19	21.6	3,504.10	1,369	2.56
25.	Kansas	387	211	54.5	23,888.87	9,725	2.46	87.	West	515	218	42.3	35,247.47	10,444	3.37
26.	Kentucky	629	351	55.8	52,232.95	10,856	4.81	88.	Quebec						
27.	Louisiana	521	231	44.3	28,556.41	10,159	2.81	89.	Southwest	603	392	65.0 ¹	30,318.88	15,527	1.95
28.	Maine	474	182	38.3	16,121.56	8,688	1.86	90.	Southeast	234	159	67.9 ¹	9,609.77	3,481	2.76
29.	Maryland	872	401	45.9	50,821.52	13,681	3.71	91.	Northwest	375	300	80.0 ¹	11,034.97	6,892	1.60
30.	Massachusetts							92.	Ontario	405	328	81.0 ¹	10,060.50	7,707	1.30
31.	East	1,593	597	37.4	75,439.36	54,305	1.39	93.	Saskatchewan	335	158	47.1	14,814.31	4,401	3.37
31.	West	235	121	51.4	15,178.24	5,360	2.83	94.	Total U.S./						
32.	Michigan							95.	Canada	55,828	26,620	47.7	\$3,359,470.90	1,231,271	2.73
33.	Central	535	221	41.3	35,639.71	12,390	2.88		Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				173,709.87		
33.	Southeast	625	287	45.9	57,447.86	15,981	3.59		Special				244,801.29		
34.	West	452	220	48.6	30,935.45	9,695	3.19		Total for U.S. & Canada				\$3,777,982.06		
35.	Minnesota								FOREIGN AND OTHER						
36.	North	536	270	50.3	18,987.73	8,163	2.33		Birds of a Feather				201.25		
36.	South	1,024	460	44.9	47,479.40	23,797	2.00		Correctional facility groups				174.90		
37.	Mississippi	226	113	50.0	11,761.24	3,622	3.25		Foreign				22,705.57		
38.	Missouri								International Doctors in A.A.				3,000.00		
39.	East	599	293	48.9	40,132.09	9,500	4.22		International Lawyers in A.A.				3,000.00		
39.	West	214	118	55.1	12,976.55	6,135	2.12		Internationalists				80.00		
40.	Montana	343	142	41.3	14,252.87	4,976	2.86		Loners				877.00		
41.	Nebraska	683	357	52.2	46,450.17	14,704	3.16		Treatment facility meetings				564.22		
42.	Nevada	360	157	43.5	14,040.12	7,765	1.81		World Hello				80.00		
43.	New Hampshire	531	208	39.1	16,879.17	8,586	1.97		Grand Total				\$3,808,665.00		
44.	New Jersey														
45.	North	1,248	481	38.5	65,767.70	30,413	2.16								
46.	South	474	254	53.6	39,719.60	9,181	4.33								
47.	New Mexico	321	154	47.9	17,556.61	5,466	3.21								
48.	New York														
49.	Central	709	280	39.4	38,578.59	11,188	3.45								
50.	H./M./B.	784	277	35.3	23,277.80	11,524	2.02								
51.	Southeast	1,781	847	47.5	162,805.87	53,342	3.05								
52.	West	307	117	38.1	12,912.00	4,574	2.82								
53.	N. Carolina	821	485	59.0	72,779.34	12,856	5.66								
54.	North Dakota	179	95	53.0	9,896.23	3,503	2.83								
55.	Ohio														
56.	Cent. & S.E.	596	136	22.8	13,544.95	8,314	1.63								
57.	Northeast	1,199	339	28.2	33,544.77	24,135	1.39								
58.	N.W. Ohio/														
59.	S.E. Mich.	272	146	53.6	16,198.62	3,761	4.31								
60.	S.W. Ohio	518	247	47.6	32,024.23	10,696	2.99								
61.	Oklahoma	387	238	61.4	27,577.47	6,668	4.14								
62.	Oregon	744	369	49.5	44,140.80	13,905	3.17								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1993-1992

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada						
1993	55,828	26,620 ¹	47.7% ¹	\$3,359,470.90 ²	1,231,271	\$2.73
U.S. & Canada						
1992	55,600	27,623 ¹	49.7% ¹	3,600,590.77 ²	1,230,381	\$2.93
Increase (Decrease)	228	(1,003)	(2.0%)	(\$241,119.87)	890	(\$0.20)

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists of percentages submitted by areas).
² Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as special, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

1994 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Bill Clark
 Esther Hall
 Karl Lamberg
¹Mark Langsam
 Doreen Mathison
 Charles Matthews
 Sam Reams
²Gay Walters

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Cooperation With the Professional Community

¹Susan Campbell
 Jack Connors
 Mary Ellen Davis
²Gary Kluksdahl
 Will Ruliffson
 Wil Scarborough
 John Verdon
 Mike Ward

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Correctional Facilities

Rene Desharnais
 Al George
¹John Hughes
 Jesse Leming
²Norman Litwin
 Mary Ellen O'Brien
 Charles Williams
 Jim Wilson

Secretary: Richard Bush

Finance

Denise Bell
 Linda Bluth
²Joan Johnson
¹Pete Litano
 Jon Mason
 Ray Massey
 Don Popejoy
 Valerie Wethered

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

Charlie Burns
 Sandy Champ
 Shaaron Johnson
 Pearl Runyon
¹Larry Schlosser
 Randy Sellers
²Don Swallow
 Doug Thompson
 Dawson Young

Secretary: Ann Warner

1995 International Convention/Regional Forums

Mary Ann Boggess
 Hucky Dredhart
 Anne Mabery
 Bob McElroy
 Ron Sharpe
 Roger Smith
 Mark Sullivan
 David Wilson

Co-secretaries: Eileen Gatz
 Sarah Price

Literature

Georges Bellefeuille
 Linda Bridge
 Russell Cook
²Cathy Ferrante
 Julie Newton
 Marvin Rumery
¹Hugh Vaughan
 David Wilson

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Policy/Admissions

Larry Cagnina
 Hucky Dredhart
¹Janice French
 Billie Hobart
 Fernand Lachaine
²Michael O'Connor
 Davis Tolleson
 Ike Treadwell

Secretary: Pat Rosenstiel

Public Information

Judy Allard
 Bill Baker
²Conley Byrd
 Julio Colón
 Jeanne Mattis
 Dorothy Neurohr
 Ron Sharpe
¹Bob Taylor
 Manuel Ysais

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Report and Charter

Bruce Bates
²Tom Dougherty
¹Burke Dykes
 Anne Mabery
 Betty Mac James
 Hugo McKissic
 Roger Smith
 Inez Yoakum

Secretary: Sarah Price

Treatment Facilities

Mary Ann Boggess
²Regis Chenard
 Lois Concelman
 Kevin Ernst
 Don Johnson
 Ray Steeves
 Diane Watson
¹Wally Zoller

Secretary: Phyllis Masback

Trustees

²Gene Benson
 Pat Dawson
 Shawn D'Luh
 Gene Hughey
 Al Johnson
¹Bob McElroy
 Marco Roman
 Mark Sullivan
 Russ VanDran

Secretary: Lois Fisher

1995 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS¹

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Charles Matthews, Tennessee	Karl Lamberg, New Hampshire
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Wil Scarborough, South Carolina	Mike Ward, Idaho
Correctional Facilities	Mary Ellen O'Brien, Vermont	Charles Williams, Kentucky
Finance	Linda Bluth, Arizona	Don Popejoy, Kansas
Grapevine	Sandy Champ, SW Texas	Randy Sellers, Georgia
Literature	David Wilson, Manitoba	Linda Bridge, W. Massachusetts
Policy/Admissions	Larry Cagnina, Alaska	Fernand Lachaine, NW Quebec
Public Information	Manuel Ysais, California, Mid-Southern	Judy Allard, W. Ontario
Report and Charter	Betty Mac James, Rhode Island	Bruce Bates, N. Minnesota
Treatment Facilities	Ray Steeves, New Brunswick/PEI	Mary Ann Boggess, NW Texas
Committee on Trustees	Mark Sullivan, Montana	Marco Roman, California, San Diego/Imperial

¹ Chairperson

² Alternate Chairperson

³ The 1994 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 44th General Service Conference.

1994 Trustees' Committees

Archives

John King, *chairperson*
Gerry Flegel
Jacob Ham
Tom Maguire
David O'Leary
Francine Ward
Donald Weaver
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Marc Pineau, *chairperson*
Ann Bruning
Chuck Crist
Gay Garner
Michael McPherson
Greg Muth
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

John Hartley Smith, M.D.,
chairperson
Peter Brock
John N. Chappel, M.D.
*Dorothy Driscoll
*Anne Geller, M.D.
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
John King
Marc Pineau
Jane Murphy Schulberg
*Ray Stiver
Francine Ward
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

John N. Chappel, M.D.,
chairperson
Chuck Crist
*Roy Drake, S.J.
Les Leuthaeuser
David O'Leary
Richard Roughton
*Warren Stafford
*Martha Watson
Donald Weaver
Richard Bush, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Gary Glynn, *chairperson*
Ann Bruning
Chuck Crist
Jacob Ham
Michael McPherson
Greg Muth
Marc Pineau
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A.,
consultant
Dennis Manders,
senior advisor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

David O'Leary, *chairperson*
Jacques Filteau
Larry Nelson
Frank Polek
Richard Roughton
Jean Smith
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
John Grant, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Les Leuthaeuser, *chairperson*
Gerry Flegel, *vice-chairperson*
Gay Garner
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
Tom Maguire
Larry Nelson
David O'Leary
Frank Polek
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Eileen Gatzka, *secretary*
—*International Convention*
Sarah Price, *secretary*
—*Regional Forums*

Literature

Fran Polek, *chairperson*
John N. Chappel, M.D.
Gay Garner
Gary Glynn
Michael McPherson
Richard Roughton
*Richard Steins
Francine Ward
Donald Weaver
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Nominating

Greg Muth, *chairperson*
Ann Bruning
Gary Glynn
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
John King
Larry Nelson
Marc Pineau
Jean Smith
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

Public Information

Gerry Flegel, *chairperson*
Peter Brock
*Isadora Drayton
Jacques Filteau
*Sarah Holland
*F. Bradley Lynch
Tom Maguire
Greg Muth
Larry Nelson
Jane Murphy Schulberg
*Ben Shapiro
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

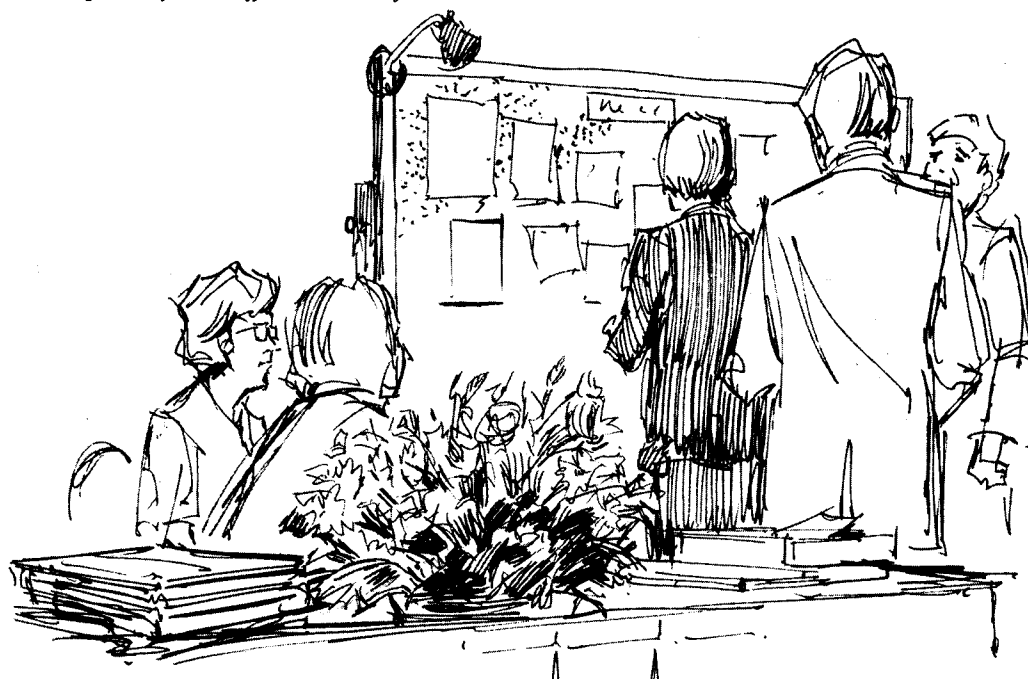
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
chairperson
Peter Brock
John N. Chappel, M.D.
*John Dunn
Jacques Filteau
Gay Garner
Gary Glynn
*Joyce King
Les Leuthaeuser
*Terry Lindgren
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Phyllis Masback, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Jean Smith, *chairperson*
Pat Rosentiel, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Jim Estelle and George Dorsey are ex officio members of all committees.



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Jim Estelle
First vice-chairperson
Jhon H. Smith, M.D.
Second vice-chairperson
John King
Secretary
Greg Muth
Treasurer
Gary Glynn
Assistant secretary
Pat Rosentiel
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers is given on page 36

* Denotes appointed committee members

1994 Conference Members



NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr. (3681 Mesa Verde Dr., El Dorado Hills, CA 95762) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1993 Conference. Jim was director of the Texas Department of Corrections for 12 years, and brought his background in correctional administration to the board when he served as a Class A trustee, 1977-1986. Now retired, he is involved in many professional societies on criminal justice and corrections and is on the board of a California service organization that serves the needs of the families of indigent jail and prison inmates.

John N. Chappel, M.D. (School of Medicine, University of Nevada, Reno, NV 89557) was elected to the board in 1989. A graduate of the University of Alberta Medical School, John has been professor of psychiatry, University of Nevada School of Medicine, since 1974. He serves as consultant to many professional organizations and is widely published in the field of alcoholism. John chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Treatment Facilities, and Literature Committees.

Gary A. Glynn (1112 Park Ave., New York, NY 10128) was elected to the board in April 1993 after serving as a consultant to the trustees' Finance Committee, A.A.W.S.'s Employee's Retirement Committee and the A.A.W.S. Board. A graduate of the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, he has been an investment analyst and portfolio manager for over 20 years, and is active in various professional organizations and committees. Gary is treasurer of the General Service Board and chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee; he also is a member of the trustees' Literature, Nominating and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Catonsville, MD 21228) was elected to the board in May 1992. A graduate of Morgan State University, Baltimore, and the University of Maryland, Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to regional and government agencies and published many articles in professional journals. Elaine is director of the Center for Substance Abuse Prevention. Elaine chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and also serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

John E. King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College,

Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as a consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. John chairs the Archives Committee and also serves on the Nominating and Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Peter Roach (1332 Edmison Dr., Peterborough, ON, Canada K9H 6V3) was elected to the board in 1994. Peter has been an elementary and secondary school teacher and a director of education, and he is currently involved with local industry and manufacturing.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (5060 Maple Street, Vancouver, BC V6M 3T1, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John was appointed assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health in 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. In 1988 he resigned to do private consulting. He was also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine, 1978-87, and is a part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. John chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and serves on the International, International Convention/ Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

C. Peter Brock (4625 S. 34th St., Arlington, VA 22206) was elected general service trustee in April 1994. Peter has served as an A.A.W.S. director, and has served on the trustees' C.P.C., P.I., Treatment and Literature Committees. With a professional background in the education, financial and health fields, he is currently a director of alcoholism and mental health programs.

Ann Bruning (10728 Hunters Point Rd., Fort Smith, AR 72903), who was a Panel 37 delegate, was elected Southwest U.S.

regional trustee in April 1991. Ann has also served her area as G.S.R., area chair, and has been active in P.I. work, mostly in schools. A registered nurse, Ann now works at an in-hospital hospice, and serves on the boards of several community organizations, as well as presenting workshops for various organizations. Ann serves on the Finance and Budgetary, Nominating and Conference Committees. She is also the chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board.

William Bungay (24 Johnson's Ave., Corner Brook, Newfoundland, Canada A2H 1V8) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1994. Bill, a Panel 39 delegate, has a background in accounting and business.

Gerry Flegel (Box 1246, Humboldt, Saskatchewan, S0K 2A0 Canada), elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 1992, is a former Panel 38 delegate. Gerry is enjoying retirement after teaching math, computer science and accounting in Saskatchewan high schools for the past 30 years. He chairs the Public Information Committee, serves on the Archives, Conference, and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Gay Garner (528 Hammet Dr., Decatur, GA 30032) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1993. A former Panel 38 delegate, Gay has also served her area as G.S.R., D.C.M. and area chairperson and has been active in local P.I./C.P.C. activities. Her professional background is in the entertainment business, management and advertising sales. Gay serves on the Conference, Literature, Treatment Facilities and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees.

Jacob B. "Jake" Ham (RFD 1, Box 1400, Winthrop, ME 04364) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Jake began his service work in California as G.S.R., D.C.M., and H&I coordinator. After returning to his home state of Maine in 1980, Jake served in similar service jobs, including Maine area chair, and was a Panel 38 delegate. In his spare time, away from his job with the U.S. Postal Service, he enjoys carpentry, gardening and camping. Jake is chairman of the Grapevine Corporate Board and also serves on the Archives, Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees.

Les Leuthaeuser (1912 Ave. B, Scottsbluff, NE 69361) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1992. In service work for over 20 years, Les was a Panel 30 delegate and has served as area chair and area finance committee chair. He is self-employed in the home improvement/repair business. Les chairs the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums

Committee and serves on the Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities Committees and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Michael McPherson (315 W. 86th St., New York, NY 10024) was elected general service trustee in April 1993. Prior to that Michael was an A.A.W.S. director, where he served as chair for the A.A.W.S. Publications Subcommittee and was a member of the trustees' Finance Committee. He is chief administrative officer for a large nonprofit corporation. Michael serves on the Conference, Finance & Budgetary and Literature Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Greg Muth (P.O. Box 30068, Honolulu, HI 96820) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1990. Greg, who has been active from group coffee maker on, served as a Panel 37 Delegate, when he chaired the Conference Report and Charter Committee. An executive of a commercial construction company, he is also involved in local community organizations. Greg chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Conference and Finance & Budgetary and Public Information Committees.

Larry Nelson (192 Elm Ave., Imperial Beach, CA 91932) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1993. A former Panel 38 delegate, Larry has been active in many service activities in his area. He is a pharmacist on the staff of a large health maintenance organization clinic. Larry serves on the International, Nominating, Public Information and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees.

David O'Leary (37 Wabush Pl., St. John's, Newfoundland, Canada A1E 5V5) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1991. A Panel 35 delegate from Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador, David has remained active in his area, serving on intergroup, convention and institutions committees. He is a maintenance technician with a large corporation. David chairs the International Committee and also serves on the Archives, Correctional Facilities, Nominating and International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums Committees.

Marc Pineau (185 14th Ave., Iberville, Quebec J2X 1B5, Canada), who was a Panel 36 delegate, was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1990. He has served as G.S.R., D.C.M. and area secretary and chair. Marc is an engineer with a Canadian Corporation, where he has participated in employees' programs, as well as setting up other rehabilitation programs.



Marc chairs the Conference and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Fran Polek (2301 E. 61st Ave., Spokane, WA 99223) was elected general service trustee in May 1992, after serving four years



Jean's professional background is in publishing. She serves on the International and Nominating Committees, and is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Donald Weaver (1325 Seemore, Kalamazoo, MI 49001) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1993. Don currently chairs a prison meeting and has held many service jobs in his area, including Panel 34 delegate. A landscaper, he is also involved with various community activities. Don serves on the Archives, Correctional Facilities and Literature Committees.

as a Grapevine director. A Panel 27 delegate, Fran also served as area chair. During his time as a director, he served as a treasurer of the Grapevine Corporate Board and as a member of the trustees' Literature Committee and International Committee. Fran is a university professor, involved in teaching, research, lecturing, and writing. Fran chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and International Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Julian Rhinehart (1127 Seno Court, Boulder City, NV 89005) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 1994. Julian was a Panel 41 delegate, where he chaired the Conference P.I. Committee. He has long been active in area service. Julian is now retired after 25 years working for the federal government in communications and in public and news media relations.

Jane Murphy Schulberg (138 E. 38th St., New York, NY 10016) was elected a general service trustee in April 1993, after serving four years as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. Jane, who is a producer/writer with a television media house, has been active at many levels of local A.A. She is a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board and also serves on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Public Information Committees.

Jean Smith (100 Bank St., New York, NY 10014) was elected general service trustee in April 1990. Jean has served on the Grapevine editorial board and was an A.A.W.S. director from 1987 to 1990, when she served on several trustees' committees.

On Being a Delegate

- Shared at the morning A.A. meeting: "Being a delegate is like being a drunk, once you become one you always are one."
- Al George (Central Michigan) said he never wanted to be a delegate, he just wanted to be a past delegate.
- Charles Matthews (Tennessee) felt it was most appropriate that he was delegate to the Conference with the theme Spirit of Sacrifice. He considers himself an expert on sacrifice, having been divorced three times.
- Bill Baker (Southern Illinois) was thrilled to be able to get together with "a bunch of losers, so we can celebrate our winnings."

Staff member Phyllis Masback, accompanying a group of delegates on a visit to the G.S.O. office, was handing out subway tokens at the 50th St. station. She handed a token to a man, patted him on the back and said "Be sure and come by my office." You guessed it! He was not a delegate and we have no information as to whether or not he visited G.S.O.

1 Rotating at the close of the 1994 Conference meeting.

2 New trustee, elected by the General Service Board, April 1994.

A.A. World Services Directors

Ann Bruning, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Peter Brock, *nontrustee director*
 George Dorsey, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Jacques Filteau, *nontrustee director*
 Gerry Flegel, *regional trustee*

Michael McPherson, *general service trustee*
 Pat Rosenstiel, *G.S.O. staff member*
 Richard Roughton, *nontrustee director*
 Jean Smith, *general service trustee*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Jacob Ham, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Chuck Crist, *nontrustee director*
 John King, *Class A trustee*
 Les Leuthaeuser, *regional trustee*
 Thomas Maguire, *nontrustee director*
 Francine Ward, *nontrustee director*

Fran Polek, *general service trustee*
 Jane Murphy Schulberg, *general service trustee*
 Ames Sweet, *Grapevine managing editor*
 Ann Warner, *Grapevine executive editor*

General Service Office Staff

George Dorsey, *general manager*
 Richard Bush
 Lois Fisher
 Eileen Gatz
 John Grant
 Phyllis Masback
 Joanie Moncrief
 Daniel Mooney

Valerie O'Neill
 Sarah Price
 Pat Rosenstiel
 Helen Turnquest
 Susan Ulseth
 Tom Jasper, *services director*
 Frank Mauser, *archivist*

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet, *managing editor*

Ann Warner, *executive editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Caryl Bertolino, *staff assistant*
 Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
 Joseph Dennan, *staff assistant*
 John de Stefano, *editor*
 Yee Eng, *staff assistant*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 Margie Janicek, *receptionist*
 John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller/business administration*
 Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
 Phyllis Masback, *G.S.O. staff*
 Lynda Maziarz, *staff assistant*
 Don Meurer, *controller, A.A.W.S.*
 Lilianna Murphy, *data processing manager*
 John Nayduch, *Conference Report designer*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Bob Scherer, *Grapevine controller*
 Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
 Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine administrative assistant*
 Cynthia White, *staff assistant*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Trustees emeritus

Michael Alexander
 Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 44th Conference includes Panel 43 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 44 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	43	Julie Newton, 903 Yorktown Rd., Dothan, AL, 36301
Alaska	2	44	Larry G. Cagnina, 1457 Gillam Way, Fairbanks, AK 99701
Arizona	3	44	Linda Bluth, 1124 East 12th St., Casa Grande, AZ 85222
Arkansas	4	43	Conley F. Byrd, Box 3, Redfield, AR 72132
California Southern	5	43	Mary Ellen Davis, 10248 Mossy Rock Circle, Los Angeles, CA 90077
Northern Coastal	6	43	Diane Watson, 101 W. 24th Ave., #303, San Mateo, CA 94403
Northern Interior	7	44	Inez Yoakum, 5626 Palm Ave., Sacramento, CA 95841
San Diego/Imperial	8	44	Marco Antonio Roman, 5555 Las Altunas Terrace, San Diego, CA 92114
Mid-Southern	9	44	Manuel Ysais, 1015-A W. First St., Santa Ana, CA 92703
Colorado	10	43	Gary Kluksdahl, 522 S. Carr St., Lakewood, CO 80226
Connecticut	11	43	Bob Taylor, 239 Jefferson Ave., New London, CT 06320
Delaware	12	44	Douglas (Doug) Thompson, 39 Duchess Circle, Dover, DE 19901
District of Columbia	13	43	Mark Langsam, 4907 Strathmore Ave., Kensington, MD 20895-1208
Florida North	14	43	Tom Dougherty, 3806 Calloway Dr., Orlando, FL 32810
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I.	15	43	Patrick H. (Pat) Dawson, 418 Mayflower Rd., West Palm Beach, FL 33405
Georgia	16	44	Randy Sellers, Rt. 1, Box 346 A, 3605 Minchew Rd., Waycross, GA 31503

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Hawaii	17	43	Anne Mabery, 1843 Alewa Dr., Honolulu, HI 96817	Southern	36	43	Esther Hall, 7503 W. Shore Dr., Edina, MN 55435
Idaho	18	44	Mike Ward, 2823 Polaris, Caldwell, ID 83605	Mississippi	37	44	Joyce (Billie) Hobart, 260 Wilmot Rd., Greenville, MS 38701
Illinois				Missouri			
Chicago	19	43	Walter (Wally) Zoller, 35591 N. Franklin Ave., Ingleside, IL 60041	Eastern	38	43	John Verdon, 49 Willow Brook Dr., St. Louis, MO 63146
Northern	20	44	Russ VanDran, 115 Greenwood St., Box 333, Toulon, IL 61483	Western	39	43	Gene Hughey, 8700 Holmes, Apt. 211, Kansas City, MO 64131
Southern	21	43	William (Bill) Baker, 4711 W. Main St., Decatur, IL 62522-1060	Montana	40	44	Mark Sullivan, 6336 Highway 93 South, Whitefish, MT 59937
Indiana				Nebraska	41	44	Marvin Rumery, 1812 W. Arlington, Lincoln, NE 68522
Northern	22	43	Cathy Ferrante, 301 Navajo Trail, Lowell, IN 46356				
Southern	23	44	James (Jim) A. Wilson, 115 N. 5th Ave., Beech Grove, IN 46107	Nevada	42	43	Peter (Pete) A. Litano, 155 Leo Dr., Sparks, NV 89436
Iowa	24	43	Hugh Vaughan, 1624 S. Lakeport St., Sioux City, IA 51106	New Hampshire	43	44	Karl Lamberg, 32 East Auburn Rd., Hooksett, NH 03106
Kansas	25	44	Don Popejoy, 826 N. Durham, Ulysses, KS 67880	New Jersey			
Kentucky	26	44	Charles Williams, 407 Bromwell Dr., Louisville, KY 40245-4614	Northern	44	43	John Hughes, 1889 Rt. 9, Blvd. 15, Unit 119, Toms River, NJ 08755
				Southern	45	44	*Sally Letts, 7389 Walnut Ave., Pennsauken, NJ 08109
Louisiana	27	43	Michael (Mike) F. O'Connor, 867 Willow Dr., Shreveport, LA 71118	New Mexico	46	44	Jesse Leming, 1116 Landman NE, Albuquerque, NM 87112
Maine	28	44	Willard (Will) A. Ruliffson, Box 307, Houlton, ME 04730	New York			
Maryland	29	44	Valerie Wethered, 3015 Kenyon Ave., Towson, MD 21204	Central	47	43	Charles (Charlie) Burns, 35325 Country Rte. 36, Carthage, NY 13619
Massachusetts				Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire	48	44	Jeanne Mattis, 5559 Water St., Lowville, NY 13367
Eastern	30	43	Robert (Bob) McElroy, Box F, Raynham, MA 02767	Southeast	49	43	Denise Bell, 245 Bennett Ave., #4E, New York, NY 10040
Western	31	44	Linda Bridge, 15 Wallop School Rd., Enfield, CT 06092	Western	50	44	Shawn D'Luhy, Box 1524, Niagara University, NY 14109
Michigan	32	43	Alfred (Al) George, 515 N. Butler Blvd., Lansing, MI 48915	North Carolina	51	43	Ronald (Ron) Sharpe, 456 Homestead Dr., Fayetteville, NC 28303-2609
Southeast	33	43	Samuel (Sam) V. Reams, 17405 Pershing, Livonia, MI 48152-3822	North Dakota	52	44	Dorothy Neurohr, Box 102, Gladstone, ND 58630-0102
Western	34	44	Pearl Runyon, 523 Howard SE, Grand Rapids, MI 49507	Ohio			
				Central Southeast	53	43	Shaaron E. Johnson, 1584 S. Southfield Dr. So., Columbus, OH 43207
Minnesota				Northeast	54	43	Emery (Al) Johnson, 21795 North Lane, Oakwood Village, OH 44146
Northern	35	44	Bruce Bates, 4505 Robinson St., Duluth, MN 55804				

* Alternate delegate was seated.
Ike Treadwell, delegate, was unable to attend due to illness.

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
<i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>	55	44	Roger Smith, 5937 Sylvan Green, Sylvania, OH 43560
<i>Southwest</i>	56	44	Jack Connors, 991 Corliss Ave., Hamilton, OH 45011-4443
Oklahoma	57	43	Gene M. Benson, 2529 W. Eubanks, Oklahoma City, OK 73112
Oregon	58	44	Don Johnson, 247282 E. Highway 26, Prineville, OR 97754
Pennsylvania <i>Eastern</i>	59	43	Hugo McKissic, Sr., Box 27729, Philadelphia, PA 19118-0729
<i>Western</i>	60	43	Lois Concelman, 418 Santa Rosa Lane, Pittsburgh, PA 15237
Rhode Island	61	44	Betty Mac James, 25 Linden Rd., Narragansett, RI 02882
South Carolina	62	44	Wil Scarborough, 2335 Herndon Dr., Charleston, SC 29414
South Dakota	63	44	Kevin Ernst, 2616 Bobbi Dr., Aberdeen, SD 57401
Tennessee	64	44	Charles E. Matthews, 2323 Paddock Court, Murfreesboro, TN 37130
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	43	Davis Tolleson, 702 Common St., Jefferson, TX 75657
<i>Northwest</i>	66	44	Mary Ann Boggess, 3200 Fleetwood Dr., #A9, Amarillo, TX 79109
<i>Southeast</i>	67	43	Russell Cook, Box 1972, La Porte, TX 77572
<i>Southwest</i>	68	44	Sandy Champ, Box 546, Little River, TX 76554
Utah	69	43	Gay Walters, 963 Henderson Dr., #8, Ogden, UT 84404
Vermont	70	44	Mary Ellen O'Brien, 16 Giorgetti Blvd., Rutland, VT 05701
Virginia/Cuba	71	43	Susan Campbell, 4501 New Kent Ave., Richmond, VA 23225
Washington	72	43	Burke Dykes, 4071 SW Holgate St., Seattle, WA 98116
West Virginia	73	43	Johnathan (Jon) L. Mason, 402 Palmer Dr., Parkersburg, WV 26104
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up Penn. MI</i>	74	44	Doreen Mathison, 725A Hazel St., Oshkosh, WI 54901

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
<i>Southern</i>	75	43	Joan Johnson, 1905 Melody Lane, Brookfield, WI 53005
Wyoming	76	44	Bill Clark, 1100 Georgia Way, Green River, WY 82935
Puerto Rico	77	44	Julio Colón, Box 1036, Morovis, PR 00687

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	44	Raymond (Ray) Massey, 28 Whiteram Close N.E., Calgary, AB T1Y 5X8
B.C./Yukon	79	43	Larry Schlosser, #310-5454 Balsam St., Vancouver, BC V6M 4B4
Manitoba	80	44	David Wilson, 50 Barnstaple Cove, Winnipeg, MB R3R 2W3
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	44	Raymond (Ray) Steeves, Box 1262, Moncton, NB E1C 8P9
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	82	43	Janice French, 60 Royal Oak Dr., St. John's, NF A1G 1S6
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	43	J. Don Swallow, 209 E. Craig Henry Dr., Nepean, ON K2G 4B6
<i>Northeast</i>	84	43	Harold (Hucky) Dredhart, 38 Pine St. N., Ste. 109, Timmins, ON P4N 6K6
<i>Northwest</i>	85	43	Norman Litwin, Box 184, Balmertown, ON P0V 1C0
<i>Western</i>	86	44	Judy Allard, 128 Victoria St., Sarnia, ON N7T 2T1
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	44	George Bellefeuille, 7375 Roi Rene Anjou, PQ H1K 3G7
<i>Southeast</i>	88	43	Regis Chenard, 76 Rue Delage, Riviere du Loup, PQ G5R 3P8
<i>Northeast</i>	89	43	Rene Desharnais, 611-A, St. Wilbrod St., Hebertville Station, PQ G0W 1T0
<i>Northwest</i>	90	44	Fernand Lachaine, 160, Rue Cloutier, App. 303, Rosemere, PQ J7A 3Y5
Saskatchewan	91	44	Dawson A. Young, 25-189 Lockwood Rd., Regina, SK S4S 3G6

